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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp * * * * * * * THURSDAY, JUNE 26, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXV NO. 147 WSJ.com ★★★★ $5.00

DJIA 42982.43 ▼ 106.59 0.25% NASDAQ 19973.55 ▲ 0.3% STOXX 600 536.98 ▼ 0.7% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 1/32, yield 4.294% OIL $64.92 ▲ $0.55 GOLD $3,327.10 ▲ $9.70 EURO $1.1661 YEN 145.26

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Shell is in talks to** acquire BP in what would be a landmark combination of two supermajor oil companies, potentially the largest such deal since the merger that created Exxon Mobil in 1999. **A1**

◆ **The U.S. took a step** toward easing some financial-crisis-era bank restrictions, proposing to let the largest lenders free up some of the capital they hold for times of market turmoil. **B1**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** ended mixed, with the S&P 500 unchanged and the Nasdaq rising 0.3%, leaving both within 1% of their records. The Dow fell 0.2%. **B10**

◆ **Sales of new** single-family homes sank in May amid continued concerns over high mortgage costs. **A2**

◆ **A mediator proposed** that Trump and Paramount Global settle the president's lawsuit against the media company's CBS News division for $20 million. **B1**

◆ **Mark Zuckerberg** poached three OpenAI researchers to join Meta's superintelligence efforts, a recruiting coup intended to help steer the company out of an AI crisis. **B1**

◆ **Tesla's sales in the EU** fell steeply in May, continuing a downward trend even as the bloc's electric-vehicle market shows signs of growth. **B4**

◆ **The EU said it would** investigate in depth Mars's bid to take over Kellanova, escalating its probe into the nearly $30 billion deal over competition concerns. **B3**

◆ **Dating company Bumble** said it would lay off about 30% of its workforce, or roughly 240 employees, aiming to become more agile. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **Trump shifted** his stance on NATO, calling the alliance "not a rip-off" after a summit in the Netherlands, as European leaders used flattery and focused on increased military spending to satisfy him. **A1**

◆ **Democratic socialist** Zohran Mamdani's near-certain win in the New York City Democratic primary for mayor left financiers wondering what it might mean for their industry. **A1, A2**

◆ **China told its rare-earth** industry to identify employees with technical expertise, aiming to ensure they don't pass trade secrets to foreigners. **A1**

◆ **Trump doubled down** on claims that U.S. strikes crippled Iran's ability to pursue a nuclear bomb, rejecting the a leaked preliminary intelligence report that found the hits only delayed Tehran's efforts for a few months. **A6**

◆ **Health Secretary** Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s new panel of vaccine advisers will re-evaluate the recommended vaccine schedule for children and teens, including for measles. **A3**

◆ **Britain said it would** acquire a squadron of U.S. jets capable of carrying nuclear weapons as it looks to beef up deterrence in Europe in light of a growing Russian threat. **A10**

◆ **Former Trump lawyer** Emil Bove defended his actions at the DOJ, parrying Democratic accusations that his temperament and ethics disqualified him from serving on an appeals court. **A3**

◆ **A Capitol Hill group** launched a sustainability caucus to back policies that encourage what it calls environmentally responsible commerce. **A4**

CONTENTS

Shell in Early Talks to Buy Rival BP

A deal for BP, valued at some $80 billion, would help Shell to challenge competitors

By Ben Dummett, Lauren Thomas and Jenny Strasburg

Shell is holding early-stage talks to acquire rival BP in what would be the largest oil deal in a generation, people familiar with the matter said.

Talks between company representatives are active, the people said, and BP is considering the approach carefully. Acquiring BP would put Shell on firmer footing to challenge larger competitors such as Exxon Mobil and Chevron. It would be a landmark combination of two so-called supermajor oil companies, a group of multinational behemoths that dominate production of the world's most important energy sources.

Potential terms of any deal couldn't be learned, and a tie-up is far from certain, the people familiar with the matter said. Bankers working on behalf of the companies have been engaged in the discussions, which are moving slowly, the people said.

Shell said after The Wall Street Journal reported the talks that the report "is further market speculation. No talks are taking place." U.S.-listed shares of BP ended the day 1.5% higher, while in London, Shell shares fell 0.8%.

A BP spokesman declined to comment.

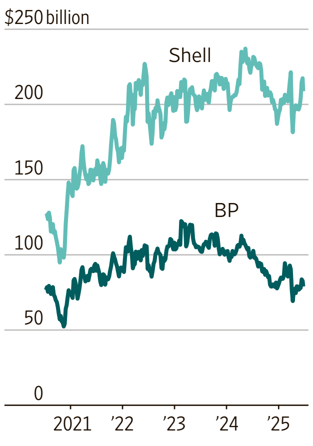
BP is currently valued at around $80 billion. Taking into account a premium, a deal could end up as the largest corporate oil deal since the $83 billion megamerger that created Exxon Mobil at the turn of the century. It would also easily be the biggest M&A deal of the year, so far, in a market that has been rattled by Trump's trade war and other geopolitical tensions.

Shell comes into the talks operating from a position of strength, with its stock sharply outperforming BP in recent years. Shell, which like BP is based in the U.K. but has operations around the world, has a market value of more than $200 billion.

BP has been the laggard among major oil companies after an ill-fated push away from fossil fuels into renewable energy. It has also suffered years of management upheaval and

Please turn to page A10

Market value



Source: FactSet

BEATA ZAWRZEL/ZUMA PRESS

President Trump basked in praise from European leaders at the summit at The Hague. He is flanked at a meeting by U.K. Prime Minister Keir Starmer, left, Dutch Prime Minister Dick Schoof, standing, and NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte, right.

Trump Warms to NATO, Won Over By More Military Spending, Flattery

By Annie Linskey, Alexander Ward and Daniel Michaels

THE HAGUE—What a difference one night in a Dutch palace can make.

President Trump departed Washington early Tuesday in a bad mood, swearing at Israel and Iran for endangering the cease-fire he had brokered and sweating from a heat wave blanketing the capital.

Once he settled into his royal digs here, where temperatures dipped into the 60s, the cease-fire was holding and he basked in praise from European leaders he had clashed with for years.

"I came here because it was something I'm supposed to be doing," said Trump during an hourlong news conference at the end of his brief trip to the Netherlands. "But I left here a little bit different."

The biggest difference was his new verdict on the North Atlantic Treaty Organization.

"It's not a rip-off," Trump said, reversing his past broadsides against the alliance.

Trump even got a pass on his profanity from NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte, who compared the Iran-Israel situation to disciplining children, explaining, "Daddy has to sometimes use strong language."

The first NATO summit of Trump's second term indicates he and his European counterparts have finally reached an understanding: If allies pay more for their own defense, the U.S. will remain a committed leader of NATO. In a bonus for Europeans, Trump bashed President Vladimir Putin of Russia as the main reason war still rages in Ukraine.

"Vladimir Putin has been more difficult," Trump said. "Vladimir Putin really has to end that war."

But getting to this point took immense effort, and some European officials privately bristled at how much this year's summit was geared toward personally satisfying Trump.

Please turn to page A8

◆ Intelligence on damage to Iran remains murky......... A6

Wall Street Frets Over Prospect of A Socialist NYC Mayor

On Wednesday, the world's epicenter of capitalism woke up to find it might soon have a socialist mayor.

By Kevin T. Dugan, Gregory Zuckerman and Brian Schwartz

Democratic socialist Zohran Mamdani's nearly certain win over former Gov. Andrew Cuomo in the New York City Democratic primary for mayor shocked Wall Street. Some of the world's most influential and powerful financiers were left grasping to understand what a potential Mamdani mayoralty would mean for their industry—and whether they would leave the city.

"It's officially hot commie summer," Dan Loeb, chief executive of hedge fund Third Point, and a major Cuomo backer, wrote on social-media platform X.

Mamdani's campaign was, up until a few weeks ago, a long shot. On Polymarket, which predicted the outcome of the 2024 presidential election, Cuomo had odds as high as 92.5% on May 27. Negative ads against Mamdani paid for by Wall Street-funded super political-action committees, as well as also-ran candidate Whitney Tilson—himself an investor—blanketed airwaves and filled residents' mailboxes.

Mamdani's platform includes

Please turn to page A2

◆ Primary results jolt party leaders.................................... A2

China Puts Rare-Earth Experts on Tight Leash

By Jon Emont

China has told companies in its rare-earth industry to give the government lists of employees with technical expertise, aiming to ensure they don't divulge trade secrets to foreigners.

The queries point to the growing geopolitical significance of China's control over the materials, which are widely used in cars, electronics and weapons and stand at the center of the U.S.-China trade war.

China's Ministry of Commerce in recent weeks asked rare-earth companies based in China for personnel lists that include specialist employees' specific expertise, education, research background and personal information, people familiar with the queries said.

The goal, the people said, is to develop a formal catalog of Chinese nationals with rare-earth expertise and keep tabs on these employees to make sure they don't travel abroad and reveal secrets.

Please turn to page A9

INSIDE

CAROLYN FONG FOR WSJ

U.S. NEWS
Young Americans, squeezed by a challenging economy, are spending less. **A3**

SPORTS
Can a woman run a four-minute mile? Faith Kipyegon is ready to find out. **A14**

The Great Scottish Tea Swindle

* * *

How a band of brew-swilling detectives brought down Scotland's 'Mr. Tea'

By Alistair MacDonald

When Ron McNaughton was asked to investigate an entrepreneur claiming to sell Scottish tea, he had one thought.

"You can't grow tea in Scotland," the former police detective remembers thinking of a plant normally grown in notably hotter and sunnier climes of China and India.

Thomas Robinson's The Wee Tea Plantation business was feted for cultivating novel homegrown brews sold in some of Britain's most exclusive hotels and stores. The self-styled "Mr. Tea" even claimed the late Queen Elizabeth II as a fan.

But his story sparked questions about the provenance of his product, setting off a seven-year probe that took investigators from Scottish fields to a Parisian cafe and a Mississ-

Please turn to page A12

Even Buffett Hasn't Fixed RV Breakdowns

Forest River averages 50 recalls a year, many from manufacturing errors

By Ryan Felton And John Keilman

Jay Nelson was driving away from a picturesque Montana state park in 2020 when he saw smoke in his rearview mirror.

It was coming from the Forest River recreational vehicle he was towing. Nelson, a longtime Montana highway patrolman, got his three daughters to safety, then he and his wife grabbed a fire extinguisher.

He later blamed the incident on a wiring defect. The trailer suffered hundreds of dollars in smoke damage. Nelson said it could have been much worse.

"That could have easily cost the life of my children, my wife, or me," he said.

RVs are the ticket to an itinerant, back-to-nature lifestyle for millions of Americans. Behind those footloose dreams, however, are vehicle-quality problems that have been blamed for injuries and deaths.

Forest River, owned by Warren Buffett's Berkshire Hathaway, is one of the RV industry's Big Three, along with Thor and Winnebago. Over the past decade, those companies have reported more recalls than Detroit's Big Three automakers, even though they make far fewer vehicles.

RVs have to operate as both houses and vehicles. The complexity of that production leads to more recalls, according to Forest River. Executives, consultants and analysts say the RV industry's unique manufacturing practices also play a major role.

Unlike highly automated car plants, RV factories typically rely on workers who

Please turn to page A10

U.S. NEWS

NYC Primary Result Jolts Party Leaders

Democrats on the left cheer Mamdani as GOP looks to paint his policies as extreme

By John McCormick
And Katy Stech Ferek

DAVID 'DEE' DELGADO/REUTERS

Zohran Mamdani spoke during a watch party for his primary election Tuesday night. His campaign stressed cost-of-living issues.

Democrats were handed their latest challenge in selling themselves nationally to swing voters following the surprise first-place showing of a democratic socialist in New York City's mayoral primary.

The performance in Tuesday's election by Zohran Mamdani, a 33-year-old state lawmaker, has further emboldened progressives calling for generational and ideological changes within a party now completely out of power in Washington. Voters rejected former New York Gov. Andrew Cuomo, a 67-year-old scandal-tarnished insider who was well funded and backed by establishment figures including former President Bill Clinton and billionaire former New York Mayor Michael Bloomberg.

The election outcome in the nation's most populated city and economic capital of the world left the Democratic Party—already fractured and struggling to challenge Republican President Trump—showing even more directional division ahead of next year's midterm elections.

Trump said on his Truth Social platform that "Democrats have crossed the line" by backing Mamdani. "We've had Radical Lefties before, but this is getting a little ridiculous," Trump posted. "He looks TERRIBLE, his voice is grating, he's not very smart."

Polls nationally show that the rising cost of living remains a top issue for voters, and Mamdani—who was backed by Sen. Bernie Sanders (I., Vt.) and Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (D., N.Y.)—spoke extensively on the topic. The trio of progressives have emerged as leading voices in the resistance against Trump as Democrats have struggled to find a unified message or messenger.

"The old guard establishment of the Democratic Party, fueled by billionaires, did everything they could to defeat Mamdani—and they failed," Stephanie Taylor, co-founder of the Progressive Change Campaign Committee, said in a statement. "They continue being wrong about everything, and they need to get out of the way and let a new generation lead."

Voters flocked to Mamdani after he called for freezing rent costs, free city bus rides, public child care for young children, city-owned grocery stores and raising the minimum wage to $30 an hour by 2030. The primary's top vote-getter has suggested he would pay for his costly plans by raising the city's corporate tax rate and imposing higher taxes on those making more than $1 million.

Mamdani, who could become the first Muslim to lead New York, has also described Israel's actions in Gaza as genocide and has defended pro-Palestinian slogans such as "globalize the intifada."

Mamdani's success was cheered by progressives, while establishment Democrats and party committees were more muted.

New York Gov. Kathy Hochul, Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer and House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries praised Mamdani on Wednesday without getting too close to him or some of his policy positions.

"I look forward to speaking with him in the days ahead about his ideas on how to ensure a safe, affordable, and livable New York City," said Hochul, once Cuomo's lieutenant in Albany.

Republicans nationally are gleefully suggesting Mamdani is the new face for Democrats as they present him as out of step with a majority of Americans.

The Congressional Leadership Fund, the super political-action committee associated with House Republicans, on Wednesday called Mamdani the ideal candidate for Democrats and sought to tie him to the platform of the Democratic Socialists of America by suggesting he wants to "abolish the police, get rid of prisons, abolish medical bills and private health insurance, legalize sex work, end cash bail, and ban all guns."

A debate about the party's tone and policy direction is already percolating among prospective 2028 Democratic presidential candidates who, along with others in the party, now must decide how closely they want to be associated with Mamdani.

Some possible candidates, including Illinois Gov. JB Pritzker, who is expected to formally announce a third-term campaign Thursday, have encouraged the party to embrace a progressive path. Others, including Govs. Gavin Newsom of California and Gretchen Whitmer of Michigan, former Transportation Secretary Pete Buttigieg, and Rahm Emanuel—a White House chief of staff, Chicago mayor and diplomat—are trying to nudge it in a more centrist direction.

The official outcome in New York is still to be determined by a ranked-choice vote, count and the Democratic primary winner will still face competition in the November general election.

Along with the Republican candidate, Curtis Sliwa, and an independent, Jim Walden, the Democratic nominee will need to beat Mayor Eric Adams. The embattled incumbent opted to skip the primary and has said he wants to run in November under party lines he created: "Safe&Affordable" and "EndAntiSemitism."

U.S. WATCH

SHAWN THEW/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

WATER BREAK: Visitors cool off in the fountains at the World War II Memorial in Washington.

ECONOMY

New-Home Sales Fell 13.7% in May

Sales of new homes sank in May amid continued concerns over high mortgage costs

Sales of new single-family homes fell 13.7% to 623,000 from a downwardly revised 722,000 in April, according to a Commerce Department report released Wednesday.

Sales had been expected to come in at 695,000, according to economists polled by The Wall Street Journal.

Monthly data on sales are volatile and tend to be revised.

Compared with May 2024, sales declined 6.3%, the Commerce Department said.

The estimate for new houses for sale was 507,000, 1.4% above the April estimate and representing supply for 9.8 months at current sales rates.

The new-homes data comes after existing-home sales rose unexpectedly for the first time in three months in May, though held near historically low levels, according to the National Association of Realtors on Monday.

—Ed Frankl

WASHINGTON, D.C.

Powell Says Tariffs Make Fed Cautious

Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell said the central bank is taking a more cautious approach to the effects of President Trump's tariff increases than it did in 2019 because recent increases in tariff rates are much larger and because the economy is coming off a period of much higher inflation.

The Fed cut rates three times in 2019 to cushion the economy against the risks of a sharper slowdown as a trade war with China hurt business sentiment. Inflation was running below the Fed's 2% target at that time.

"This is different," Powell told the Senate Banking Committee on Wednesday. Recent tariff hikes are larger, with many more countries facing tariff increases and fewer product exemptions.

While it's possible that tariff increases will result in a one-time increase in prices akin to an oil price shock that interest-rate policy should look through or ignore, the Fed is moving cautiously to arrive at that judgment, Powell said.

—Nick Timiraos

SOUTH CAROLINA

Lightning Strike Sends 12 to Hospital

A dozen people were taken to hospitals Tuesday after a lightning strike at a South Carolina lake, officials said.

Emergency crews responded to Dominion Beach Park near the Lake Murray Dam and assessed 20 patients, including 12 children, Lexington County officials said. They treated 18 people on the scene and 12 of them went to hospitals, according to county spokesperson Vanessa Diaz.

Their injuries weren't considered life-threatening, and all of the patients were expected to recover, officials said.

The weather was sunny with some clouds nearby, but not overhead when the strike happened, the Irmo Fire District said. Lightning hit the water as several people were holding on to or swimming near a metal cable and buoys that surround the swimming area, the agency said.

"Everybody got quite a jolt," the fire agency said. "We're so fortunate that injuries were not worse than they were."

—Associated Press

Wall Street Frets Over Election

Continued from Page One

increasing taxes on those making more than $1 million a year. He has said he would make the city more affordable by freezing rents on rent-stabilized apartments, investing $70 billion in publicly subsidized housing, providing free bus service and opening government-operated grocery stores.

Cuomo's lock on Wall Street was all but taken for granted. He had the loud backing from billionaire figures such as Bill Ackman, Loeb and former Mayor Michael Bloomberg, who won three terms as the GOP nominee.

On Tuesday night, Mamdani's lead became apparent soon after polls closed: A nine-point advantage in early votes held about steady as the day-of voting results came in. The primary results aren't yet finalized, but Cuomo conceded before the end of the night, leaving open questions of whether he will run in the general election in November.

Wall Street quickly started to worry. "There are a lot of warning signs flashing here. The next mayor here is going to have his hands full," said Ed Skyler, a former deputy mayor under Bloomberg, who is now an executive at Citigroup.

Some of the financial executives spoke of backing Mayor Eric Adams, who is expected to run in November on an independent line. Financial titans had found Adams an early improvement from his predecessor Bill de Blasio, a Democrat.

Corporate leaders held a flurry of private phone calls to plot how to fight back against Mamdani and discussed backing an outside group with the goal of raising around $20 million to oppose him, according to people familiar with the matter.

The calls also discussed efforts to coalesce behind Adams and working to keep Cuomo out of the race, the people said. They also discussed trying to get Republican candidate Curtis Sliwa, to drop out by getting the White House to offer him a job in the Trump administration, the people said.

Not everyone was downbeat about the primary results, though. On CNBC, Philippe Laffont, founder of hedge fund Coatue Management, said the city would likely continue to thrive, arguing it withstood the tenure of de Blasio, who embraced policies that some in the business community opposed.

"We had Mayor de Blasio for eight years, New York is really strong, I'm hopeful the same will happen," he said on CNBC's "Squawk Box." "And there's still an election."

Mamdani's wide support seemed to expose how Wall Street has changed in recent decades. There were more individual donors from major banks to Mamdani than there were to Cuomo, according to city campaign-finance records where donors listed their employers.

But many of them were among the large ranks of tech staff and other nonfinance employees. Three Goldman Sachs software engineers were listed as donating directly to Mamdani. Only one financier at Goldman publicly gave directly to Cuomo, according to the records. Other bankers who quietly supported Mamdani wouldn't talk on the record. One tried to use a fake name.

The level of support for Cuomo among the moneyed set was so high that viral TikTok videos skewered the phenomenon in recent weeks, as Election Day neared. "You seem like such an alpha," a woman says in one video to her fictional date with a finance bro. "So, you're voting for Cuomo, right?"

On Wednesday, bankers and traders were trying to figure out the repercussions of a potential Mamdani mayoralty.

Some voiced concern about Mamdani's plan to freeze the rent of millions of New Yorkers who live in rent-stabilized apartments, saying it would deter new investment in housing, reduce supply and push up prices for everyone else.

"I can't believe I even need to say this, but socialism doesn't work," said Anthony Pompliano, CEO of Professional Capital Management, a bitcoin-focused financial-services company. "It has failed in every American city it was tried."

There were renewed questions about whether Wall Street executives would stay in New York or if Mamdani's plans for the city would send more financiers to states such as Florida and Texas. Some executives cited concerns about taxes and crime under a potential Mamdani administration as well as fears of rising antisemitism.

"I'm depressed and sad," said Ricky Sandler, who runs Eminence Capital, a Midtown Manhattan hedge fund, which employs 55 people. "If Mamdani becomes mayor, I will likely move my business and family out of New York."

CORRECTIONS & AMPLIFICATIONS

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RFK Jr. Panel To Assess Shots For Children

Vaccines including hepatitis B, measles and their timing will get new scrutiny

By Liz Essley Whyte And Dominique Mosbergen

ATLANTA—Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s new panel of vaccine advisers will re-evaluate the recommended schedule for vaccines for children and teenagers, including for measles and hepatitis B, its new chairman said Wednesday.

The new slate of advisers met for the first time Wednesday in Atlanta, kicking off a two-day meeting with an agenda partially set by political appointees. Meanwhile, on Capitol Hill, the nominee to lead the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, Susan Monarez, told senators she believes vaccines save lives and there is no causal link between vaccines and autism.

Kennedy earlier this month dismissed all 17 previous members of the Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices, accusing the panel of conflicts of interest. Several of the new replacements have articulated anti-vaccine positions in the past.

A new working group of the panel in coming months will re-evaluate childhood and adolescent vaccines and their timing, said the committee's new chairman, Dr. Martin Kulldorff. He said the group may look at vaccines for hepatitis B and for measles, mumps and rubella, or MMR.

"If you have questions or concerns about the safety or efficacy of vaccines, we want to hear them. That is the scientific method," Kulldorff said. "No questions should be off limits."

Kulldorff said a working group of the committee would examine whether the hepatitis B vaccine should be given to infants in their first days of life. Doctors in the U.S. typically give the shot to newborns, even if a mother has tested negative for the virus, because of the risk that tests are wrong or other household members carry the virus. While the virus is most often spread through sexual contact or intravenous drug use, it can also spread through scrapes and cuts. Hepatitis B can be a lifelong infection that leads to liver failure.

The new panel of vaccine advisers met for the first time Wednesday.

Kulldorff also said a working group may re-examine the timing for giving MMR vaccines and consider religious objections to MMR vaccines derived from fetal cell lines. He said the working group may look at an MMR vaccine approved in Japan.

Sen. Bill Cassidy, the Louisiana Republican leading Monarez's confirmation hearing for CDC director on Wednesday morning, reiterated his call that the Atlanta sessions be postponed, saying that many of the secretary's appointees lacked the right experience and that some may even harbor biased opinions against vaccines.

"Given that there is no confirmed CDC director, along with an ACIP panel which has very few members, many of whom lack broad vaccine and immunological expertise, there are concerns about the rushed nature of this process," said Cassidy, chairman of the Senate's health committee.

The doctor from Louisiana, who cast the deciding vote to advance Kennedy's nomination as HHS secretary, made his first significant rupture with Kennedy earlier this week when calling for the meeting to be delayed.

Kennedy on Wednesday announced he was withdrawing U.S. funding to Gavi, an international alliance that helps provide vaccines to the world's poorest children. Monarez told senators she wasn't involved in that decision but affirmed that vaccines save lives.

"We need to continue to support the promotion of utilization of vaccines," she said.

The vaccine advisory panel is set Thursday to hear a presentation on thimerosal, a preservative that anti-vaccine activists have often blamed for autism, from Lyn Redwood, a nurse practitioner who is president emerita of Children's Health Defense, an anti-vaccine nonprofit previously helmed by Kennedy. Anti-vaccine activists have long suspected that thimerosal causes autism. Rates of the disorder have continued to climb even after thimerosal was removed from most vaccines in the early 2000s.

Stressed Generation Z Spends Less

By Rachel Wolfe

CAROLYN FONG FOR WSJ

Sheeta Verma, age 25, left, with her younger sister Hiya Verma. Sheeta has a new job that pays around six figures at a marketing startup, but worries about being laid off.

Young Americans' shopping spree is over.

In-store and online purchases for 18- to 24-year-olds fell 13% year-over-year between January and April, according to market research firm Circana. Spending by older groups is still on the rise but has slowed.

A combination of economic challenges is driving the decline. Young grads are having a much tougher time finding jobs. Student-loan payments are restarting for millions of borrowers. Over roughly the past year, credit-card delinquency rates have risen to their highest points since before the pandemic, and are highest for those 18 to 29, according to the New York Federal Reserve.

"This group is struggling more than older cohorts," said Wells Fargo economist Shannon Grein.

Categories where young people's spending has fallen the most include apparel (-11%), accessories (-18%), technology (-14%) and small appliances (-18%).

It isn't uncommon for every generation to struggle at the outset. But they also tend to have fewer major financial obligations and more free cash to spend on entertainment and clothing. And as they move up the career ladder, their spending power ought to increase, economists say.

"It sucks for now," said Grein at Wells Fargo. "But since younger consumers are not only spending less today but also probably saving less, that could dent their ability to build wealth in the future."

Bank of America found that spending for Gen Z and millennials fell 1% between May 2023 and May 2025.

"Although a 1% decline doesn't sound so weak, it should at this stage of younger generations' life cycle really be rising," said David Tinsley, a Bank of America Institute economist.

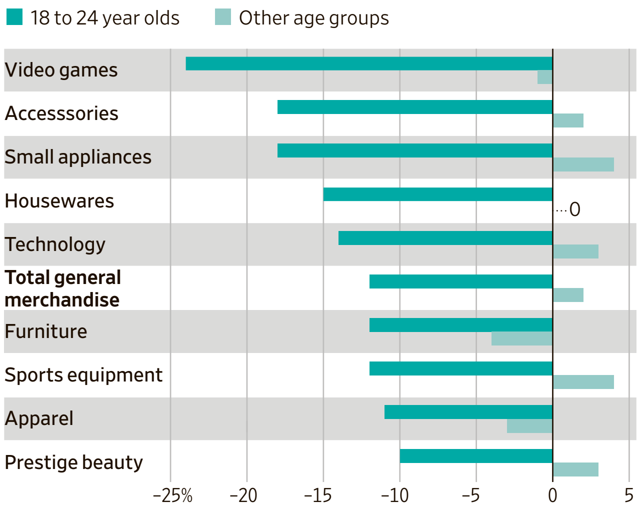
Job insecurity

Sheeta Verma moved from her parents' house to an apartment in San Francisco six months ago, armed with a list of over 200 bars and restaurants she wanted to try. She has been to fewer than 10. For starters, cocktails are $20. And even when she is willing to splurge, she can't count on finding a friend to go with her.

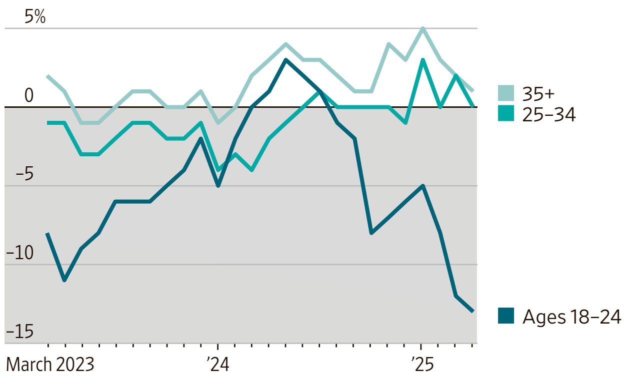
"It's so disappointing," said Verma, who is 25.

After getting laid off and spending most of last year job hunting, she was thrilled about her new startup marketing gig, which pays around six figures. But her salary doesn't go as far as she expected, and she worries about the possibility of losing her job again.

Average weekly spending for select industries, change from a year earlier*



Purchases by age group, change from a year earlier†



*For the four weeks ending April 2025 †Change in three-month rolling average for per-person purchases

Source: Circana

"It feels like every single day I go online and I see a new big tech company has done layoffs," Verma said.

Most of her friends are similarly fearful, or part of the rising ranks of the unemployed. They have pulled back paying for meals, streaming subscriptions and buying new clothes.

One such friend, Himanshu Wagh, frequents fancy furniture stores for a free place to hang. "We sit on the sofas and when the conversation gets boring, we move to a different sofa," said Wagh, a 25-year-old psychiatry resident. "We feel rich drinking their free coffee and enjoying this bougie furniture we can't afford."

Although young people make up only a small slice of overall consumer spending, they are an important demographic for retailers to hook.

"The beauty of the younger consumer is they give you longevity and they give you loyalty," said Marshal Cohen, Circana's chief retail analyst. They also tend to go on more frequent, smaller shopping trips, which leads to more impulse buying.

The pullback is especially noticeable for retailers who cater to this demographic.

Online sales for Thread Wallets, an accessories brand that sells primarily to 18- to 29-year-olds, fell 29% over the first three weeks of June compared with the same days in May. "Instead of buying the $30 wallet, they're buying the $16 wallet," said Ryan King, chief financial officer for the brand.

Financial stress

Skye Bowie, 21, never expected to have a ton of disposable income as a college student. But the closer she has gotten to graduation from New York University, the more financially stressed she has become. She has felt discouraged watching older friends struggle to find work. And she was disappointed when the paid summer internship she had initially lined up fell through.

"You get to this point that, even though you did everything you were supposed to do, the system seems stacked against you," said Bowie.

Nadia Ford was on track to buy a small condo in Washington, D.C., before she turned 30. The 28-year-old was proud of her six-figure "dream job" at the Department of Health and Human Services and to be contributing regularly to a savings account for her future down payment.

That was before her role as a Presidential Management Fellow was eliminated last month in a round of Department of Government Efficiency cuts. With job prospects in both D.C. and the public-health field more generally looking bleak, she is worried she will have to move back in with her parents in rural Texas.

"I felt like I was where I wanted to be," said Ford. "Now, that's off the rails."

Bove Defends DOJ Tenure in Hearing

By Corinne Ramey

President Trump's former lawyer Emil Bove defended his actions as a top Justice Department official, including in the corruption case against New York City's mayor, as he parried Democrats' accusations that his temperament and ethics disqualified him from serving on a federal appeals court.

"There is a wildly inaccurate caricature of me in the mainstream media," Bove said during a hearing before the Senate Judiciary Committee. "I am not anybody's henchman. I'm not an enforcer. I'm a lawyer from a small town who never expected to be in an arena like this."

Bove, 44 years old, has been nominated by Trump for a seat on the Third U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals. He now serves as principal associate deputy attorney general, and he previously defended Trump in several criminal cases, including his hush-money trial in New York City. Bove spent about a decade working as a prosecutor in the U.S. attorney's office for the Southern District of New York, with a focus on national security matters.

Bove has faced fierce opposition from Democrats. They grilled him Wednesday about his order to drop the bribery charges against Democratic Mayor Eric Adams and a whistleblower complaint accusing him of telling subordinates to disobey court orders related to deporting immigrants. They accused him of having an angry temperament—including while as a prosecutor in New York—that made him a liability to his office.

Sen. Dick Durbin of Illinois, the committee's top Democrat, said that in selecting Bove, Trump was looking for a nominee who, as a judge, would rule for his policies from the bench.

"He is looking for loyalty," Durbin said. "He is looking for fierce retribution. He is looking for someone who will instill fear in his opponents. It seems he has found such a nominee in Mr. Bove."

Over several hours, Bove remained largely calm and collected, although at times he declined to answer questions about internal Justice Department matters, Trump's pardons and whether there was any White House involvement in the Adams case.

He denied a whistleblower's account that he advised officials to tell courts "f— you" to some directives. "I did not advise any Justice Department attorney to violate court orders," Bove testified.

KEVIN DIETSCH/GETTY IMAGES

Emil Bove spoke before the Senate Judiciary Committee.

In February, the Justice Department asked a judge to dismiss the federal bribery case against Adams, saying the case had been politically driven and that it hampered the mayor from helping the Trump administration's crackdown on illegal immigration. Asked about the matter, Bove said he hadn't made a "political deal" to drop the charges against Adams.

He told senators that the case "placed an inordinate burden on the mayor's ability to protect the city" and to campaign for re-election.

The judge ultimately dismissed the case with prejudice, meaning it couldn't be refiled, although he picked apart Justice Department officials' rationale in his opinion.

Bove also accused the Special Counsel's office, under Jack Smith, of acting politically in its criminal cases against Trump and prosecutors in one of the cases of trying to rush to trial unusually quickly.

Durbin questioned Bove about his views on the Jan. 6, 2021, attack on the U.S. Capitol by a mob of Trump supporters. He pointed to a 2022 article in which Bove described domestic terrorism as a national security issue and referred to the Jan. 6 attack. Durbin said that was inconsistent with Bove's aggressive attempts to build a list of Federal Bureau of Investigation agents who participated in the investigation.

"Now you are trying to have it both ways," said Durbin.

"Both things can be true," replied Bove. He said he condemned both unlawful behavior and heavy-handed behavior by law enforcement.

Republicans on the committee seemed largely supportive of Bove's nomination during the hearing. That signals Bove might face little resistance in a vote by the full Senate, which is controlled by the GOP.

GOP Talks on Megabill Heat Up

Senators try to hit Trump's July 4 target as Republicans work to resolve differences

By Richard Rubin And Jasmine Li


TING SHEN/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

'It's a moving target,' Sen. James Lankford (R., Okla.) said of the GOP effort to reach a deal.

WASHINGTON—Senate Republican leaders kept pressing the gas pedal Wednesday to get their "one big, beautiful bill" passed by this weekend, even while hundreds of billions of dollars in crucial decisions are being negotiated, key senators are holding out, and some House lawmakers are crying foul.

President Trump wants the legislation on his desk by July 4, and Republicans hope the megabill's perceived inevitability overcomes any momentary implausibility. Senators aim to start votes as soon as Friday on the legislation, which would cut taxes, reduce spending on Medicaid and nutrition assistance, and boost spending on border security and national defense. The House could send the bill to Trump early next week.

For now, there aren't enough votes for a bill that isn't finished yet.

"It is this mysterious process of trying to be able to move specific ideas through 53 other people and trying to be able to get ideas and opinions," said Sen. James Lankford (R., Okla.). "And where do people land? It's a moving target."

Changes expected

Senators aren't quite ready to vote and they expect to change the legislation in the coming days. Several senators, including Josh Hawley (R., Mo.) and Dan Sullivan (R., Alaska), said they want to be able to review the whole bill before taking the first procedural step—a vote to open debate.

"Our guys are all going to keep advocating for what they want, til the final minute, til we pass it," said Sen. John Hoeven (R., N.D.) "That's how it works."

Senate Republicans need support from at least 50 of their 53 members, a task that is proving to be challenging. Sen. Rand Paul (R., Ky.) is expected to vote "no" because of a debt-limit increase. Sens. Ron Johnson (R., Wis.), Rick Scott (R., Fla.) and Mike Lee (R., Utah) are seeking further savings in the bill—from bigger spending cuts to faster expiration of clean-energy tax credits.

For now, there aren't enough votes for a bill that isn't finished yet.

But moving the bill in their direction could risk others' votes. Sens. Thom Tillis (R., N.C.), Hawley and Susan Collins (R., Maine) are already arguing that the bill's Medicaid cuts go too far. They are resisting the Senate leadership proposal to limit a state mechanism that increases federal Medicaid funding, and they are trying to get money to shore up rural hospitals.

"I don't think we've landed the plane on the rural hospitals," Hawley said Wednesday, arguing that a $15 billion fund spread over many years wouldn't be enough.

Senators expect the House to accept whatever they produce, dismissing GOP representatives' concerns about budget deficits, Medicaid cuts, clean-energy tax credits and the state and local tax deduction, or SALT. In each case, however, those provisions might look substantially different from the version that the House passed last month, and the House could reject or change it.

"It ain't good where it is," said Rep. Chip Roy (R., Texas).

Trump and GOP leaders are trying to get the bill finished by Independence Day, a date with symbolic importance but little policy significance. The tax cuts getting extended in the bill don't expire until Dec. 31. The debt-limit increase in the bill isn't needed until August at the earliest.

But failure to hit the July 4 deadline could frustrate Trump. And Republicans can't countenance an expiration of the tax cuts at year's end, which would mean higher costs for most households.

Beyond that, if Republicans can't get the votes to extend tax cuts and raise the debt ceiling on their own, they might need to negotiate with Democrats. That dynamic gives Republicans confidence that they will find a way through by relying only on Republican votes.

The issues at the center of the frenzied dealmaking—Medicaid, renewable energy, deficits, taxes—are no surprise.

They are among the biggest pieces of the bill, and the choices that Republicans have postponed for months. Party leaders successfully prodded rank-and-file lawmakers to keep the process going through earlier stages, assuring them that they could always vote "no" later.

Frustration in House

Later is now here, and the Senate framework is prompting frustration in the House, which passed its bill 215-214. House members may be forced to make an up-or-down call on a bill that they don't fully support.

Reps. David Valadao (R., Calif.), Juan Ciscomani (R., Ariz.) and 14 others wrote to party leaders this week and warned that the Senate's deeper Medicaid cuts undermined the House's approach.

Conservatives, including Roy and Reps. Andy Harris (R., Md.) and Eric Burlison (R., Mo.), have warned that they can't back the Senate plan, which has slower phaseouts of clean-energy credits.

And some New York House members continue insisting on a $40,000 cap on SALT, when many Republican senators prefer $10,000 or $0. So far, the discussions have focused on keeping the cap at $40,000 while lowering the beginning of the income limit for that deduction down from the $500,000 in the House bill. House members have said they are open to that change but only if they get something, such as larger annual increases in the cap beyond the 1% in the House bill.

"This is a big jigsaw puzzle," Sen. Roger Marshall (R., Kan.) said. "I think SALT will be the last piece."

Rep. Mike Lawler (R., N.Y.) was among lawmakers at a Wednesday meeting with Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, a session that Lawler called productive. "We're near the end of the bill, aren't we?" Lawler said. "The Senate is barreling towards a vote, and obviously the president and the White House want to get this bill across the finish line."

Lawmakers Encourage Sustainable Shopping

By Clara Hudson

In the age of Shein and the fast-fashion haul, lawmakers on both sides of the aisle are trying on a more sustainable option.

Reps. Sydney Kamlager-Dove (D., Calif.) and Nicole Malliotakis (R., N.Y.) are launching a new caucus aiming to promote the re-commerce economy, looking in part to help platforms like eBay, **Etsy** and Depop where consumers can buy and sell pre-owned items—often at hefty discounts.

The bipartisan initiative will back policies that extend the life cycle of a product, cut down on landfill waste and "encourage environmentally responsible commerce." It will also aim to support small sellers on digital platforms and promote access to apps like Poshmark and OfferUp.

Kamlager-Dove said she hopes to focus in part on reducing sales tax on secondhand items and providing tax credits for companies adopting circular business models.

"Why not do something that's good for fashion, good for the economy and good for the environment?" she said.

For Malliotakis, a big concern is tackling tax burdens for small businesses and resellers as well as fighting counterfeits, with the added benefit of cutting waste.

"It's sustainable, it helps the environment, there's less trash and you make somebody else happy," she said.

The push comes as an onslaught of tariffs hit products and materials shipping into the country, sending retailers' supply chains into disarray but also focusing U.S. shoppers' minds on where their goods come from.

Small Conservative Firms Are Drawing Legal Clients

By Erin Mulvaney


CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

Judd Stone, shown speaking at the Supreme Court in 2022, is a founder of conservative law firm Stone Hilton.

The nation's largest corporate law firms have been on their heels during President Trump's second term, but for small firms with impeccable conservative bona fides, these have been boom times.

What they lack in name recognition or size, these firms make up for with a crucial credential: loyalty to Trump and to MAGA causes.

Steve Roberts, co-chair of litigation boutique Lex Politica, said the firm, with offices in Austin, Texas, and Washington, D.C., has experienced a swell of business from Fortune 500 companies and is fielding résumés from big-firm lawyers. Lex Politica numbers about a dozen lawyers. It added four hires just a few weeks after Trump was sworn into office this year—including Roberts, who has long catered to Republican clients.

By working for a small, overtly political firm during an unabashedly conservative presidential administration, Roberts said he can "amp that up and lean into the political moment we're having."

Lex Politica says it has provided legal and strategic advice on the formation of Elon Musk's Department of Government Efficiency. The firm says it has also represented Musk in his private capacity, as well as entrepreneur and former Republican presidential candidate Vivek Ramaswamy and dozens of GOP Senate and House members.

Conservative firms are well-positioned to help clients navigate an administration that prizes loyalty above all else. Their rise also comes as clients seek favorable outcomes from a federal judiciary that leans to the right.

The Austin-based firm Stone Hilton hasn't shied away from its conservative roots since it was launched just under two years ago by Chris Hilton and Judd Stone, who are alumni of Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton's office.

The law firm's pitch: They are only a phone call or two away from the president.

Stone Hilton says it is providing counsel to top Republican lawmakers and high-level officials in the administration, as well as representing Musk's social-media platform X in a defamation case. It has also worked on cases with America First Legal, a conservative legal nonprofit founded by Stephen Miller, Trump's deputy chief of staff.

Stone says those close connections to Trump's allies have helped the firm win more business from corporate clients looking to navigate the current regulatory environment.

"We were never going to be politically neutral from the start," Stone said.

A lawsuit filed in late May by a former employee of the firm accusing Stone of verbally harassing her and making inappropriate sexual comments has cast some shadow over the firm's rise. The firm says the lawsuit is the result of a political vendetta.

Large law firms have long tended to have a more liberal bent, and many played a role opposing the first Trump administration on immigration and other policies. **Jones Day**, which has some 2,400 lawyers, has historically been an exception in leaning conservative. The firm represented Trump during his first presidential campaign, and lawyers there landed top spots in his first administration, including Don McGahn, who served as White House counsel. The firm hasn't had the same prominence in Trump circles this time around.

Jones Day declined to comment.

Several lawyers from small firms hold significant positions in Trump's current administration, after representing Trump on criminal and civil matters while he was out of office. He installed Emil Bove, who served on his criminal-defense team, to a high-ranking Justice Department post and has since nominated him to be a federal appeals judge. Alina Habba, who worked at a small firm in New Jersey, is now Trump's interim U.S. attorney for the state. And Trump ally Harmeet Dhillon has catapulted from a small namesake firm to lead the Justice Department's civil-rights division.

Industry consultants say today's hyperpartisan environment allows smaller firms to thrive in part because larger firms, beholden to a much larger base of clients and lawyers, must toe a more careful line.

Bigger firms "may be reluctant to take on politically charged right-wing disputes because of the internal ramifications they can have among employees," said Dan Binstock, a legal recruiter in Washington, D.C.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U.S. Makes New Push for Cease-Fire in Gaza

Arab officials say Israel, Hamas have both indicated a desire to seal a deal

The U.S. is making a fresh push in negotiations to end the fighting and free the hostages in Gaza, as President Trump hopes to build on the momentum of a deal that paused hostilities between Israel and Iran and bring an end to the conflict that sparked nearly two years of war in the Middle East.

By Summer Said, Anat Peled and Alexander Ward

OMAR ASHTAWY/APA IMAGES/ZUMA PRESS

Palestinians in Jabalia, Gaza Strip, on Wednesday walked among ruins, as President Trump said he hopes for a deal for a truce.

While significant gaps remain between Israel and Hamas, Arab officials mediating the talks say both sides have shown an interest in getting a deal done. The mediators said they are in talks with both sides by telephone, adding they could soon meet in Egypt, which along with Qatar has helped the U.S. broker the Gaza talks.

On Wednesday, Trump said the cease-fire between Israel and Iran has improved the atmosphere of talks around the fighting in Gaza. “I think great progress is being made on Gaza,” Trump told reporters at the NATO summit in The Hague. “I think we’re going to have some very good news.” Trump said he was recently briefed about developments in the talks by special envoy Steve Witkoff. “He did tell me that Gaza is very close,” Trump said.

U.S. officials have frequently expressed hopes that talks to end the conflict, sparked by Hamas’s deadly Oct. 7, 2023, attacks on Israel, were close to bearing fruit, only to be proven wrong.

While Israel is willing to talk, there is no sign it has changed its position on ending the war or some of its other demands, including Hamas’s giving up its arms.

But after months of stalemate, there have been signs of new activity. Hours before Trump announced the cease-fire between Israel and Iran, Witkoff called Israeli and Arab mediators to restart the negotiations for a possible Gaza deal, the mediators said. The mediators reached out to Hamas officials, who indicated they are willing to come back to the table, the mediators said.

Witkoff told the mediators that Trump wants to see the war in Gaza end and that Israel has communicated to the U.S. that it is sincere about reaching a deal after months of deadlocked negotiations, the mediators said.

The Israeli prime minister’s office and Hamas didn’t respond to requests for comment. The State Department and Witkoff didn’t respond to requests for comment.

Hamas said on Wednesday that it would continue its “positive engagement with the efforts of mediators, and with any serious ideas or proposals that could lead to a comprehensive agreement.”

Israel launched the war in Gaza after the Hamas-led Oct. 7 attacks, which killed around 1,200 people and took about 250 hostage. Israel’s war in the enclave has killed more than 56,000 Palestinians, according to local health authorities, who don’t say how many were combatants, and has left swaths of the enclave in ruins.

Israel had aimed to wrap up its war in Iran to shift the focus back to Gaza, a person familiar with the matter said.

Hamas, meanwhile, finds itself increasingly isolated, with its Lebanese ally Hezbollah and patron Iran battered by Israeli attacks. Most of Hamas’s military leadership has been taken out in Gaza, where the group is now on its third leader in eight months after the previous two were killed by Israel.

The latest proposal under consideration is similar to one that has been on the table for months, the mediators said. It calls for Hamas to release 10 of the roughly 20 hostages Israel believes are still alive, along with the bodies of some deceased hostages. In return, Israel would release a much larger number of Palestinians it is holding and commit to a 60-day cease-fire, they said.

According to the proposal, the 60-day cease-fire would be followed by a lasting cease-fire, during which the remaining living and slain hostages would be handed over.

Hamas has expressed willingness to accept guarantees that the U.S. would express publicly that Israel will enter into talks to end the war, the mediators said.

Iran Intelligence Stays Murky Without Eyes on Ground

WASHINGTON—President Trump on Wednesday doubled down on his claims that U.S. military strikes against Iranian nuclear sites crippled Tehran’s ability to pursue a nuclear bomb, rejecting a leaked preliminary intelligence report that assessed the American strike had merely delayed Iran’s efforts for a few months.

By Michael R. Gordon, Dustin Volz and Lara Seligman

The dispute points to a larger problem that is likely to bedevil U.S. intelligence analysis and experts for many months, as they attempt to determine the full extent of damage on the nuclear facilities that were struck.

While there are ample indications that the Iranian program suffered major damage from the B-2 bomber and cruise-missile strikes the U.S. carried out last weekend, the status of Iran’s program might not be fully known unless inspectors are allowed to visit the sites that were attacked and the suspected locations where enriched uranium and nuclear-related equipment might be hidden. Iran maintains that its program is for peaceful purposes.

EVELYN HOCKSTEIN/REUTERS

CIA Director John Ratcliffe said the strikes were effective.

“Remote battle-damage assessment is always difficult,” said Charles Duelfer, who oversaw United Nations weapons inspections in Iraq and later directed a Central Intelligence Agency assessment after the 2003 U.S. invasion on what happened to Saddam Hussein’s weapons of mass-destruction programs. “That’s why people like inspectors on the ground.”

Speaking at a North Atlantic Treaty Organization summit at The Hague, Trump stood by his initial claims that the Iran program had been “totally obliterated” and called the early findings in a leaked Defense Intelligence Agency report “inconclusive.” The issue is likely to be addressed Thursday morning at a rare Pentagon news conference, which Trump announced in a social-media post.

“We destroyed the nuclear,” Trump said.

CIA Director John Ratcliffe issued a statement that lent support to Trump’s broad claims without offering details. “CIA can confirm that a body of credible intelligence indicates that Iran’s Nuclear Program has been severely damaged by the recent, targeted strikes,” Ratcliffe said.

Neither the White House nor the CIA addressed the status of stocks of highly enriched uranium that Iran was known to possess and whether they might have been moved before the U.S. attack.

On Sunday, Vice President JD Vance suggested that Iran still had caches of enriched uranium. “We are going to work in the coming weeks to ensure that we do something with that fuel and that is one of the things that we’re going to have conversations with the Iranians about,” Vance told ABC News.

Before Israel and the U.S. attacked, Iran was thought to have enough near-weapons-grade material for around 10 nuclear weapons. But Vance also argued that the uranium wouldn’t be useful to Iran because its main known enrichment facilities had been destroyed.

A person familiar with the DIA report leaked this week said the document states that it is a preliminary assessment based on reporting available just 24 hours after the strike, and that it wasn’t coordinated with other agencies.

Weakened Regime Is Testing Durability of Its Alliances

SOBHAN FARAJVAN/PACIFIC PRESS/ZUMA PRESS

A man walks in the rubble of a Tehran building that was damaged during Israeli attacks.

As Iran reels from its gravest threat in decades, its alliance with China, Russia and North Korea—an axis that increasingly has alarmed the U.S. and allies—is facing a vital test: Will its partners come to its aid?

By Timothy W. Martin, Thomas Grove and Austin Ramzy

Beijing, Moscow and Pyongyang could offer Iran crucial assistance to recover from the damage inflicted by U.S. and Israeli strikes on its nuclear program and arsenal of conventional weapons. That could deepen the alliance, sending a powerful signal for potential conflicts in Taiwan, the Korean Peninsula and Eastern Europe.

Indeed, the three powers helped Iran build the nuclear program that the U.S. and Israel have tried to destroy.

The Isfahan facility, Iran’s largest nuclear-research complex and a prime target of the U.S. strikes, was built with Chinese assistance when it opened in 1984, according to the nonprofit Nuclear Threat Initiative. Three small, Chinese-supplied research reactors operate there.

North Koreans helped design the underground tunnels used in Iran’s nuclear sites. Moscow has said hundreds of Russian nuclear experts currently work inside Iran.

But China, Russia and North Korea don’t appear eager to rush to Iran’s side. A big reason: President Trump’s decision to insert the U.S. into Israel’s assault on Iran by striking the country’s nuclear facilities has made helping Tehran recover far riskier and more geopolitically fraught.

“Iran could literally build back better,” said Behnam Ben Taleblu, of the Foundation for Defense of Democracies, a Washington, D.C.-based think tank. But he remains skeptical that such support is coming soon.

“A rising tide that lifts all boats is not the principle that governs this axis of authoritarians,” he added.

‘China, Russia and North Korea to some extent are vulnerable under Trump.’

A failure to come to Iran’s aid would show how divergent the four powers’ interests are, exposing the transactional nature of a coalition that is largely driven by shared opposition to economic and geopolitical pressure from the West.

On Monday, Russian President Vladimir Putin received Iran’s top diplomat, Abbas Araghchi, in Moscow but offered no military aid. China and North Korea both condemned the U.S. strikes on Iran, but didn’t mention Trump by name.

“It’s not like there’s a four-party bad boys treaty,” said Alexander Gabuev, director of the Carnegie Russia Eurasia Center in Berlin. “It’s more helpful in peacetime, in sanctions busting and tech transfers.”

The quartet—christened “Crink” by some Western officials—has cooperated on energy, military and diplomacy in recent years, united in the aim of evading Washington’s sanctions and undermining a U.S.-led order.

Russia’s full-scale invasion of Ukraine three years ago catalyzed the group, with an isolated Moscow seeking support for the war. Iran has supplied Russia with critical drone technology, while North Korea has sent huge quantities of ammunition and thousands of soldiers.

China, which buys more than 90% of Iran’s oil, has supplied so-called dual-use products that help the Kremlin’s war effort.

Sergei Shoigu, head of Russia’s security council, met in Pyongyang with Kim Jong Un last week to strike a deal whereby North Korea would send 6,000 military construction and demining specialists to Russia’s Kursk region—the same area in which Kim has deployed roughly 15,000 of his troops to help expel Ukrainian soldiers since last fall.

Even without helping Iran directly, the three have benefited from the recent events.

The U.S.’s military—already overstretched—has redeployed a slate of assets to the Middle East, including an aircraft carrier that had been stationed in the South China Sea, where China has aggressively pressed territorial claims.

To deal with the Iran-Israel conflict, Trump cut short his trip to the Group of Seven summit in Canada last week, skipping a meeting with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, who had traveled there to rally support against Russia.

Rearming Iran creates opportunities for weapons sales from North Korea, a longtime military supplier to Tehran. But assisting Tehran could undermine the three nuclear-armed nations’ own interests.

China is in the midst of trade talks with the Trump administration, which has slapped high tariffs on Chinese imports.

Russia might be eager to maintain goodwill with Trump, who has so far rejected new sanctions against Moscow to force it to end the war in Ukraine.

North Korea, with limited resources, is engaged in a foreign war in Russia.

“China, Russia and North Korea to some extent are vulnerable under Trump,” said Gabuev, from the Carnegie center.

“They have to balance out that vulnerability with what they want to do for Iran,” he added.

Moscow Balances Its Loyalties to Tehran and Israel

Moscow has played a major role in helping Iran finish and run its only nuclear-power plant, with enriched uranium coming from Russia. However, while Moscow was long a major supplier of arms to Iran, it hasn’t delivered on most of those contracts in recent years.

Moreover, Russian President Vladimir Putin and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu have had a long relationship. Israel has provided Ukraine with early warning radar systems, and Moscow doesn’t want it to provide more.

Nikolay Kozhanov, an expert on Russia-Iran relations at Qatar University, said the best Moscow could likely do at this time is provide Tehran with radio-electronic systems and some software to help against cyberattacks. “Leaving Iran without any support is very tricky for Moscow,” Kozhanov said. “But the key task for Moscow right now is not to spoil relations with anyone.”

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Air Raids and Shelters: A Night in Kyiv

A reporter spends evenings clinging to life's normal things, if the sirens allow

By Jane Lytvynenko

KYIV, Ukraine—It is a balmy Monday evening here, filled with the scent of linden trees, the bustle of outdoor cafes and no outward hint of the deadly war that has raged for more than three years.

Then comes a social-media warning: A couple of Russian attack drones are closing in.

A couple. Not enough to alter my dinner plans but the start of a gamble Kyiv residents take every night: How long can we cling to the normal stuff of life before Russia's steady drone-and-missile barrages drive us underground in search of shelter?

During my meal—a half roast chicken and mashed potato washed down with fresh lemonade—my phone lies unlocked so I can keep a wary eye on drone status notifications appearing on my screen at shorter intervals.

Sirens start to wail across the city at 9:06 p.m. as I take a walk after dinner, indicating the first few drones have entered Kyiv's airspace. I head home to get some sleep before the assault's crescendo.

At my apartment, I begin my nightly checks. The bathtub, a safe place away from the windows and behind an interior wall, is padded with a blanket and pillows. I put my electronic devices on to charge and check my go-bag: water, granola bars, a medical kit with two tourniquets, a flashlight, a power bank and sweaters.

I turn the volume on my phone to maximum to avoid missing an air-raid alert and set alarms for every 20 minutes to wake up and check on the status of the assault.

As I doze off, at 10:17 p.m., another warning on Telegram: Russian war planes are preparing to take off in the next two hours. I go back to sleep.

The next update is at 10:31 p.m.: There are up to 100 drones in Ukrainian airspace. I try to squeeze in another 20 minutes of rest as I listen for the telltale buzz, which earned the drones the nickname "mopeds" among Ukrainians.

Just after midnight, I hear one. The buzzing grows closer. More are on the way. It's time to go to the air-raid shelter.

The usual crowd stands at the entrance, a covered stairway near the side of a building. They are smoking, chatting and checking their phones, ready to scurry back down at the first sound of trouble.

Many people in Ukraine use parking garages or basements for shelter, but this one was built for the situation in 1978 during the Cold War. A tattered old map on the wall shows the potential direction for the spread of radiation in case of a nuclear strike. There is wireless internet and makeshift beds fashioned out of stacks of blank forms for a census that was never carried out.

People arrive with their pets, including a green parrot and a pooch with a dyed purple tail named Lolita. The regulars greet one another warmly. The cold underground turns into a kind of living room housing a couple of dozen people. A blond woman is sleeping under a blanket with her spaniel beside her. The boy with the parrot eats sandwiches with his friend as their parents scroll through their phones. A young man plays Candy Crush. Someone snores.

It is past 12:30 a.m. and there are a few dozen drones in the air and Russian warplanes carrying cruise missiles have taken off. By 2 a.m. we will know whether they have launched their munitions. Each update comes with a mental calculation of how long the bombs will take to arrive.

"*Balistyka*?" people blurt out as walls vibrate. "Was that a ballistic missile?"

Each explosion, even when it is an interception by Ukrainian air defense, shakes the shelter. Those who were asleep are alert now. Ballistic missiles can only be countered with U.S.-designed Patriots, which Ukraine has in short supply. The shock wave from one makes the body shudder.

"A strike in Solomyanka," a working-class Kyiv district, a man with a mustache says.

"Ambulances were called," I read out loud from my phone.

By 2:15 a.m., most of the shelter is awake, sharing grim updates about the areas of the city that have been hit. "*O bozhe*," the woman next to me whispers repeatedly, "Oh god."

Another wave of drones comes an hour later, but some people begin to head home during a period of quiet.

By 4.30 a.m., the cold has begun to creep through my two sweaters and I can't keep my eyes open. The desire to sleep wins out over fear, and I head home, despite the 15 attack drones still in the air.

When I emerge from the shelter, it is nearly dawn. The sky is filled with the sound of birds greeting the rising sun.

For an hour, I try to sleep between the machine-gun fire and explosions as Ukrainians battle against the final wave of drones and missiles.

A glance at photos sent to me by colleagues shows the damage from the strikes. A student dormitory is hollowed out, missing windows. The midsection of a nine-story apartment building has been bombed to the ground by the ballistic missile we heard.

The toll of those who didn't share our shelter or our luck that night is stark: 28 killed and more than 140 wounded.

SERHII KOROVAYNY FOR WSJ (2)

At top, people hunker down in a Soviet-era bomb shelter in Kyiv. Above, residents seeking a haven from Russian attacks bring their pets, including dogs, cats and even a parrot.

Wearing Down Resistance

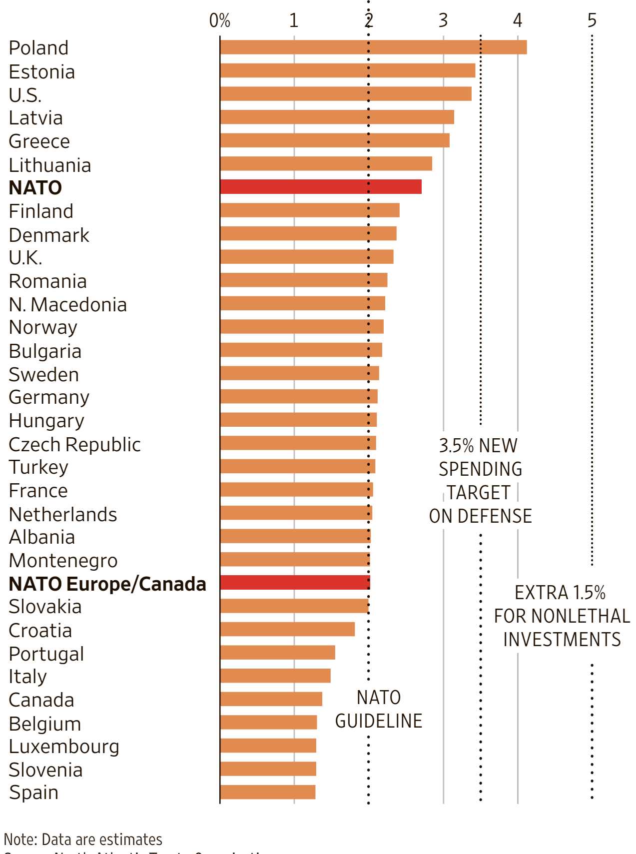
Russia's latest tactic in its effort to wear down Ukrainian resistance is to stockpile munitions for a few days and then launch them in a single night to overload defenses.

The biggest threat comes from Iranian-designed Shahed attack drones, each capable of destroying several floors of an apartment building. The longer the sky is quiet, the more tense the conversations in Kyiv's coffee shops and stores become about when the next air raid will launch.

REMKO DE WAAL/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

President Trump with Norway's Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Støre, left, and Polish President Andrzej Duda at the summit.

Military spending as percentage of GDP, 2024



Note: Data are estimates
Source: North Atlantic Treaty Organization

Trump Warms Up To NATO

Continued from Page One

One day earlier, on Trump's flight to the Netherlands, he had equivocated about his commitment to NATO's core tenet, mutual defense, enshrined in its founding treaty. "Depends on your definition. There are numerous definitions of Article 5," he said.

Organizers compressed the gathering to just one day, under U.S. pressure to focus on European military spending and European desire to minimize chances of conversations getting confrontational, as they did at NATO's 2018 summit. The final agreed-to text was five paragraphs, one of the shortest communiqués in the alliance's 75-year history.

Europeans also employed copious flattery.

"You are a man of strength, but you're also a man of peace," Rutte gushed.

Even President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine, who has clashed with Trump, issued a statement brimming with praise after a bilateral meeting. Trump, for his part, said he held a good meeting with Zelensky and committed to sending the country more Patriot air-defense systems, U.S. equipment that Kyiv has long sought.

Not everyone was ebullient.

Former NATO chief Anders Fogh Rasmussen said one of the headline commitments—spending 5% of economic output on defense within 10 years—must be achieved sooner.

"All other options are disappointing or too weak," he said.

And Gabrielius Landsbergis, Lithuania's former foreign minister, said gratifying Trump had distracted from the bigger picture: confronting Russia's military resurgence.

"The problem is our expectation at the summit was to win a political battle with Trump to appease him," Landsbergis said in an interview. "The real battle is actually Putin, who is out there blasting Ukraine every single day, and I don't think we achieved much on that front."

He cited European intelligence that Russia is rearming at levels beyond what it needs to fight in Ukraine. The buildup should have been the main focus of the summit, Landsbergis said, not Trump.

The summit occurred as Trump was toggling priorities, including pushing lawmakers in the U.S. to support his legislative agenda, negotiating an effort to push member nations to increase military spending while also monitoring a fragile peace in the Middle East.

> The president reversed his past verdict on the alliance: 'It's not a rip-off.'

The only apparent cloud darkening the presidential mood was a leaked preliminary intelligence report that found the U.S. military's strikes on three Iranian nuclear facilities only set back Tehran's nuclear ambitions by a few months. He blamed the reports on "idiots at CNN" who broke the story and other news outlets that followed it. And, while Trump didn't dispute the validity of the intelligence reports, he stressed that they were preliminary and cited other reports from Israel and Iran describing significantly more damage.

Just as NATO members voted to lift spending commitments, the White House put out a statement from the Israel Atomic Energy Commission saying the U.S. strikes on the Fordow nuclear site in Iran made it "inoperable" and set Iranian nuclear ambitions back by "many years." Trump read from it during the news conference.

Trump's mood was notable for a president who during his first term showed dislike for traveling to big international summits. During the Group of Seven summit in Canada earlier this month, Trump was annoyed he had to sit through a lengthy meeting about fire prevention and repeatedly asked aides what was going on in the outside world with the war.

"We've gotta go," he said, explaining the decision to leave, according to a person familiar with the conversation.

Staff from some other delegations rolled their eyes as Trump's team left early.

Trump said Wednesday he was genuinely pleased with the Dutch trip. "This was a tremendous summit, and I enjoyed it very much," he said after several hours of meetings. "I stayed through every one of those speeches, every one. And some were good."

Typically, U.S. presidents don't sit through all of the speeches, but instead pop out for bilateral meetings.

Trump appeared upbeat from the lavish dinner upon his arrival Tuesday. He and other leaders gathered at the 17th-century royal palace Huis ten Bosch, in a hall decorated with floor-to-ceiling paintings and lighted by chandeliers. Trump, who favors grand rooms, was photographed looking up to take in the splendor.

He overnighted there as the guest of Dutch King Willem-Alexander and Queen Máxima. "I actually had breakfast today with a king and a queen who were beautiful, beautiful people. Central Casting."

Trump even had praise for the foliage. "I saw the most beautiful trees," he said. "In fact, I want to bring some back with me."

U.K. to Purchase U.S. Jets in Shift Of Nuclear Policy

By Max Colchester

LONDON—In a return to Cold War nuclear policy, Britain will acquire a squadron of U.S. jets capable of carrying atomic bombs as it looks to beef up deterrence in Europe in light of a growing Russian threat.

The U.K. government said it would purchase 12 F-35A jets, which can carry conventional weapons as well as U.S.-made tactical nuclear bombs. The purchase could allow the U.K. to launch nuclear weapons from the air for the first time since the late 1990s. Currently, Britain's nuclear weapons are carried solely on its four Vanguard submarines.

The overhaul of Britain's nuclear policy points to growing fear of Russian aggression and Europe's reliance on U.S. equipment to deter its most high-profile adversary. Fears of a more isolationist Trump presidency have prompted European leaders to consider expanding their nuclear capabilities.

Britain will contribute its F-35 jets to the North Atlantic Treaty Organization's airborne nuclear mission. Several European countries, including Germany and the Netherlands, have jets that can be loaded with U.S. nuclear bombs and deployed in the event of war. These missions need signoff from the U.S. president, as well as NATO planners. The U.K. doesn't at this stage plan to develop its own air-to-ground nuclear missiles, officials said.

NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte hailed the move as "a robust British contribution to the alliance." The British announcement to purchase Lockheed Martin's F-35As was made as it pledged to increase military spending to 5% along with other NATO allies by 2035, in a bid to placate President Trump, who has complained that the Continent doesn't pay enough to fund its own security.

Since Trump's election, European nations have been debating whether they need to develop, or more widely share, nuclear bombs in case the U.S. disengages from the Continent's defense. In Europe, only France and the U.K. have their own nuclear bombs.

The F-35s, as well as being cheaper to maintain than submarines, also can be equipped with tactical nuclear bombs, which carry a smaller nuclear payload. Britain will need to acquire nuclear air-to-ground bombs from the U.S.

NATHAN LAINE/BLOOMBERG NEWS

An F-35A jet was seen at the Paris Air Show this month. The U.K. government said that it would buy 12 F-35A jets.

WORLDWATCH

LUIS TATO/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

A demonstrator gestured in front of a burning barricade in downtown Nairobi on Wednesday, amid a protest against police brutality and government corruption on the first anniversary of antitax demonstrations in which 60 people were killed.

UNITED KINGDOM

Trump Skips King's Meeting Offer

President Trump plans to make a full state visit to Britain this year, bypassing a suggestion put forward by King Charles III that the two men first meet informally this summer when both are expected to be in Scotland.

The invitation from Britain formalizes Trump's unprecedented second state visit to Britain. The visit is seen as part of Prime Minister Keir Starmer's effort to curry favor with Trump and lessen the impact of his America First policies on the U.K. But Starmer has faced pushback from some lawmakers in his Labour Party.

Charles will face his own challenges during the visit because he is head of state of the U.K. and Canada, which Trump has suggested should become the 51st U.S. state.

—Associated Press

GAZA STRIP

Seven Israeli Forces Killed in Bombing

Israel on Wednesday reported one of its deadliest days in Gaza in months as its military said seven soldiers were killed when a Palestinian attacker attached a bomb to their armored vehicle, while health officials in the battered enclave said Israeli attacks killed 79 people over the past day.

Among the 79 reported killed in Gaza were 33 people who died while trying to access aid. Palestinian witnesses and health officials say Israeli forces have repeatedly opened fire on crowds heading toward desperately needed food, killing hundreds in recent weeks.

The military says it has fired warning shots at people it said approached its forces in a suspicious manner.

—Associated Press

ARMENIA

Archbishop Held On Terror Charges

Security services arrested one of the country's top religious leaders on terrorism charges on Wednesday and accused him of plotting to overthrow the government, the second arrest in a week of a prominent political opponent.

Archbishop Bagrat Galstanyan, a major figure in the influential Apostolic Church, was arrested by Armenia's Investigative Committee, which accused him of planning to carry out bombings and arson attacks to disrupt power supplies and stage accidents on major roads to paralyze traffic. His lawyer described the charges as "fiction."

Galstanyan leads the Sacred Struggle opposition movement and has demanded the resignation of Prime Minister Nikol Pashinyan.

—Associated Press

KENYA

Rights Protesters Clash With Police

Thousands of protesters against police brutality and government corruption clashed on Wednesday with Kenyan police who hurled tear-gas canisters and wielded batons, leaving several people injured as demonstrations spread.

The protests were timed to mark the first anniversary of antitax demonstrations in which 60 people were killed.

Parliament and the president's office in Kenya's capital were barricaded with razor wire, with all access roads blockaded by police.

The protests, which have spread to major cities, have morphed into calls for President William Ruto to resign over poor governance.

Ruto on Wednesday urged protesters not to "destroy" the country.

—Associated Press

China Aims To Monitor Rare Earths

Continued from Page One

The lists include those in upstream roles, such as processing rare earths, and those in downstream roles, such as those using the processed minerals to make rare-earth magnets. The magnets are used in automobiles, wind turbines, drones and jet fighters.

One of the people said some experts at Chinese companies have been asked to turn in their passports to their companies or local authorities, to ensure they don't make any unauthorized trips. China already requires government officials and employees of state-owned companies to turn in travel documents and apply for approval to travel abroad.

China is the world's largest miner and processor of rare earths, and it makes around 90% of the world's rare-earth magnets. With trade tensions heating up, China in April established a new system for licensing the export of rare earths and rare-earth magnets. That has constricted the global trade in magnets, worrying Western car and electronics companies and leading to some temporary closures at factories dependent on Chinese supplies.

For years, China has produced these magnets so inexpensively that it has been all but impossible for companies elsewhere to compete. But the recent export restrictions are breathing new life into efforts to develop rare-earth industries in countries such as the U.S. and France.

The country produces about 90% of the world's rare-earth magnets.

One of the main hurdles is the paucity of rare-earth production expertise outside of China.

Processing rare earths involves painstaking separation of individual rare-earth elements from raw materials, in which many elements with similar chemical properties are jumbled together. Chinese scientists have developed equipment and processes that are widely considered best in class.

That is a turnaround from decades ago, when China was first developing its rare-earth industry and benefited from foreign experts who trained workers in the latest technologies.

To fortify its advantage, China's government in December 2023 released new regulations forbidding the export of certain Chinese technology used in rare-earth processing, making it harder for foreign competitors to emulate China's strengths.

Last September, China's Ministry of State Security said a Chinese national was sentenced to 11 years in prison for selling secrets about China's rare-earth stockpiles to unspecified foreign interests.

The ministry said foreign entities "use every means to obtain our internal data" and if they get leaked data, it could "put China at a disadvantage in international strategic competition."

REUTERS

Workers transport soil containing rare-earth elements—of which China is the world's largest miner and processor—for export at a port in Lianyungang, Jiangsu province, China.

Shell Is In Talks To Buy BP

Continued from Page One
operational disasters.

Activist investor Elliott Investment Management, which owns more than 5% of BP's shares, has pushed for changes at BP since at least February, underscoring the oil and gas producer's exposure to a potential takeover bid.

BP has since adopted several measures to try to address investor frustrations. It announced plans earlier this year to boost oil and gas production and sharply cut investments in clean energy.

BP is also in the process of trying to sell its lubricants business that operates under the Castrol brand and has indicated it could unload at least part of its solar unit, Lightsource. More recently, BP said that Chairman Helge Lund, an architect of BP's low-carbon strategy, plans to step down.

Shell, meanwhile, has focused on its most profitable operations, pledging to pump more oil and gas and rolling back green-energy targets.

When asked publicly, Shell Chief Executive Officer Wael Sawan said recently the company's bar for big dealmaking would be high. Shell announced in May a multibillion-dollar share buyback plan, the latest in a series of big share repurchases. Shell has been working with bankers on a potential sale of its chemicals assets in Europe and the U.S., the Journal has reported.

For Shell, acquiring BP would take years of integration, complicated by culture clashes and possibly the sale of overlapping assets. But a deal could give Shell's global trading business greater reach and bolster its dominance in areas like liquefied natural gas. Analysts and investors also see a good matchup in the companies' operations in the Gulf of Mexico, now called the Gulf of America by the U.S.

Acquiring BP would offer an opportunity for Shell to spread costs over a larger operating base and would box out rivals. Shell would also be more politically palatable to U.K. regulators who might oppose a foreign buyer from acquiring BP, a more than century-old company that traces its roots to oil exploration during the height of the British Empire.

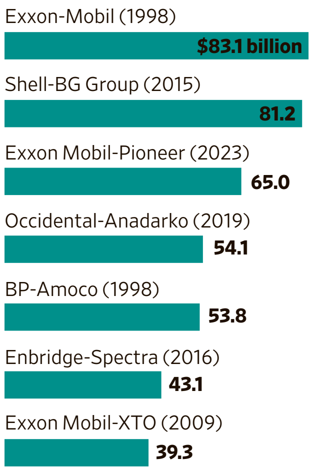
Bloomberg News reported in early May that Shell was evaluating a potential BP deal.

Under U.K. takeover rules, a London-listed company that issues a formal stock exchange denial of takeover talks can be prevented from approaching the target for at least six months. Shell didn't release a formal statement, but its comment could still potentially subject it to that restriction.

A Shell-BP deal would be the latest in a wave of M&A activity across the energy landscape as producers look to achieve greater economies of scale. Chevron is still working to close its $53 billion megadeal for Hess, which has been held up due to Exxon's effort to challenge the deal's legality.

Exxon last year closed a $60 billion deal to buy Pioneer Natural Resources. And Diamondback Energy sealed a $26 billion deal for Endeavor Energy Resources.

Major energy deals



Note: Year of deal announcement
Source: FactSet

Clockwise from left, Forest River RVs; Wade Mullins points out spots where the ceiling fell down in his RV; a billboard in Elkhart advertises Forest River's priority for customer satisfaction.

SARAH RICE FOR WSJ (4)

Forest River RVs Under Scrutiny

Continued from Page One
assemble vehicles by hand. Employees are often paid by the unit instead of a straight hourly wage and can leave once they hit their quota. Some former workers say the system encourages speed over thoroughness.

"The piece rate thing is great, but if you know you'll get out early when you get done, that's where the crap comes from," said Fred Cook, who spent most of his career working in RV factories, including six years at a Forest River plant.

From 2015 to 2024, no single automaker or RV manufacturer issued more recalls than Forest River. About half of its recalls between 2020 and 2024 were due to manufacturing errors rather than faulty parts or poor engineering, according to a Wall Street Journal analysis of federal data.

Recall documents highlight insufficient oversight, inattention and haste.

In one case, workers punctured microwaves they were installing with screws that were the incorrect length. In another, inspectors discovered misaligned furnace flues a month after the employee who was checking them quit. In 2023, the company recalled 50 towable campers after finding that workers had created a fire risk by inserting the wrong fuse into power distribution centers. The reason? The factory had a shortage of the correct fuse.

Federal law requires companies to file a recall within five working days of determining that a vehicle contains a safety-related defect. Forest River said it proactively files recalls out of an overabundance of caution, doing so even when it doesn't believe a safety defect actually exists. It also noted that other companies' recalls, on average, have involved many more vehicles.

Forest River said it is committed to producing the safest and highest-quality vehicles, and does thorough inspections before every RV leaves the factory. A trade group, the RV Industry Association, also does its own unannounced inspections six times a year.

"Forest River will continue to own what we build and stand behind every product with the same honesty that's helped us become one of the industry's leading manufacturers," the company said.

Forest River now faces the biggest probe of its quality control in years with a lawsuit brought by Nelson.

Four years after the incident at the state park, the company recalled about 41,000 vehicles with an electrical component that it said some plants had incorrectly wired—an error that could cause a short circuit and a fire. The safety issue affected two Forest River models produced over 20 years, according to the company's recall filings, and so far 7% have been repaired.

Nelson said the company issued the recall after inspecting his RV. His lawyers are seeking class-action certification, alleging the wiring defect could affect far more vehicles.

Forest River said it doesn't comment on pending litigation.

'Well-oiled machine'

Four out of five RVs in the U.S. are built around Elkhart, Ind., a city of 53,000 between Chicago and Detroit. Long before dawn, its roads are jammed with workers headed to their shifts.

The area has been a manufacturing hub for decades. While many plants closed long ago, RV makers have remained a constant since setting up shop in the 1940s, taking advantage of the town's prime auto belt location.

Among those drawn to the business was Pete Liegl, who created a small RV maker in the mid-1980s called Cobra Industries. After selling the company to private investors—and later reclaiming it out of bankruptcy—he renamed it Forest River and offered it to Buffett in 2005 for $800 million. The legendary investor bought the company for an undisclosed sum following 20 minutes of negotiation.

Buffett has praised the business and Liegl, but has rarely spoken about Forest River in detail. Unlike Thor and Winnebago, which are stand-alone, publicly traded companies, Berkshire typically shares little detail about Forest River beyond occasional remarks on revenue and market share.

"Forest River has 82 plants, and I have yet to visit one," Buffett said in a 2011 letter to investors.

Forest River said Buffett still hasn't visited a plant, though the company regularly meets with Berkshire representatives. Buffett and Berkshire didn't respond to requests for comment.

Liegl, who stayed on as CEO, died in November at 80.

Forest River now sells more than 100,000 RVs a year on average and generates more than $6 billion in annual revenue. Like its competitors, the company offers vehicles at various price points, but its bevy of entry-level towable trailers has helped make it the go-to brand for less-affluent buyers.

Michael Swartz, who covers the industry for Truist Securities, said Forest River is especially disciplined with costs, which allows it to offer more attractive deals.

"People try to get their price points as low as possible to match Forest River," Swartz said. "They're viewed as a well-oiled machine."

Production and pay

The concentration of the industry around Elkhart has created an intensely competitive labor market. Workers, who historically haven't been unionized, are typically paid a relatively low hourly wage and a bonus known as a "piece rate" that kicks in if they hit a weekly production goal.

Job hunters prefer factories that offer piece-rate pay, according to RV execs, workers and industry consultants. Companies can lure away workers with even a small increase in the rate, leading to high turnover at plants.

Former piece-rate workers at the Big Three said the promise of leaving early once they hit their quota led to fast-paced assemblies. At the same time, RV makers design and produce new models in weeks, often copying popular features introduced by competitors.

The unstable workforce and lack of automation make it difficult to produce consistent results, Swartz said: "It's not everything measured to a laser-pointed width of a hair, like in autos."

Forest River said it offers a variety of compensation programs for workers, and many of its highest quality plants are piece-rate facilities with low turnover.

"Pay programs do not define quality; rather, it's ongoing training, adherence to standards, regular audits, and long-term employees that combine to create expertise within our workforce," the company said. Forest River added it uses automation, though it declined to give an example.

Analysts say quality is an industrywide concern; market leader Thor and its subsidiaries, which operate separately, have collectively had the most recalls over the past decade.

Thor said it errs on the side of caution, issuing recalls when potential safety defects are identified. Winnebago said it adheres to industry best practices to ensure safety and dependability.

Some buyers don't know what they're getting into with an RV, said Pat Spackey, a former Air Force mechanic who began repairing RVs during the pandemic. "They'll have it for five to six years, sell it, and they say, 'Never again,' " he said. His repair business, he said, remains brisk.

Wade Mullins, a former General Motors machinist, bought a Forest River RV in 2021, thinking it would be an upgrade over his aging trailer. One of the camper's bunk beds broke during a final pre-purchase walk-through. The dealer fixed it immediately, Mullins said, but he encountered other issues for years, including peeling wall panels and poorly fitting doors. A blown refrigerator fuse ended up costing him $190.

"For whatever reason they put the fuse behind the fridge," he said.

Allison Paul bought a Forest River trailer in 2023. Within a month of it sitting outside, the pipe fitter said, rainwater began leaking through the ceiling. Paul said she put the camper inside a barn and argued with Forest River over the warranty until the company fixed it.

"This is the first and only brand new thing I've ever bought in my life, and it went to sh— in a year," she said.

Growing recalls

Forest River used to report as few as one or two recalls a year. In some cases, it issued technical service bulletins that are supposed to address non-safety-related issues. Some highlighted potentially fatal concerns.

In one 2014 bulletin, the company advised that loose wiring could spark a fire. In another the following year, it pointed to furnaces that didn't have exhaust vents, which could lead to carbon-monoxide exposure.

The National Highway Traffic Safety Administration told Forest River that those and other problems needed to be treated as recalls. Unlike bulletins, recalls require companies to provide fixes for free and routinely report how many units have been repaired.

As part of a settlement, the company admitted it had violated federal law and ultimately paid a fine of $5 million. Though the sum pales in comparison with a $65 million fine Ford paid earlier this year for similar violations, it is still among the larger penalties NHTSA has collected over the past decade.

In a 2015 interview with a trade publication, Liegl said the matter was an internal IT mistake. "While it was nothing I would call serious in itself, it was obviously serious to NHTSA," he said.

Forest River said it would remedy violations, create internal practices to comply with the law and conduct independent audits. Following the 2015 settlement, the company revamped its recall processes. It began to report an average of 50 recalls a year.

"As a manufacturer, we continually seek to improve quality and safety," Forest River said. "Recalls are one tool to accomplish this goal."

Michael Brooks, executive director of the Center for Auto Safety, said recalls improve safety, but manufacturers should work to ensure defective vehicles never reach the road in the first place.

"I've just never heard a manufacturer describe a recall as a tool," he added. "It's something they have to resort to when their quality and other processes have failed."

Pat Spackey, left, says his RV repair business stays busy.

Wiring risks

Forest River's quality control has come under fresh scrutiny through Nelson's lawsuit.

Nelson's lawyers declined to make him available for an interview. In a deposition filed in the case, he said taking his family camping had been a dream. While buying his Palomino Puma fifth-wheel trailer, he completed a course to learn best practices for owners.

Nelson returned his camper for a newer Forest River model that had the same wiring issue. After Nelson sued in 2022, his experts allege, the company conducted a study that found that more than half of Forest River plants surveyed were wiring towable RVs in a way that violated industry standards. One of Forest River's expert witnesses, in a report for the case, said that claim was unsubstantiated.

In seeking class-action certification, Nelson's lawyers said Forest River's recall is insufficient and that more than one million vehicles face wiring risks. One of his lawyers is Tab Turner, who more than two decades ago helped bring to light a rollover problem with Ford Explorers that cost the automaker billions of dollars.

The lawyers hired a team of engineers to survey Forest River vehicles in the field, and said they found roughly 60% of the 86 RV models surveyed had the same wiring problem discovered in the front of Nelson's trailers.

Forest River said in court filings the proposed class size is overblown because the standards Nelson cites apply only to one type of RV.

Forest River declined to comment on the survey conducted by Nelson's team or say how many fires have been attributed to the defect.

Heather Timmerman and Christy Csernyik say their RV should be on that list.

The pair were lying in bed one night in December 2023 when a fire broke out that destroyed their home. They got out in time but lost their cats and most of their belongings in the flames.

Local police and fire investigators couldn't determine the cause, and didn't rule out human intervention, improperly discarded smoking materials or problems with a generator.

Months later, Timmerman and Csernyik received a notice in the mail: Their camper was part of the faulty wiring recall. "When I got that letter, it all made sense," said Timmerman.

Forest River said connecting the trailer fire to the recall is "an unsupported conclusion."

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PERSONAL JOURNAL.

New Sobriety: Loud and Stigma-Free

A growing sober set is taking over mosh pits and football stadiums, partying even harder without booze

By Julie Wernau

John Plageman was covered head-to-toe in Green Bay Packers gear in April as he stood a few feet away from a beer tent at the National Football League draft. But he wasn't drinking beer.

The 53-year-old was hanging out with 20 other football fans drinking water in a "gratitude circle" at a sober tailgate. His group, Section Yellow, is a safe space for football fans to be boldly sober in one of the most intense drinking environments in American sports.

"Sobriety is this new culture wave," said Plageman, who stopped drinking 16 years ago. "I think this is a new phase of our evolution of humanity."

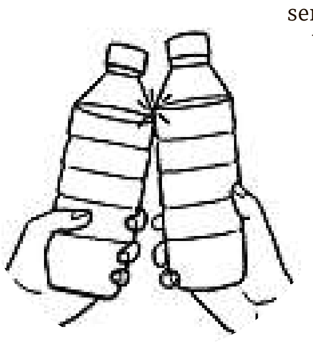
When tailgaters jokingly took selfies of themselves holding beers in front of the sober tent, Plageman gave them a ribbing right back.

Today's sobriety is in-your-face and everywhere. More than ever, people are seeking alternatives to alcohol, from $15 mocktails and sober dating, to waking up early for sober raves and wearing T-shirts branding their sobriety. But some people think it is a buzzkill.

Doreen St. Felix, a staff writer at the New Yorker, quipped that we have entered the age of "sober fascism," or the idea that people talk about their sobriety so much they make it their personality. People seem addicted to sobriety, she said.

Americans increasingly think that alcohol consumption is bad for their health, according to a Gallup Poll. In 2024, 45% of Americans said drinking one or two alcoholic beverages a day is bad for one's health, a new high.

In-your-face sobriety is catching on with people in recovery, such as Plageman. But also with people such as Johnny Crowder, who never found partying all that fun in the first place.



ALEXANDRA CITRIN-SAFADI/WSJ (3)

At every show Crowder plays with his metal band Prison, the 32-year-old singer and tech executive has a key message for his fans: Don't drink or do drugs.

Reality is metal, he tells his fans.

Crowder has the kind of fan base that would punch each other in the face in a mosh pit if he told them to. Instead, he screams out lyrics about how drinking is legalized murder and crowd surfs with a chest painted in messages about mental health. When fans try to gift him drugs and booze, he asks for Pop-Tarts and lasagna.

> 'Sobriety is this new culture wave,' a Green Bay tailgate organizer says.

"These big corporations want you to get drunk and happy and numb," he said.

So many fans have reached out for help getting off substances that he started his own company called Cope Notes, which sends people affirmations throughout the day. "You're not broken," one text message says. "Don't keep it to yourself," says another. He also gets people together after shows to talk about their mental health and sobriety. "What is more punk than that?" he said.

A lot of younger people would rather just chill out, said Chris Marshall, who started one of America's first alcohol-free bars, called Sans Bar, in Austin, Texas, in 2017.

"Work hard, play hard? Kids hear that and say, 'That seems like a lot of effort,' " Marshall said.

Still, when his bar first opened, it wasn't an immediate hit. A group of people from a local Alcoholics Anonymous meeting showed up and threatened to shut him down, saying that mocktails could trigger alcoholics to drink. A local newspaper commenter wrote, "What's next? A restaurant without food?"

"People don't get it at first," he said.

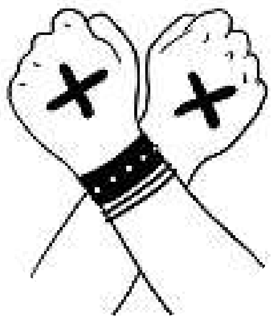
He doesn't serve soda. Or coffee. There are zero-proof cocktails, wines and beers. When people come in and say their plan is to quietly sit in the corner with a book, he discourages it. The comedy show or sorority party he is hosting might not make for a good library environment.

Engineering social interactions takes a little more work without the booze, he said, but people can actually hold a conversation. A group sitting at the bar recently had a raucous debate after one patron claimed that oatmeal-raisin cookies are better than chocolate-chip cookies.

"People went crazy," he said.

Partying sober has also gotten more in-your-face. Carl Radke returned to the reality show "Summer House"—and the party—sober.

Radke had spent the first several seasons of "Summer House" drunk and on cocaine. In 2020, his brother died of a drug overdose. His own relationship with substances took a dark turn. "I almost died," he said.



People told him they were worried that going back to an environment that is essentially one big party wasn't a good idea. He chose to go back to "Summer House." The only real change was that he stopped partying until 5:30 a.m. Now that is when he wakes up. He became so convinced that he wasn't the only sober person who liked to party, that he launched his own nonalcoholic drinks and bar.

"Is there a requirement that you have to be drunk and do cocaine to drive to the Hamptons?" he said.

Radke says that in some ways, we are all living in a reality show. His theory is that he isn't the only one who has seen enough footage of himself drunk, coked out and acting like an a—hole. But many are surprised to see a party on the other side.

People once associated sobriety with drinking stale coffee in the basement of an Episcopal Church, said Jeremiah Calvino, co-founder and chief product officer of Recovery.com, a marketplace for recovery programs and communities. Now it is also a bunch of weirdos at the climbing gym, he said, and people covering themselves in body paint.

Scott Strode, founder and executive director of sober community The Phoenix, got sober by whaling on a boxing bag. Now nearly one million people on his "sober active community" platform aren't only boxing, but rock climbing, line dancing and hosting beach parties.

"When you go into recovery, you feel left behind," Strode said. "But what if we gang up?"

That is exactly what Plageman decided to do. The Packers fan is such a die-hard that he owns a section of the goal post from the team's stadium. But he was tired of feeling like the lone sober person at football games.

So, six years ago, he and a friend muscled their way into Lambeau Field, where the Packers play, calling themselves "Section Yellow." They didn't ask permission.

"You don't have to be pious. You can keep your personality," said Plageman.

He got some pushback from other fans at the start. They bullied his group and put beers on their table.

Today, the group has six billboards on the way into the stadium and an official sober tailgate at the NFL draft.

When booze sales end for the fourth quarter, Section Yellow's fans release yellow (biodegradable) balloons in a kind of subversive celebration.

Plageman said he was inspired by one of the most substance-loving crowds in history: fans of the jam band Phish. A sober cadre of his fellow Phish fans fly yellow balloons at festivals. He is hoping he can persuade Phish to host a sober rock festival at Lambeau Field. The sober fans, he said, party down the most.

"We boogie, we boogie-down," he said.

Are Weighted Vests Worth the Hype?

ANN SARNAT

YOUR HEALTH

SUMATHI REDDY

It's not often that we intentionally add extra body weight. But the latest fitness fad encourages it: Meet the weighted vest.

You've probably seen them in your neighborhood, on power-walking pros out and about at the crack of dawn. That's my neighbor and me.

For the past month, we've been sneaking out in the early morning—she in a Navy SEAL-worthy vest and me in one that looks like an ill-fitting lifejacket—as we supercharge our walk. I duck across the street in a baseball cap to oblige my 11-year-old's plea to avoid her bus stop.

A fad, yes. Fashionable? Not so much.

So what are these weighted vests actually doing for us?

The vests have been around for decades, but were traditionally associated more with military training or CrossFit workouts. They have broadened their appeal, showing up on everyone from actress Jessica Alba to news anchor Katie Couric. They have grown particularly popular with middle-aged women.

The vests can enhance your cardiovascular workout. The benefits ramp up at weights of at least 10% of your body weight. But they're not a substitute for resistance training.

So how many more calories can you burn wearing a weighted vest?

If you wear one equal to 10% of your body weight, it will burn an additional 8.5% calories, says Dave Looney, an exercise physiologist at CoachMePlus who has researched weighted vests for the Army. With a vest that is 20% or 30% of your body weight, that number jumps to 19.7% and 32.2%, respectively.

Weighted vests can also boost endurance in stabilizing muscles, says Looney. They work your back, shoulders, abs and lower body, he says.

For running and high-intensity workouts, keep your vest weighted at 10% to 20% of body weight, and make sure it isn't affecting your normal range of motion, he says.

It's OK to start with a light vest, but getting an adjustable one is recommended, so you can increase the weight. Wearing a vest that's only 5% of your body weight doesn't have a metabolic benefit, says Troy Purdom, an assistant professor of kinesiology at North Carolina Agricultural and Technical State University, in Greensboro, who conducts research on weighted vests.

His research has found that weighted vests can help with running performance. Recreational runners shaved more than 15 seconds off a 5K when warming up with a 10% body weight vest for 20 minutes prior to the race.

But be careful: Wearing a vest during really intense or long workouts can lead to posture issues or a greater risk of injury as muscles fatigue, Purdom says.

And always consult a doctor before trying a weighted vest if you have back, shoulder or other orthopaedic issues.

Weighted vests are also beneficial for older people, especially postmenopausal women, who have a higher risk of developing osteoporosis and suffering from bone loss and fractures.

Studies suggest weighted vests can help prevent or reduce bone density loss. That's what drew Lauren Gleason, a 40-year-old dietitian in Decatur, Ga., to try one. "Bone health has been a personal priority for me," she says. "My grandmother broke her hip at my parents' wedding."

▲ **Andrea Bastek and Sarah Adle wear matching 16-pound weighted vests on their walks.**

She wears an 18-pound vest while doing lunges and push-ups. "It really helps," she says. "I used to struggle to get to 10 regular push-ups. With the vest I do sets of five and without it I can easily do 15 push-ups."

A lot of the studies done on the impact of weighted vests on bone density have been done in older adults who are naturally losing muscle and bone density.

"Weighted vests can be helpful at maintaining—even in promoting—gains in musculoskeletal health, like improving strength or balance, or even bone density in a weight-stable state," says Kristen Beavers, a professor of internal medicine at Wake Forest University School of Medicine.

Still, Roger Fielding, a senior scientist at Tufts University, says evidence on bone density isn't conclusive. He notes bone density changes over months to years.

While vests add resistance to cardio, they don't replace focused strength-training like dumbbell or body weight exercises, Fielding says.

Most of the studies include wearing it on average an hour a day for three days a week, Beavers says.

That's exactly what Sarah Adle, a 47-year-old attorney, does. She wears a 16-pound vest with friends on regular power walks. She will walk up to an hour with the vest. "I hurt myself and stopped running, and I didn't feel like just walking around the neighborhood was enough," she says. "This feels like a good supplement."

And me? A month into my weighted-vest walks, I'm feeling less self-conscious. I've ditched the fleece I used to hide the vest with when passing through busier parts of our neighborhood.

Now, when I walk without the vest, I'm moving at a noticeably faster clip. I'm ready to upgrade to an adjustable weighted version so I can add more weight.

I may even spring for one with full coverage, like my neighbor's, so we can match as we march through the neighborhood, commando-style.

Small-Business Owners Offer The Best Advice They Ever Got

Useful startup lessons came from hard-earned experience or from other entrepreneurs

By Demetria Gallegos

About 5.2 million new business applications were filed in 2024, according to the U.S. Chamber of Commerce. But based on historical averages dating back to 1994, about half of them will fail over the next five years.

So, what makes the difference between success and failure?

To find the answer to that question, we asked readers to tell us what one piece of advice was most useful to them in starting and running their business. And what do they wish they had known when they started their business. Here are some of their responses.

▲ Rowena Scherer learned a '$15,000 entrepreneurial lesson.'

▲ 'Say what you'll do, and do what you say,' advises Dave Hulett

▲ Shanna Hocking has found that the right mindset is crucial.

▲ Venkat Sharma has learned the importance of persistence.

FROM LEFT: ROWENA SCHERER; DAVE HULETT; NICHOLE MCH PHOTOGRAPHY; VENKAT SHARMA

Ask for help

I wish I'd known when I started my business that it is OK to ask for help. I used to be hesitant because I didn't want to seem like I didn't know what I was doing. But I've learned that there's no shame in asking, and it's actually one of the smartest things you can do.

In the male-dominated music-promotion business and up against some behemoths, I've found a platform supporting diverse and inclusive artists. As a small-business owner, you just have to continue to pivot until you find a lane you can own and find your community. They will be your biggest champions. They have become mine.

—**Marcie Allen,** *Nashville*

Be true to your word

Say what you'll do, and do what you say. There is no excuse for not returning a phone call or for not calling to say you're late, for example. This is beyond just business, it is common courtesy, but it's not so common anymore.

—**Dave Hulett,** *Hot Springs, Ark*

Do the homework

I've made many mistakes based on emotions, which I now realize could have been avoided if I had taken the time to do market research and data analysis. The perfect example is when we expanded to the United Kingdom. We had received a couple of orders from England, and I thought it was a good time to expand internationally. The U.K. is an English-speaking country, so I assumed it would be easier to start there. But we didn't spend time understanding the different taxes and regulations, as well as market fit. We were not prepared for it and ended up closing down our U.K. operations after one year. It was a $15,000 entrepreneurial lesson!

—**Rowena Scherer,** *New York*

You have to believe

I've learned that mindset plays an important role in running your own business, particularly an abundance mindset. It means believing in your ability to make things possible, even when things are challenging in business. And they will be!

This mindset helps you make decisions from a position of strength, gratitude, generosity and learning. Practicing this mindset has helped me to keep moving forward when things don't go as planned or hoped, to continue to invest in my business to create opportunities and proactively build supportive relationships with other entrepreneurs.

—**Shanna Hocking,** *Merion Station, Pa.*

Ask the big questions

Your most important employee is your bookkeeper. He or she must have an accounting degree. Meet with them weekly. Are you spending more than you're bringing in? Where's the money going? Do you really need all of your big-ticket equipment, or services, or consultants? Are you depositing your payroll taxes? We had technical writers placed in Silicon Valley companies, and we had to make federal tax deposits every day, but we didn't know that!

Also, a CEO often rolls up her sleeves and helps with the work all day (and night). But you are the only one who had the vision, the passion. So you have to take an hour or a day occasionally to take a helicopter view. Ask: How's it going? What are the weak parts? How can we fix those areas? And, most important, What can we do to grow?

—**Dorothy Webster,** *Humble, Texas*

It's a marathon

Go slowly, especially when it comes to debt. I have seen many gold-plated businesses fail. Debt can drown a new business before it has time to get past its growing pains.

The idea of growing slowly is that it will give you time to really get to know your business and to understand where the true opportunities lie. In my case, we had envisioned a fine-dining restaurant with table service at lunch and dinner. Instead, we found out that lunch was a low-margin business because most people skip alcohol and desserts. But an even better opportunity was right under our nose. We had an extra room that we began using for business meetings and group events. These events would usually involve preordered lunches or dinners, so our service costs were reduced, and there was usually a third-party payer, so wines and desserts were quite in fashion.

—**Joe Roberts,** *Helena, Mont.*

Customers before tech

I started my first business in college, building a Bluetooth-based tracking device and focusing, like an engineer, solely on the product and technology. Sales and marketing seemed like something you do later. Sure enough, no one bought it. My co-founder was friends with a tech founder who had just turned the corner in his business. This is where we got the simple advice: Sales solves all problems. He told us to stop focusing on the technology and focus on the customer. Tune the product that they want to buy against our vision of what we wanted to build.

—**Chris Herbert,** *Santa Barbara, Calif.*

Press on

I am a serial entrepreneur with a mix of successes and failures. Even the successes were not without significant struggles, self-doubt, ups and downs. One key insight has stayed with me, though.

After my first company crashed and burned when I ran out of money, I started a second company, which was a great idea but slightly ahead of its time. I abandoned it as early revenues were slow to pick up. A few years later, I saw that same idea taken to market by someone else, with millions of customers, and a brand that many of your readers would recognize.

During a later startup, I was talking to a successful investor in small businesses. He made what seemed to be, then, an off-the-cuff remark. "It's surprising how many entrepreneurs are successful just by sticking around long enough." As I reflected on this statement and my entrepreneurial experience, to me, this translated to persistence—never give up. I took that to heart, and that was a key learning that was part of subsequent successes. However difficult the circumstances, my persistence was a key element of my success.

—**Venkat Sharma,** *Louisville, Ky.*

Don't hire your spouse

I have some spectacular successes and spectacular failures. Here is just a little bit of what I've learned.

1. Spend at least five years working in the business you intend to start. Before you launch a restaurant, work in them for five years. The most successful founders are ones that see a new trend or creative idea from a business they are currently working in.

2. Understand tax strategy, as taxes are your No. 1 expense and your best opportunity to retain operating capital.

3. Never hire your spouse or your relatives; it discourages the other goal-achievers.

4. Drive an old pickup truck like Sam Walton. Don't be ostentatious. Be humble. Be thankful that you lucked out with the right idea at the right time. You are lucky, not brilliant.

5. The least-attractive businesses are the most profitable. Janitorial services are good.

—**Michael Lowery,** *Colorado Springs, Colo.*

Chasing Scotland's 'Mr. Tea'

Continued from Page One

sippi tea farm. Along the way, McNaughton found out he was wrong about one thing: There are legitimate tea farmers in Scotland, a country famed for its cold and cloud.

Robinson just wasn't one of them.

He was found guilty of fraud and on Wednesday was sentenced to three-and-a-half years in prison.

Few nations drink more tea than Britain, a country where "having a brew" is woven into the national identity. British colonialists helped spread tea drinking—and the growing of the plants—around the world. The World Bank valued the global tea market at around $7 billion.

Robinson wanted a piece of that.

In January 2014, he began selling "smoked white tea" to high-end hotels that he said was cultivated on his estate in Perthshire, just south of the country's Highlands area.

You can call me Mr. Tea, he told British media, having snagged what he described as top prize in the "Salon de The" global industry awards in Paris.

The tweed-wearing Robinson touted top university qualifications in agriculture and a spell as a British army bomb disposal expert.

Robinson also said he'd created a new way of growing tea plants ideal for Scotland. His tea needed less light because it was cultivated in a biodegradable polymer wrapping, he said. The breakthrough was later described in court as looking like a black trash can liner.

In early 2015, Richard Ross was in his car when he heard of Robinson's Scottish tea production on the radio. "It was a light-bulb moment," said the food and drink writer, who had land just 8 miles from Robinson's farm.

Ross went to meet Robinson, who was then going by the name of Tam O'Braan, and bought 500 tea plants for the equivalent of around $8,100.

By 2018, McNaughton's team had been contacted by local authorities who were concerned that whenever they tried to check Robinson's business, he was never home.

A former detective with a six-cups-a-day tea habit, McNaughton heads the Scottish Food Crime and Incidents Unit, a government-run consumer-protection group.

During his police career, McNaughton had worked on all manner of vile crimes, from murder to violent assaults. Food fraud can be just as serious. His team has investigated toxic fake vodka and poisonous weight-loss pills.

But they were surprised to be investigating Scottish tea, and even more so to learn the country had around 30 plantations. "I thought, my goodness, I didn't know there was one," said Ian Cowie, a senior investigator.

Over copious cups of tea, the team set to work. Some of Robinson's claims quickly unraveled. Qualifications from particular universities appeared to be incorrect. The British army had never heard of him. The Salon de The in Paris was a small cafe, not the tea industry's Oscars.

Cowie knew that Robinson was selling large amounts of tea to the Balmoral Hotel in Edinburgh and posh London store Fortnum and Mason's, claiming that it came from his own and other Scottish plantations.

After a cup of tea on a visit to a plantation in Perthshire, Cowie could see that Scottish production was very real. "It was very nice actually," he said.

Other local plantations were also selling to Robinson. But investigators questioned whether their combined production matched the amount he was passing off as Scottish.

Meanwhile tea plants sold by Robinson were struggling. Nearly a third of Ross' had died within two years.

When Cowie contacted Robinson and asked for some paperwork, he was told the documentation had been destroyed in a fire. He would later say a flood.

From 2020, McNaughton's team began submitting their evidence to prosecutors. "Scottish tea just sounded ridiculous," he said. "But such fraud can have an impact on trust."

Robinson's trial began in May. He denied the fraud charges.

That's when Jason McDonald in Mississippi received an email.

McNaughton's team wanted help for the trial in working out whether Scotland's combined crop could ever even match what Robinson was already selling as Scottish tea.

"Scotland is not the most suitable place in the world for tea," said McDonald, who grows it in Mississippi. "But it tastes great," he said.

McDonald concluded that the yield from Scotland's crop wasn't enough for the 500 kilograms of tea that Robinson had sold as Scottish.

In fact, Robinson had bought tea from Sri Lanka, Malawi and China via a London dealer and simply sold it on as Scottish at a large premium, prosecutors said.

Meanwhile, the tea bushes that Robinson said he had developed for Scotland had actually been bought in Italy.

Ross and several others have since given up cultivating Robinson's tea plants.

The swindler has become a huge headache for the Scottish tea industry, sparking online ridicule and concerns that customers will question the provenance of its brews. But he also helped.

"Oddly, he's the Godfather of the Scottish tea industry," said Islay Henderson, who has been growing tea on the hilly banks of a Scottish loch for seven years and is producing enough to sell to high-end restaurants. "He sparked people's interest in it."

▶ Thomas Robinson at his farm in the Scottish Highlands in 2016.

▶ A cafe owner prepares a pot of Robinson's 'smoked white tea.'

ROBERT PERRY/AFP/GETTY IMAGES (2)

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ARTS IN REVIEW

ARCHITECTURE REVIEW

A Building's Practical Power

The newly expanded Perry Glass Studio offers a contemporary view of an ancient art form

The studio, left; a scene from its grand opening earlier this year, below.

By Michael J. Lewis

Norfolk, Va.

You don't have to be old to know that the museum experience has changed. That phrase is itself the most radical change of all, for it assumes that a museum is not a storeroom of objects but a place where things *happen*, that its fundamental duty is to offer you an experience. This idea has already affected the internal balance of power of the contemporary museum, whose programming branch is coming to rival the curatorial in terms of prestige and clout.

This gives special interest to the Perry Glass Studio, where the visitor's experience is particularly immersive—to use the fashionable term. Yet it is not the usual zippy apology for the static array of objects on the wall or in the vitrine. If anything, it makes those objects more comprehensible, even urgent—which is quite an achievement, since you have to cross the street to see them.

The Perry Glass Studio was founded by the Chrysler Museum of Art, whose collection of some 10,000 glass objects is remarkable. It spans three millennia, providing a comprehensive history that the museum wanted to bring up to the present day. In particular it wanted to show that this history is not a closed book and that the Studio Glass Movement, which began in the 1960s, remains a vital genre of contemporary art.

Toward that end, the Chrysler acquired a nearby bank building and in 2011 converted it into a studio for contemporary glass artists and for public classes in glassblowing. That original studio has now been given a $30 million, 24,000-square-foot addition, tripling it in size and in the process transforming its meaning.

> The museum that founded the studio has some 10,000 glass objects.

I foolishly assumed that the addition would be made of glass, and so did its architects. Work Program Architects, a Norfolk-based firm, first sketched a glazed building in the tradition of the Crystal Palace and Bruno Taut's *Glashaus*. They soon discovered that the worst material for a glass studio—weirdly enough—is glass. As molten glass cools, it changes color, telling you the precise moment it can be worked and shaped. You need controlled lighting, not fickle daylight.

This was the moment, as lead architect Rob Crawshaw told me, when it became clear that the project demanded a straightforward, smoothly functioning workshop, not a symbol of itself. It is anything but flashy. Built of a coal-black brick with cream-colored terracotta trim, it is a simple two-story box, bent slightly in the middle so that its entrance points to the Chrysler across the street.

The site complicated matters. Close to sea level and prone to flooding, it forced the architects to raise their building onto a 4-foot-high earthen terrace. This was planted with native, salt-tolerant species, which act "as a green sponge" and reduce runoff. The added height compels you to traverse a long serpentine ramp to reach the entrance, or else mount several sets of steps and cross a small bridge.

The moment we enter we can see fire. The broken axis of the building "genuflects," to use Mr. Crawshaw's felicitous term, toward the studio's principal hot shop, where two melting furnaces are kept constantly burning, night and day, to maintain the 2100 degrees Fahrenheit necessary for working glass. A space of both making and teaching, it takes the form of a 200-seat black-box theater, surrounded by a balcony, and can be dramatically darkened for educational purposes. You might effectively stage "Faust" here (or any other production that would be enhanced by flames).

This is no antiseptic gallery. It is a gritty place of making, with a resolutely industrial aesthetic. The floors are of concrete and the walls brick, while the ceiling is painted black and left unfinished. The only note of color is in the prominent pipes of the sprinkler system overhead, which are painted in bright, vibrant red—the architects' "playful" way of telling the visitor not to fret about the omnipresent fire.

Bare concrete and brick are sound-reflective, and pose an acoustic challenge for artists trying to teach. The architects recognized that they could never achieve silence, not in the presence of roaring furnaces, but settled for making the human voice at least "discernible," using discreetly placed sound-absorbent panels and a perforated ceiling. They have done this sensitively and—as anyone who has listened to a glassblowing demonstration will attest—successfully.

The Perry Glass Studio does not strive to be beautiful, but to support the making of beautiful objects. At heart it is a prosaic building. But prose can be as eloquent as poetry, and a well-made tool can be a thing of beauty.

After the glassblower's demonstration, I made my way back to the Chrysler. Having watched molten glass pulled from the furnace, as mesmerizing and ominous as flowing lava, and expertly twisted at the end of the blowpipe, I found that the museum's rows of precious glass objects had acquired a different meaning. They seemed made not of lifeless matter, but of consolidated fire, charged with human effort; their silence was like that of a volcano that's dormant—not dead.

Mr. Lewis teaches architectural history at Williams College and reviews architecture for the Journal.

FROM TOP: YUZHU ZHENG; LINDSAY COLLETTE

CULTURAL COMMENTARY

A Grand Folly In Three Dimensions

By Eric Gibson

NEXT TUESDAY, July 1, is the deadline for artists to submit applications to contribute to the National Garden of American Heroes, a joint venture of the National Endowment for the Humanities and the National Endowment for the Arts. The project, proposed during the first Trump administration and revived this year, would create an outdoor display, in an as yet undetermined location, of 250 life-size statues of individuals "who have contributed to our cultural, scientific, economic and political heritage," as the NEH's April 24 press release states.

Grants of up to $200,000 per statue are available, with the subjects drawn from a wide-ranging list contained in President Trump's Jan. 18, 2021, Executive Order 13978. Applicants must "submit a two-dimensional or three-dimensional graphic representation of the preliminary concepts for up to three statues of selected individuals, accompanied by a description of the proposed project and workplan." Successful applicants will be notified by Sept. 25 and must deliver their finished statue(s) by June 1 of next year. According to Acting NEH Chairman Michael McDonald, "The projected unveiling date for the Garden is on or about July 4, 2026."

Talk about an impossible dream.

The author of this idea must imagine that artists of the caliber of Augustus Saint-Gaudens and Daniel Chester French walk the land today. They and other sculptors active during the second half of the 19th century created statues of America's great and good, some of which stand as enduring masterpieces of American art.

One of the latter is Saint-Gaudens's Farragut Monument (1877-80) in Manhattan's Madison Square Park. David Glasgow Farragut was the great naval hero of the Civil War, famous for the battle cry, "Damn the torpedoes! Full speed ahead!"

Saint-Gaudens's bronze statue of him stands atop a stone pedestal whose sides curve out to form an exedra, or high-walled bench. Farragut is posed as if on the prow of a ship, feet planted firmly on the ground, one just ahead of the other, and facing into a wind that billows his coat. The right arm hangs down, the left is flexed, hand tightly gripping a pair of binoculars. His torso rotates slightly toward his right, while his head turns in the opposite direction, his lips pursed and his gaze fixedly and determinedly staring at something in the distance. Light and shadow play across the statue, articulating the form and animating every square inch of its surface.

A good likeness the Farragut may be, but the reason it gets and holds our attention is that it is more. Saint-Gaudens has orchestrated the language of the human figure—pose, gesture, facial expression, even dress—to express ideas about his subject's character, situation and the like. In so doing, he has created both a dynamic individual active in the world and a statue that transcends time and place to embody a set of values.

I can't claim to have made a scientific study of the genre, but the contemporary sculptured figures that I've seen over the years are, by comparison, like three-dimensional snapshots—records of surface appearances, nothing more. And while their knee bones may be connected to their thigh bones, most display only a notional, something-like-this-goes-here understanding of the architecture of the human body. You get no sense of how the members function individually and as part of a whole. More broadly, even when anatomically correct, these works reflect no understanding of the expressive potential of the figure itself as a vehicle of ideas. As works of three-dimensional art, they are mostly just piles of inert matter. You look once, then quickly move on.

Blame the state of art instruction. Since the Renaissance, mastery of the human figure has been considered the indispensable prerequisite, the foundation of everything in art. Even Henri Matisse, one of the founding fathers of modern art, made life drawing integral to his practice. Yet recent decades have seen abstract and conceptual art prioritized over such traditional methods as having students work from the live model.

Augustus Saint-Gaudens's statue of David Farragut in Madison Square Park, New York.

ALAMY

Then there's the zeitgeist. The heroic mode exited American art generations ago, replaced first by irony, then grievance, both attitudes antithetical to the spirit of celebration that is the Garden's raison d'être. So the odds of this project yielding one work capable of passing the test of time in the manner of the Farragut Monument, much less 250, are, well, long.

My advice: Scrap the field-of-figures idea. Instead, hire a talented landscape architect to create a bucolic environment built around a wall etched with the names of the notables, leaving room for later additions. That's the only way to prevent the National Garden of American Heroes from becoming the Cavalcade of Kitsch.

Mr. Gibson is the Journal's Arts in Review editor.

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SPORTS

Can a Woman Run a Four-Minute Mile?

Faith Kipyegon, the world-record holder, will attempt to break the barrier this week. She'll be getting plenty of help.

By Rachel Bachman

More than 70 years ago, Roger Bannister became the first person to run a mile in under 4 minutes. And, as runners continued to obsess over the mark, several thousand more followed in his wake.

But all of them had one thing in common: They were men.

Now, for the first time, a woman is taking aim at a 4-minute mile. Faith Kipyegon, a three-time Olympic champion from Kenya, will make her attempt at the previously unimaginable target on Thursday in a closed-course event at the Stade Charléty in Paris.

"I think it will cement my legacy and also give hope to other women that everything is possible," Kipyegon said.

The question is exactly how possible. Nike, her sponsor and the event's organizer, is calling this a moonshot, and with good reason. To go under 4 minutes, the 31-year-old Kipyegon needs to slash nearly eight seconds off her current world record of 4:07.64.

Nike has supplied her with special spikes and a sleek, custom racing suit. But the most crucial element probably won't be anything she's wearing. The biggest difference-maker will likely be the pacesetters running with Kipyegon to help maintain the frenetic rhythm and shield her from wind. A spokesperson said Nike had tested different strategies and that the final formation would be revealed on Thursday.

Kipyegon has already written her name into the history books repeatedly by setting world records in the 1,500 and 5,000 meter races. But the mile remains the distance that stays in the minds of even casual weekend runners.

World Athletics President Seb Coe, who set the mile world record three times in the 1970s and 1980s, pointed out that more people have reached the summit of Mount Everest (an estimated 7,000) than achieved a 4-minute mile (about 2,100, according to Track & Field News editor Sieg Lindstrom).

"The mile still has a universal cachet," Coe said.

Nike has plenty of experience with stunts like this one. Eight years ago, it staged a race in Italy for Kenyan star Eliud Kipchoge to try to run a marathon in under two hours.

The company equipped him with state-of-the-art shoes and a phalanx of pace-setting runners tagging in and out to escort him on his way. Kipchoge missed the mark by 25 seconds at the time. But in a subsequent staged attempt two years later, he hit the historic mark on a closed course in Vienna.

Due to the highly controlled conditions, Kipchoge's effort wasn't eligible for world-record ratification—no one has run a marathon in under 2 hours in competition. The same will be true of Kipyegon's attempt. Track and field governing body World Athletics requires that world records be set in live competition.

Still, Kipyegon is throwing herself into uncharted territory for women. Trimming 7.65 seconds over the course of a mile is a monumental leap that will require every possible efficiency.

Aerodynamic drafting with the help of pacesetters could contribute to a saving of 3 to 4 seconds at 4-minute-mile pace, according to a recent academic paper written in part by two Nike-funded researchers. When Bannister broke the 4-minute barrier, he drafted closely behind two different pacers for more than 80% of the run.

Another study, published in February independently of Nike, said its calculations "suggest that Kipyegon could run ~3:59.37 with drafting provided by one pacer in front and one in back who change out with two other pacers at 800 [meters]."

Wouter Hoogkamer, one of the authors of the February study, said, "We didn't think they were going to try it this soon. But I guess if anybody's going to do it, it's going to be Faith Kipyegon."

Beyond the pacers, Kipyegon—who once won a junior title running barefoot—will also rely on a knee-length bodysuit studded with raindrop-sized nubs that Nike calls "aeronodes," which are designed to "split the air in front of Faith and create smaller eddies behind her to reduce drag." The kit includes arm and leg sleeves and a headband.

Her custom track shoes, meanwhile, feature six spikes instead of the regular five and more cushion under the forefoot. The general category of super spikes, developed with high-tech foams and carbon-fiber plates, has driven a surge in 4-minute miles among men.

Kipyegon's attempt comes as Nike seeks to rejuvenate its brand and capitalize on the rising profile of women's sports. But not everyone necessarily sees the sporting merit.

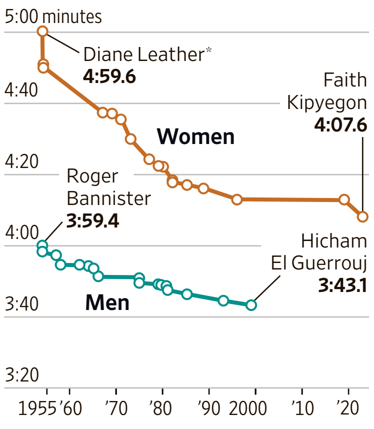
Kara Goucher, a retired U.S. Olympian and former Nike athlete who has been critical of the brand, called Kipyegon a "true prodigy," but thought that fixating on 4 minutes was misguided.

"We are focused on a woman breaking a men's barrier instead of what she has already done," Goucher wrote in an email. "She has run 4:07 in the mile. That is wayyy faster than what was ever believed that a woman could run."

Faith Kipyegon will make her attempt in Paris.

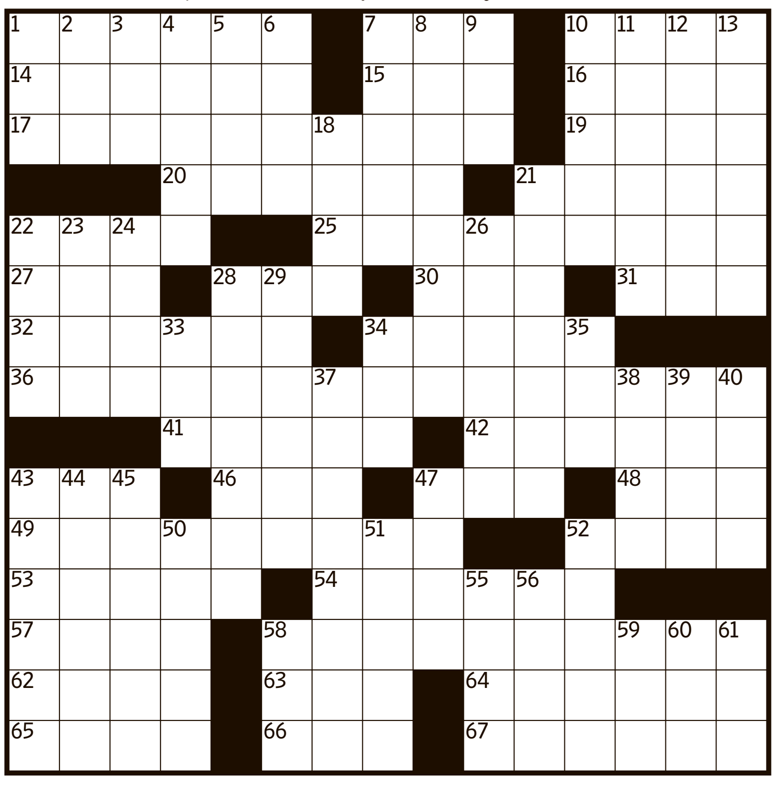
BRYAN BANDUCCI/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Mile world record progression



*World records for women weren't ratified until 1967.
Source: World Athletics

The WSJ Daily Crossword | Edited by Mike Shenk



NO KIDDING! | By Mike Shenk

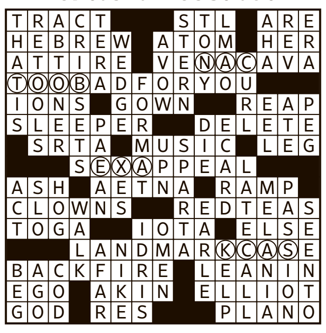
Across

1 Packs of plotters
7 "Alexander Hamilton" biographer Chernow
10 Prepare for tomorrow's test
14 Slow when playing
15 Crazy eights cousin
16 Medal recipient, maybe
17 Ground-breaking invention
19 Wide-flanged girder
20 Bullpen pitcher's job
21 Gives the cold shoulder
22 17-million-square-mile area
25 "Nicomachean Ethics" author
27 It was deorbited in 2001
28 Ukr., once
30 Key location: Abbr.
31 It may be sprinkled on les frites
32 New Englander's milkshake
34 Suffers a toe woe
36 Their faces used to appear on milk cartons (and what will explain 12 of the Down answers)
41 Short-tailed lemur
42 Brother of Lucrezia Borgia
43 Head for Vegas?
46 Wide shoe indication
47 Two-time loser to DDE
48 Make a note of
49 Virginia-to-30-Across Amtrak option
52 Low pitch
53 Respect, informally
54 Like rotini
57 Underfoot?
58 "You are so right!"
62 Home to Yeats
63 According to
64 Big name in potato products
65 Some Little League coaches
66 Ending for ethyl or methyl
67 Hound or badger

Down

1 Budget rental
2 Hoo-ha
3 Degree not offered by MIT
4 Pearl Mosque site
5 Position on a golf course
6 Spot for seeds
7 It's made to measure
8 Carat, vis-à-vis a gram
9 Also excluding
10 Stubble setting
11 Picture puzzle
12 Good for farming
13 Bite
18 Deceitful type
21 Dark-furred martens
22 Radio letters
23 Phone answerer
24 Some nest eggs
26 Water channel
28 Book parts
29 Postal party
33 Next-to-last Greek letter
34 Bot. or bio.
35 1960s activist grp.
37 Some statue subjects
38 Indian royal
39 Son of Aphrodite
40 Barclays Center team
43 Ran out
44 Colorful sky show
45 Cube or cone, e.g.
47 Have ___ (know somebody)
50 Calligrapher's stock
51 "If ___ a Boy" (Beyoncé song)
52 Tourney passes
55 Soak up
56 Quattro preceder
58 Bonobo, e.g.
59 Double, say
60 Drink suffix
61 La Brea stuff

Previous Puzzle's Solution



▶ Solve this puzzle online and discuss it at **WSJ.com/Puzzles.**

Cooper Flagg Can Do Almost Everything. Will He Save the NBA's Biggest Punchline?

By Robert O'Connell and Will Dehmel

WHEN COOPER FLAGG heard that the Dallas Mavericks had traded Luka Doncic, he had the exact same reaction as everyone else in the world.

"We just all started going crazy," Flagg said. "It was such a shock."

There's one big difference between Flagg and every other basketball fan who couldn't believe that the Mavericks had willingly sent away one of the NBA's premier superstars.

As of Wednesday night, it will be Flagg's job to replace him.

When general manager Nico Harrison officially makes his selection with the No. 1 pick of the NBA draft on Wednesday night, Flagg will become a Dallas Maverick. His role will be to rescue the franchise from one of the most calamitous decisions in pro sports history.

The most remarkable thing, though, is that Flagg might just pull it off.

Plenty of NBA draft picks enter the league with one spectacular skill that separates them from everyone else—deadeye shooting or top-grade athleticism. Teams will be lining up on Wednesday to get players they think can become ace passers or shot-blocking defensive anchors.

The difference with Flagg? He can do all of the above—and then some. Before he ever played a second of college basketball, Flagg dominated a scrimmage with Team USA's Olympic squad, leaving the world's best players shaking their heads. And last season at Duke, he carried the Blue Devils to the Final Four while leading the team in every single statistical category: points, rebounds, assists, steals and blocks per game.

"He's basically a point guard," ESPN analyst Jay Bilas said, "in a 6-foot-9 body."

Any franchise would count itself lucky to land Flagg, who has been penciled in as 2025's top pick since well before he enrolled at Duke. But for the Mavericks, who endured fan protests and widespread ridicule following the Doncic trade, Flagg represents a once-in-a-lifetime chance to undo the damage almost as quickly as it set in.

When the Mavericks traded Doncic away in February, the idea of Dallas getting Flagg seemed about as realistic as Dallas getting a ski resort. The Mavericks entered the draft lottery—which determines the order by weighted drawing—with just a 1.8% chance of getting the top pick.

Despite the long odds, Flagg was in many ways the exact type of player Harrison was chasing when he opted to dump Doncic. In explaining his decision to send a perennial MVP candidate to a conference rival, Harrison outlined his philosophy and why Doncic—an often sluggish and uninterested defender—didn't fit it.

"Defense wins championships," Harrison said. "We're hanging our hat on defense."

In his wildest dreams, Harrison couldn't have imagined that his team would match his vision so quickly. When they traded Doncic away, the Mavericks received Anthony Davis, one of the NBA's most dominant defenders, in return. Now, Harrison can add Flagg—another tenacious stopper who is capable of guarding every position on the floor—to the mix.

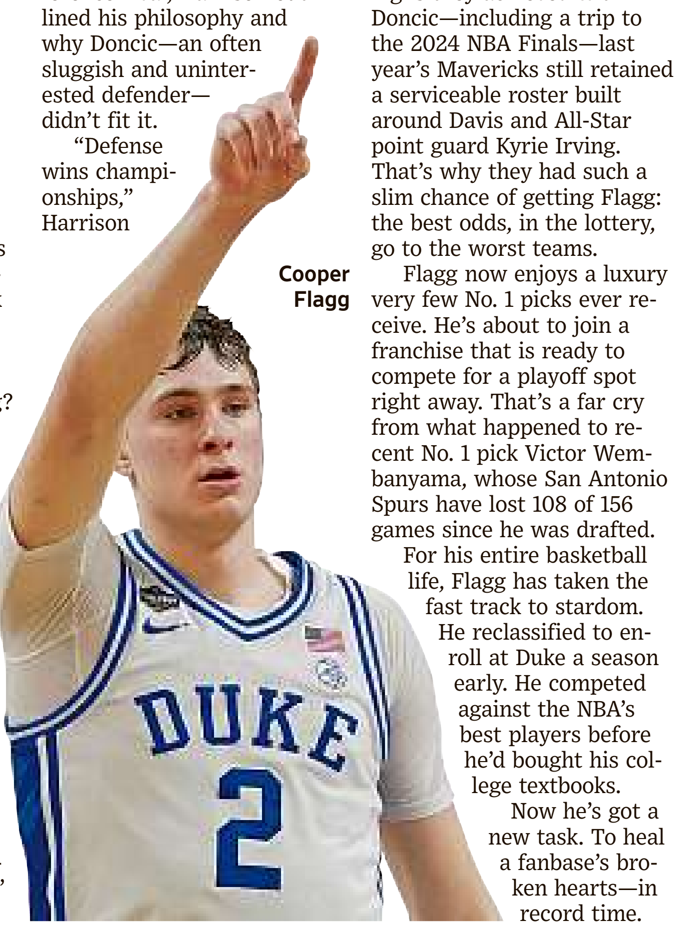
When the lottery's ping-pong balls bounced Dallas' way, last month, the entire basketball world fixated on how lucky the Mavericks were. Some conspiracy-minded fans even suggested the league had paid the franchise back for sending one of its biggest stars to one of its biggest markets.

But there's another side to Dallas' good fortune. Though they'd plummeted from the highs they achieved with Doncic—including a trip to the 2024 NBA Finals—last year's Mavericks still retained a serviceable roster built around Davis and All-Star point guard Kyrie Irving. That's why they had such a slim chance of getting Flagg: the best odds, in the lottery, go to the worst teams.

Flagg now enjoys a luxury very few No. 1 picks ever receive. He's about to join a franchise that is ready to compete for a playoff spot right away. That's a far cry from what happened to recent No. 1 pick Victor Wembanyama, whose San Antonio Spurs have lost 108 of 156 games since he was drafted.

For his entire basketball life, Flagg has taken the fast track to stardom. He reclassified to enroll at Duke a season early. He competed against the NBA's best players before he'd bought his college textbooks.

Now he's got a new task. To heal a fanbase's broken hearts—in record time.



Cooper Flagg

BRYNN ANDERSON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

OPINION

The MAGA Isolationist Mirage

By Karl Rove

Operation Midnight Hammer demonstrated the U.S. military's awesome power and dealt Iran's nuclear ambitions a severe setback. It also ignited a debate at home. Was the assault on Iran's nuclear facilities a betrayal or a furtherance of President Donald Trump's "America first" agenda?

Neo-isolationists argued Mr. Trump abandoned his MAGA base and predicted the immediate outbreak of a great Middle Eastern war. They were wrong on both counts. No ground war has erupted. Nor is one remotely likely. And there's clear evidence that Mr. Trump acted in accord with his domestic coalition, which seems in reality interventionist-minded.

Look at a poll that the Ronald Reagan Institute conducted three weeks before the B-2s unloaded their ordnance—and therefore prior to any rally-around-the-flag effect from the strikes.

The June 2 survey by Beacon Research and Shaw & Co. Research found that "when it comes to international events," 64% of Americans think it is better for the U.S. "to be more engaged and take the lead" compared with 23% who believe it's better "to be less engaged and react to events." That's a marked pro-international-involvement shift from last November, when 32% said they preferred less engagement and 57% said more.

When you dig into the partisan numbers, things look even worse for the neo-isolationist case. Among Democrats, support for being more engaged is at 65%, and among independents, 50%. The biggest supporters are Republicans—at 69%—and particularly self-identified MAGA supporters, 73% of whom are pro more engagement. Among non-MAGA Republicans, it's only 59%.

Republican support for increased engagement has risen across the board since the mid-November survey by a whopping 21 points. Again, this is due more so to Mr. Trump's base. MAGA Republican support for more engagement went up 22 points, while non-MAGA backing rose 11 points.

While neo-isolationists paint international involvement as out of fashion, the numbers say otherwise. Of any age group, it's Americans under 30 who most favor more engagement, at 68%. But no age group was below 61%.

The survey also examined four questions about America's engagement. An overwhelming 86% of respondents felt "a strong US military is essential to maintaining peace and prosperity at home and abroad," with 59% believing that strongly. There was a partisan divide—75% of Republicans and 47% of Democrats strongly agreed with the statement.

The proposition that American "leadership and engagement is essential for promoting trade and boosting our economy" likewise drew a remarkable 85%, with 49% agreeing strongly. There was little difference between the parties on this question: 54% of Republicans and 50% of Democrats strongly agreed.

Eighty-two percent of Americans also felt that the U.S. "has a moral obligation to stand up for human rights and democracy whenever possible." Fifty percent agreed strongly. There was a partisan split on this question: 63% of Democrats agreed strongly but only 42% of Republicans.

> **A recent poll belies the claim that the Trump base opposes foreign intervention.**

Lagging far behind was the proposition that the U.S. "is better served by withdrawing and focusing more attention on problems here at home." While 57% agreed across the political spectrum, only 29% felt strongly. Support for this neo-isolationist approach has dropped 5 points among Democrats and independents and 6 points among Republicans since this question was last asked, in the Reagan Institute's May 2024 poll.

These responses show Americans are capable of holding conflicting opinions. By a huge margin, they want their country to be engaged in the world and to lead. They believe that is important for trade and prosperity. They want the U.S. to stand for human rights and democracy "whenever possible." And some people can hold those views while also wanting more attention paid to challenges at home.

The Reagan Institute survey shows Americans understand the world is full of challenges: 84% are concerned about "preventing Iran from obtaining a nuclear weapon." More than 7 in 10 are worried about "a potential war between China and Taiwan," "illegal immigration across the southern border," "the war between Russia and Ukraine" and "the security of Israel."

The poll shows Americans are clear-eyed about the world and national security. We're concerned about the threats posed by our adversaries. We're certain the U.S. must lead and that our allies must step up and do their fair share, as the president is pressing North Atlantic Treaty Organization members to do.

The survey shows neither Republicans nor Americans in general are neo-isolationists. In launching Operation Midnight Hammer, Mr. Trump acted in accordance with what most Americans believe—that our great nation must be strong, dependable and engaged abroad if we're to have peace and prosperity. Most Americans believe peace comes through strength and its judicious use. The world—including opponents of the West—saw that early Sunday morning, Iran Standard Time.

Mr. Rove helped organize the political-action committee American Crossroads and is author of "The Triumph of William McKinley" (Simon & Schuster, 2015).

These Are Trump's Worst Tariffs

By Phil Gramm
And Donald J. Boudreaux

When announcing the agreement allowing Nippon Steel to acquire U.S. Steel on May 30, President Trump promised to double to 50% U.S. tariff rates on steel and aluminum. On June 3 he signed a proclamation implementing those tariffs and also applying them to the steel and aluminum content in derivative products.

While it is hard to imagine that such draconian tariffs on two essential imports could be sustained—and negotiations apparently are under way to grant Mexico a partial waiver—it is the most reckless trade action of the Trump presidency.

Because steel and aluminum are crucial in manufacturing, anything close to a 50% tariff will drive up the cost of U.S. manufactured products dramatically. That will harm consumers, make U.S. manufactured products far less competitive on the world market, and significantly increase the probability that tariffs will drag the economy into a recession. By making reciprocal trade agreements more difficult to negotiate, Mr. Trump's steel and aluminum tariffs will increase the probability of retaliation against American exports and an all-out trade war.

But these tariffs will hurt more than the economy. They will harm national security by increasing the cost of two essential components of defense procurement just as Congress is poised to increase military spending by $100 billion. The defense industry is already struggling to replace ordnance and equipment sent to Ukraine and replacing ordnance expended by Israel will add to that burden.

While total imports compose less than 14% of the U.S. economy, steel imports make up 25% of U.S. steel consumption. The U.S. imports roughly half its aluminum consumption. The new 50% tariff will have negative economic effects far larger than the original 25% tariffs in 2018. Those had carve-outs for Canada and Mexico, the largest suppliers of steel and aluminum to the U.S. Brazil and Korea were also exempt. The 2018 tariffs didn't cover derivative products that could be imported as substitutes for raw steel and aluminum. This time around prices for consumer goods, such as lawn furniture at Walmart, and producer goods, such as robots in manufacturing plants, will rise as tariffs are imposed on their steel and aluminum content.

The International Trade Commission found that the 2018 tariffs raised the domestic prices of steel and aluminum by 2.4% and 1.6%, respectively. Yet even these modest increases disrupted supply chains and inflicted real damage. From the third quarter of 2009 (the end of the great recession) through 2017, U.S. manufacturing output rose at an average quarterly rate of 0.9%. But from the first quarter of 2018, when Mr. Trump first imposed tariffs, through the end of 2019 (just before the pandemic), manufacturing output fell on average by 0.06% per quarter. Unsurprisingly, while employment in

> **The duties on steel and aluminum will hit consumers, jobs and national security.**

steel and aluminum production grew by a piddling 2,300 jobs in 2018-19, employment in manufacturing industries using steel and aluminum in their production process fell by an estimated 75,000 jobs. The job losses from the new tariffs will be many times greater. The tax on the steel and aluminum content of all imports will affect almost every U.S. trading partner, making it harder to reach reciprocal trade agreements and avoid retaliation.

The irony is that Mr. Trump is imposing tariffs in the name of national security. They will undercut his proposed defense buildup by reducing supply of the materials most critical to building the weapons on which America's security rests. As political economist Henry George observed, with protective tariffs we "do to ourselves in peace time what enemies seek to do to us in times of war." This self-imposed blockade might be warranted if the nation were dependent on steel and aluminum from potentially hostile nations. But the countries that supply the bulk of U.S. imports—Canada, Brazil and Mexico—are longtime allies and friends.

Deliverance from the 50% tariffs on steel and aluminum could come from court action finding that Congress doesn't have the authority to delegate its constitutionally prescribed powers to "lay and collect taxes, duties, imposts and excises." It could come from an extraordinary bipartisan action by Congress to take back its tariff-setting powers and void the Trump levies. Or Mr. Trump might find the political dexterity to escape this protectionist trap he has set for himself and the economy. But the most likely outcome is a recession.

Mr. Gramm is a nonresident senior fellow at the American Enterprise Institute. Mr. Boudreaux is a professor of economics at George Mason University. They are the authors of "The Triumph of Economic Freedom: Debunking the Seven Great Myths of American Capitalism." Mike Solon contributed to this article.

Socialism Is Hot in New York City

By Nicole Ault

New York

Who knows what might happen in a New York heat wave? The city is still and quiet, but the millions of people are all here, spirits and energy pent. Sights, smells and sounds are acute. It isn't surprising that E.B. White wrote "Here Is New York," a prescient vignette, in the middle of a 1948 hot spell. The city's essence is stronger in compression.

One of the great dramas of New York heat waves is fictional. But the insanity-inducing stillness is true to life in the climactic chapters of F. Scott Fitzgerald's "The Great Gatsby." The day of the book's crisis is "broiling, almost the last, certainly the warmest, of the summer." It is too hot to do anything—"too hot to fuss," says Daisy. Too hot, until the listless characters erupt in dispute, leave the Manhattan hotel where they've been languishing, and drive "on toward death."

Other dramas are all too real. In August 1896, a 10-day heat wave killed perhaps hundreds of people. Horse carcasses littered the streets, and salivating dogs were shot. William Jennings Bryan accepted the Democratic presidential nomination with a speech at sweltering Madison Square Garden. People left early in droves, and the speech flopped, writes history professor Edward Kohn in "Hot Time in the Old Town." Mr. Kohn makes the case that the heat doomed the speech that doomed Mr. Bryan's campaign.

> **Zohran Mamdani wins, but it's possible cooler heads will prevail in November.**

In July 1977, a 25-hour blackout hit the city during a heat wave. Looters and rioters brought a fine point to the city's crime problems. The disarray helped boost Ed Koch, promising law and order, to eke out a win in a seven-way Democratic mayoral primary in September. He handily won a runoff and later the general election.

This year the spell struck on primary election day. Tuesday reached 100 degrees. New Yorkers ventured through the mug to vote in the Democratic primary for mayor. Over former Gov. Andrew Cuomo, they chose the 33-year-old true socialist Zohran Mamdani, who promises city-run grocery stores, free bus rides and child care, sky-high taxes, and a $30-an-hour minimum wage.

It would be nice to call it a heat craze. Mr. Cuomo had led some polls by double digits. If "climate change" alarms rang in a few mistaken heads, didn't it also occur to anyone that socialism smacks of summer blackouts—no air conditioning? Perhaps temperatures kept older voters who might have preferred Mr. Cuomo home Tuesday. If nothing else, those ranked-choice ballots must have swum in the haze.

The result bodes ill, but the Big Apple isn't doomed. "New York is the concentrate of art and commerce and sport and religion and entertainment and finance," White wrote. "No one should come to New York to live unless he is willing to be lucky."

For all of its progressivism, New York is essentially American: thrumming with business, ingenuity and ambition, hustlers after big dreams and money. It entertains socialism, but its impulse is capitalist, believing in work and opportunity.

That impulse has curbed the worst excesses of insensible governance. Mr. Mamdani's victory in November isn't guaranteed. But even if he becomes mayor, socialism won't be the final word in New York.

Ms. Ault is an assistant editorial page writer at the Journal.

BOOKSHELF | By Steven Poole

Silence Your Phone for Real

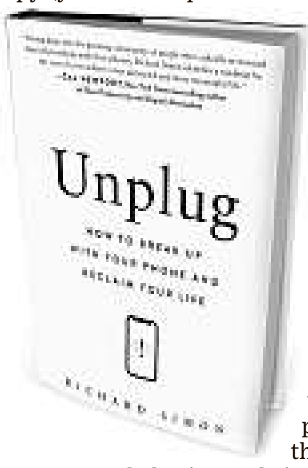
Unplug

By Richard Simon
Workman, 224 pages, $20

Don't you sometimes wish that you could throw away your smartphone? You'd be free from the doom spiral of news and social media, and more engaged with the people around you. You'd notice beautiful everyday things. Life would be so much calmer.

But then what would you do without the authenticator apps, and the banking apps, and that great camera, and your work emails? It's unthinkable. Or is it? With "Unplug," Richard Simon, a journalist and director of website strategy at Georgetown University's law school, is here to tell you that it can be done, and to explain how.

As in a 12-step program, the first thing to do is to admit that you have a problem. Our relationships with our phones are described in this book with the language of substance addiction (you need a "digital detox") or relationship therapy (you need a "phone breakup"), and the cure is quasi-religious: You should "ritualize" things like reading or even daydreaming.



Mr. Simon recommends beginning by going cold turkey: He switched off his own smartphone for 12 months, having warned friends and family, and advises the reader to disconnect for at least 60 days. Once you have struggled through the worst of the "withdrawal," you can decide whether you want to use a "basic phone" (one without internet services) or perhaps try to "reintegrate" the smartphone (as though it were a paroled prisoner being helped to live again in civil society) while being more "mindful" of how you use it. There is pseudoscientific talk of the neurotransmitter dopamine as the molecule that smartphones evilly target and how the technology manipulates us on a chemical level. In Mr. Simon's view, addicts should be wary of behaviors that replace one source of surging dopamine with another—if you dump your phone but watch endless YouTube videos on your laptop, you're no better off.

Beware, too, the "digital hack," a strategy to keep your phone but make it less pleasant to use, such as simply switching the display to grayscale. (I have done this. It is surprising how much less interesting it becomes to consume gobbets of pseudonymous rage on X or Facebook.) Like many an addiction counselor, Mr. Simon thinks such small-scale efforts are less likely to succeed than total abstention. His book draws thumbnail case studies from many interviews with smartphone refuseniks, from the Philadelphia Phillies right fielder Nick Castellanos to the novelist Kate Emmons and the chess grandmaster Wesley So. Mr. Simon betrays a rather puritan extremism: The monk-like heroes of the narrative are those who go whole hog and absent themselves from any portable long-distance communication at all. Personally, I wasn't sure that the guy who takes his 1-year-old son on mountain hikes without bringing a cellphone deserved to be in line for Father of the Year.

The book is written in a friendly and encouraging style, and offers many observations that might spark sober recognition in any reader. "The time you take looking at the screen is time you don't get back," one media professor tells Mr. Simon. "It's almost like I want something in that junk food category in my brain," a software engineer confesses. The sight of parents ignoring their children in favor of their phones is the subject of the author's recurring laments. Kindly but firmly, Mr. Simon insists: "Unless you're working at the State Department there is no need for you to be checking news throughout the day."

> **Even landlines were once understood as a problematic distraction. Alexander Graham Bell didn't allow a phone in his study.**

Even before smartphones, Mr. Simon notes, their landline predecessors were accused of hindering attention. Alexander Graham Bell did not allow a telephone in his study: After all, that's where he went to concentrate on his work.

"Unplug" reflects the growing interest in an alternative to the always-on life. There is now a market, for instance, for premium, not-so-smart devices such as the Light Phone ("designed to be used as little as possible," its advertisements say reassuringly) or the button-festooned Punkt phone. A reader might worry, however, that following Mr. Simon's advice is going to be easier for the relatively privileged. For a start, there's the list of new gear he says you'll need to buy: not just a basic phone but also a nice compact camera (because the cameras on dumbphones are terrible), a sheaf of paper maps (no GPS for you) and something to play music or podcasts on. (Mr. Simon recommends a screenless device, called the Mighty, that essentially reinvents the old iPod Shuffle for Spotify users.)

Giving up a smartphone (or, at minimum, leaving it switched off) is not going to be an option for those who rely on low-paid "gig economy" work such as Uber or delivery drivers, or anyone whose employer expects them to be rapidly answering work messages as they come in. The biggest problem with this book's arguments is that they make individuals responsible for resisting the blandishments of smartphone tech, when its intrusive demands are often mandated by forces outside their control.

This is recognized by some polities: In France, for example, employers are forbidden from emailing their workers outside of agreed-on office hours. But as long as such guardrails are not imposed from above, there will remain a lot of people involuntarily tethered to the surveillance devices in their pockets, and it seems rather unkind to blame it on their own weak wills.

Notwithstanding such criticisms, this book contains a lot of good advice: You should go for aimless walks without checking social media, or play golf, or bring a book to read if you are dining alone at a restaurant. Watch your children play sports without ravenously scrolling an endless feed. Listen to music attentively. Grow vegetables in your backyard. "This idea of getting out of your house to do meaningful activities is a critical step in filling your time," Mr. Simon advises. Apparently things have got so bad that we need a therapeutic manual to learn how to live like a normal person from 20 years ago.

Mr. Poole is the author of "Rethink: The Surprising History of New Ideas."

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OPINION

REVIEW & OUTLOOK

The Great Medicaid Hospital Scam

Republicans can fix a tax scheme that fleeces taxpayers.

No industry other than perhaps higher education feasts more on government than hospitals. So it's no surprise that hospitals are blaring their sirens over the GOP's effort to clamp down on the scheme they use to grab more federal Medicaid money.

It's hard to think of a bigger government-sanctioned racket than Medicaid provider taxes. States pioneered these during the 1980s to obtain more federal Medicaid matching funds and reduce spending on the program from their general tax revenue. The free lunch has enabled states to expand benefits and greatly diminished the incentive to operate the program efficiently.

Here's how it works: States assess taxes on health providers—namely hospitals. They then channel the revenue back into their Medicaid programs to draw more federal money. For every dollar that states spend on Medicaid, they get one to three dollars more from the feds—and nine for able-bodied individuals covered under ObamaCare. Hospitals then receive more in Medicaid payments than they pay in the provider taxes.

In 1991 George H.W. Bush signed bipartisan legislation to crack down on this scheme, which even Nancy Pelosi and Chuck Schumer voted for. The law forbids Medicaid taxes that have the effect of holding providers harmless—as nearly every state tax today does.

Even the Biden Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services in 2023 noted that providers have struck agreements to redistribute their Medicaid payments to other providers to ensure they all recoup their tax payments—including those that don't treat Medicaid patients. Is this political collusion in plain sight? Yes.

As CMS explained, "the redistribution enables broad support for the tax program from all hospitals." Such arrangements are illegal under the 1991 law, but the Clinton Administration created a regulatory safe-harbor that sanctions provider taxes as long as they are assessed at a rate of less than 6% on net patient revenue.

Enter Republicans, who are seeking to crack down on the scam. The House tax bill freezes provider taxes at current rates. The Senate Finance draft would go further by reducing the safe harbor tax rate by 0.5% annually starting in 2027 to 3.5% in states that have expanded Medicaid under ObamaCare. Taxes would be frozen in non-expansion states.

Cue the howls from the hospital lobby. Since when does an industry protest a tax cut for itself? Hospitals claim any restrictions on the taxes will cause rural hospitals to close, but they say the same about all Medicaid reforms, including work requirements. Congress can appropriate money specifically for rural hospitals if Members are worried about their vitality.

Medicaid often pays below the cost of care, but supplemental state payments funded by provider taxes more than compensate. Such payments made up a large share of earnings last year of for-profit hospitals such as Universal Health Services (45%), Tenet (25%) and HCA (18%). Most hospitals are prospering.

One reason is that government regulations have encouraged hospitals to merge and buy physician practices, which increases their leverage with insurers. Since 2010, prices charged by hospitals have increased 97%, compared to 31% for physicians, 42% for prescription drugs, while overall inflation has been 48%, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics.

Medicare also pays hospitals higher rates than independent physicians for the same treatments. The federal 340B program lets hospitals buy medicines at steep discounts and charge markups to private insurers. Republicans have shrunk from targeting these undeserved hospital perks, so the least they could do is stop hospitals from their dishonest Medicaid scheme.

Trump Wins the Battle of NATO

The alliance sets a 5% of GDP target, though a Ukraine decision looms.

America has long asked its European allies to spend more on their own self-defense. So the astonishing news out of this week's North Atlantic Treaty Organization summit is the near unanimity: NATO allies have agreed to devote 5% of their economies to military spending, up from the current 2% floor.

President Trump called the NATO plan "a big one for Europe and for actually Western civilization," and for once he may not be overselling. The allies will aim to spend 3.5% of GDP on hard military power by 2035. For the remaining 1.5 percentage points, countries can count peripheral but still useful investment such as hardening cyber defenses.

Mark Rutte is catching flak for praising Mr. Trump, but the NATO Secretary General was correct to give the President credit. "Would you ever think," Mr. Rutte asked reporters, "that this would be the result of this summit if he would not have been re-elected President?"

It's a fair point. A President Kamala Harris might have shown more politeness and avoided futile public spats. But what matters is whether the alliance has the will and the means to defend itself.

No question the 5% will be a heavy lift for some NATO laggards. Spain, which spent 1.28% of its economy on defense in 2024, is already trying to duck the agreement. Others on the dishonor roll include Slovenia (1.29%); Belgium (1.3%); and Canada (1.37%), though Ottawa is now promising to do better.

The 5% figure wasn't pulled from thin air. Mr. Rutte has been pressing the case that the target is rooted in the hardware needed to protect the continent. The specifics are classified, but Mr. Rutte says the shopping list includes:

"A five-fold increase in air defence capabilities. Because we see Russia's deadly terror from the skies over Ukraine every day, and we must be able to defend ourselves from such attacks. Thousands more tanks and armored vehicles. Because even though warfare is changing fast, we still need to be able to protect our soldiers on the battlefield, and to maneuver. And millions of rounds of artillery ammunition, because it is by having these stockpiles that we can deter aggression from any threat."

Hear, hear to that clear strategic thinking, long overdue from Europe. Left out at the summit, however, is whether Mr. Trump is prepared to help Europe arm Ukraine as Russia refuses to end its brutal assault. The President's strike against Iran bolstered deterrence, but the Ukraine decision is phase two.

The People's Republic of New York City

Mamdani's victory signals the rise of leftwing populism.

The easy victory by Zohran Mamdani in Tuesday's Democratic mayoral primary marks a sharp left turn for New York City. But perhaps more important is that it signals the rise of leftwing economic populism as a leading alternative to the MAGA Republicans.

Democrats nationwide have been debating how to respond to their defeats in 2024, and the victory by the 33-year-old assemblyman is a triumph for the Bernie Sanders-Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez faction. Mr. Mamdani's 43.5% plus 11.3% for progressive Brad Lander gave the left a clear majority. Andrew Cuomo, the former Governor and establishment favorite, had a disappointing 36.4%.

This was the first round of a ranked-choice voting primary, but Mr. Mamdani's lead is large enough that he will be the Democratic standard bearer in November's general election. We keep hearing that ranked-choice voting will yield moderate candidates. But in practice it appears to magnify what primary elections already are: events for highly motivated partisans who closely follow politics.

Mr. Mamdani is charismatic and a fluent communicator on social media. He won easily among young progressives, while Mr. Cuomo carried the traditional Democrats on Manhattan's Upper West Side and eastern Queens. Mr. Mamdani's main theme is affordability, and it resonated in a city that is increasingly unaffordable for the middle-class.

The irony is that this "affordability crisis" is the result of failed Democratic governance. Rent control and eviction limits have caused landlords to take tens of thousands of apartments off the market. A higher minimum wage raised the cost of food and other basics, while rich union contracts keep transportation inefficient and costly. Climate bans and mandates have raised energy costs.

Mr. Mamdani's solution is more socialism. He wants even higher taxes on already overtaxed businesses and high earners (top city tax rate: 14.78%), government-run grocery stores, free bus rides, and a mandatory freeze on 43% of the city's rental units. These policies won't work, but they sound appealing to Democrats who don't think New York works now.

The November election could be crowded, with Mayor Eric Adams running as an independent and radio host Curtis Sliwa as the GOP nominee. Mr. Cuomo has left the door open to an independent run, but his best service would be to drop out. He is a spent political force who thought he could win with a famous name and being Mamdani-lite on pensions, the minimum wage and more.

If Mr. Cuomo stays in the race, he could divide the anti-Mamdani vote. The best chance to beat Mr. Mamdani is with a united-front campaign that rallies behind a single candidate, though even that is probably a long shot.

Mr. Mamdani declared himself on election night to be "a model for the Democratic Party," and among the party base he may be. He echoes all of the leftwing social policies that hurt the party in 2024, and on Israel he sounds like Columbia University demonstrators. It's hard to believe the most Jewish city in America could elect a mayor who favors a boycott of Israel, but that is today's Democratic Party.

The populist left poses obvious problems for national Democrats who want to move the party back toward the middle. But Republicans would be wise not to gloat. If Trumponomics fails to deliver strong growth and gains in real incomes, the leftwing populists will be waiting as the main alternative.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

It's Time to Revisit the President's War Powers

For now the question whether President Trump needed congressional authorization to take military action against Iran is academic. Nevertheless, Peggy Noonan is right that the framers vested Congress, not the president, with the power to declare war ("Iraq's Shadow Over the Iran Debate," Declarations, June 21).

That power is in tension with the fact, underscored by the Supreme Court's Civil War-era *Prize Cases*, that the president has not merely the authority but the duty to quell foreign threats to American national security and vital interests. The matter of whether there is such a viable threat is a political one, left by the Constitution to officials electorally accountable to the people whose lives are at stake. It is nonjusticiable: Congress must vindicate its own authority because the courts won't.

To be sure, Mr. Trump had authority to strike based on how the post-9/11 Authorization for the Use of Military Force has been used over the past quarter-century, and because Iran's proxies, such as the Houthis in Yemen, have recently been attacking Americans. Moreover, the congressmen Ms. Noonan touts for pushing an Iran-focused AUMF as a precondition for military action—Reps. Thomas Massie (R., Ky.) and Ro Khanna (D., Calif.)—seem to be motivated more by their opposition to military intervention in Iran than by good constitutional hygiene.

Regardless, with the crisis hopefully in the rearview, we should recognize that the 2001 AUMF has proved too sweeping and open-ended a delegation of congressional war power to the commander in chief. Twenty-four years later, given that many targets of U.S. combat operations under the AUMF's auspices weren't in existence when the 9/11 atrocities occurred, it is time to repeal that provision.

Congress should enact a new AUMF, tailored to international terrorism as it exists today. If the president believes it necessary to use force outside such parameters, he should in the absence of a true emergency seek a separate congressional authorization.

Andrew C. McCarthy
National Review
New York

Why a Medicaid Penalty Would Prove Costly

The Senate's reconciliation bill, which would reduce the federal Medicaid match for states that cover certain healthcare services for immigrants living in the U.S. unlawfully, may sound like a way to cut federal spending. In reality, it would increase healthcare costs, strain emergency rooms and make healthcare worse for all ("Blue States Reverse Course on Insuring Undocumented," U.S. News, June 20).

Consider that outpatient dialysis costs about $90,000 a year, while emergency inpatient dialysis can exceed $300,000 annually. That extra cost falls on hospitals, state budgets and, ultimately, the taxpayer. That's why 20 states, both Democratic- and Republican-led, have chosen to provide outpatient dialysis through Medicaid. It isn't about immigration policy or a gesture of generosity; it is fiscally responsible. Patients with kidney failure need dialysis three times a week to survive. Immigrants here unlawfully typically can't access private insurance or Medicaid. That doesn't mean they go without care; it means they show up in emergency rooms when their condition is life-threatening. Under federal law, hospitals must treat anyone in an emergency, regardless of immigration or insurance status.

The proposed Medicaid penalty would make it harder for states like Delaware to provide more-efficient care. This means higher healthcare costs, increased strain on emergency rooms and longer wait times for everyone. Immigration enforcement is a separate issue that should remain under federal jurisdiction. Yet denying states the tools to deliver the most cost-effective care to people who are already here doesn't fix immigration; it makes our healthcare system worse for everyone.

Gov. Matt Meyer
Dover, Del.

Neil Hockstein, M.D.
Delaware Health Care Commission
Wilmington, Del.

A Beautiful Land Sale Is a Boon for Families

A limited sale of federal lands that can be used for much-needed housing is long overdue ("America's Big, Beautiful Land Sale," Review & Outlook, June 20). The extension of neighborhoods into new territory is one of the best predictors of housing affordability in U.S. metro areas, and keeping market-rate housing accessible for young Americans is crucial for family formation. When cities are land-constrained, home prices skyrocket. Young people loiter in their parents' basements, marry later and have fewer children. When land constraints are a product of physical barriers, little can be done. But when policy barriers, like liberal-favored urban growth boundaries or rings of federal landholdings around cities, constrain availability, the problem can be solved.

The Senate's bill proposes to sell a trivial share of federal lands through a transparent process that gives states and localities say over how land sales proceed. It would also impose restrictive covenants forcing sales to be used for new neighborhoods. That's as it should be. Nobody wants America's pristine landscapes auctioned for elite hunting estates. Nor do citizens want localities stripped of federal land access that has been a basis of their commerce and tourism for generations.

If developers can navigate the bill's requirements and build new neighborhoods, it will be a boon for American families. Housing supplies in federally landlocked cities are able to grow at a faster rate, making it easier to buy that starter home with a yard most Americans want for their new families.

Lyman Stone
Institute for Family Studies
Lexington, Ky.

Give Chester Arthur His Due

In his review of the third season of "The Gilded Age" (Arts in Review, June 20), John Anderson refers to the "undistinguished political era of Chester Alan Arthur." Yet Arthur's less than one full-term in office (he succeeded James A. Garfield, who died in September 1881, after having been shot in July), included major civil-service reform and naval expansion. It saw the Pendleton Act of 1883, which established the Civil Service Commission; the establishment of the Office of Naval Intelligence (1882), the oldest military intelligence service in the country; and the creation of the Naval War College (1884). The main black mark against his administration was the Chinese Exclusion Act (1882), which he signed reluctantly after having vetoed an earlier version.

The same period also saw the entry into politics of another New Yorker whose career would be anything but "undistinguished:" Theodore Roosevelt.

Roger Ritter
Alexandria, Va.

We've Already Hit the Iceberg

Regarding your editorial "The Social Security Iceberg Gets Closer" (June 20): In reality the iceberg has been tearing open the hull of our "ship" ever since the Social Security trust began drawing down its fund reserves in 2021. The fund is filled with special issue securities that it presents to the Treasury for payment. Since we are already running a budget deficit, this payment is made possible by Treasury's issuing more debt. All the fund has done is add a step. This creates the illusion that, for now, the problem of payroll-tax revenues running below benefits payments is being dealt with. It isn't. The day after the fund runs out will be no different than the day before. Either way, more water will have flowed into the hull, thereby ushering in the day that the ship sinks.

David C. Rose
American Inst. for Economic Research
St. Louis

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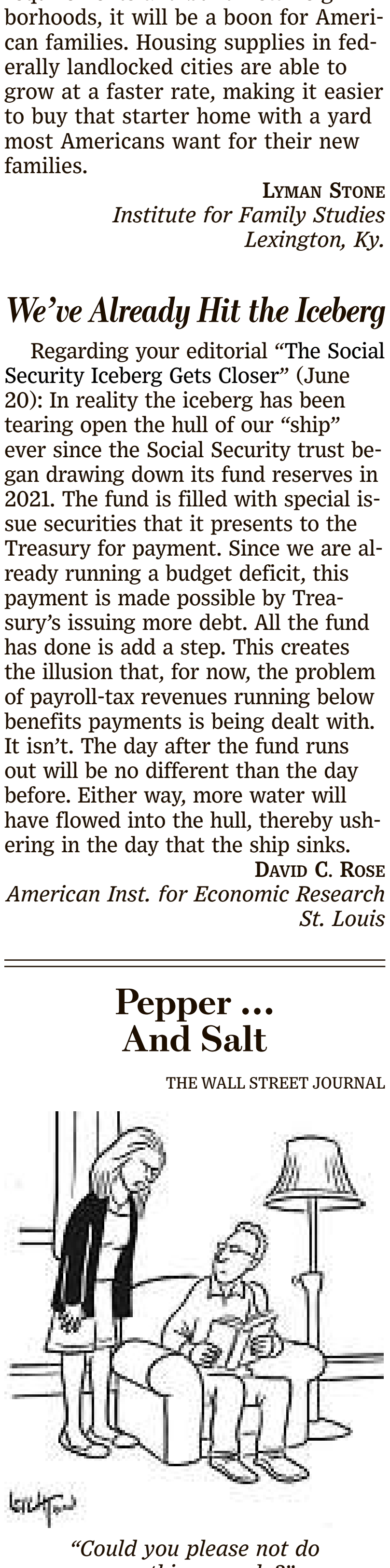
Pepper ... And Salt

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL



"Could you please not do everything you do?"

Attacks ‘Effectively Destroyed’ Iran’s Program

This is an excerpt from “Post-Attack Assessment of the First 12 Days of Israeli Strikes on Iranian Nuclear Facilities” published June 24 by David Albright and Spencer Faragasso of the Institute for Science and International Security.

After 12 days of military operations, a survey of the resulting damage is appropriate. . . . Overall, Israel’s and U.S. attacks have effectively destroyed Iran’s centrifuge enrichment program. It will be a long time before Iran comes anywhere near the capability it had before the attack. That being said, there are residuals such as stocks of 60%, 20%, and 3-5% enriched uranium and the centrifuges manufactured but not yet installed at Natanz or Fordow. These non-destroyed parts pose a threat as they can be used in the future to produce weapon-grade uranium.

Complicating any effort to turn weapon-grade uranium into nuclear explosives have been extensive attacks against Iran’s facilities and personnel to make the nuclear weapon itself. Its infrastructure to build the nuclear weapon has been severely damaged. The time Iran would need to build even a non-missile deliverable nuclear weapon has increased significantly.

In particular, major setbacks include: the elimination of, or severe damage to, the majority of the centrifuges at the Natanz site, significant damage to the Fordow underground site, destruction and damage to several facilities at the Esfahan Nuclear Complex. . . . The attack on the IR-40 Arak Heavy Water Reactor has likely destroyed the reactor, eliminating a potential future source of plutonium that could be used in nuclear weapons. . . .

Further damage assessments are needed for some of the sites, particularly underground sites. Israeli intelligence would be expected to be hunting in Iran, even under the ceasefire, for non-destroyed residuals. . . .

Natanz Nuclear Complex

The Natanz complex was Iran’s primary uranium enrichment site. . . . The underground halls can be characterized as the “workhorse” of Iran’s enrichment program focused on producing less than 5% enriched uranium. The above ground pilot plant is Iran’s principal centrifuge research and development facility and was also producing 60% enriched uranium.

On June 13, the Institute reported on the Israeli strikes to Natanz, highlighting the destruction of the Pilot Fuel Enrichment Plant and the onsite electrical infrastructure. The loss of electrical power is likely to have caused damage to the centrifuges in the underground Fuel Enrichment Plant (FEP). A subsequent review of satellite imagery from June 14 showed two or three small explosive impact craters on the surface over the FEP halls, leading to a reassessment that substantially more damage likely occurred in the initial attack to the underground enrichment plant. . . .

This assessment is in line with the next day’s statement released by the IAEA Director General Rafael Mariano Grossi that “on the same day [of the attack], the main cascade hall appears to have been attacked using ground-penetrating munitions . . . the strikes on the underground cascade halls were seriously damaging.” . . .

The site was attacked again early on June 22, this time by the United States. Satellite imagery shows at least one penetration hole located above the buried enrichment hall caused by a GBU-57 bunker buster. It is reported by the U.S. Department of Defense that at least two GBU-57’s (MOP) attacked the site, possibly in an attack where one followed the other through the same penetration hole in a “double tap” strike. As a result, the site is likely destroyed and knocked out of operation. No damage was observed in satellite imagery of the complex being constructed underneath Mt. Kolang Gaz La.

Fordow Enrichment Plant

Fordow enrichment site is a deeply buried uranium enrichment site associated with the production of highly enriched uranium . . . revealed in 2009 by Western leaders. Iran promptly declared it as a civil facility dedicated to making low enriched uranium and allowed international inspection. Inspectors who soon after visited the site reported that the internal pipework, equipment, and uranium feed stations were in line with a site to make weapon-grade uranium. On the next visit by inspectors, all the pipework and other equipment associated with weapon-grade uranium production had been removed, with the Iranians giving the excuse that the ceiling needed to be repainted. . . .

The Institute for Science and International Security sizes up the results of the U.S. and Israeli strikes.

In a striking attack in the early morning of June 22, the U.S. dropped twelve MOPs over the deeply buried enrichment halls. High-resolution satellite imagery taken post attack shows two groups of three penetration holes on the mountain above the enrichment halls. This set of holes are at the location of the ventilation shaft of the underground complex and at the location of previously identified service-related structures that lay above the cascade hall, enabling easier pathways for the MOPs to the deeply buried halls. As a result, the facility is likely severely damaged or destroyed. . . .

It appears that the bombing was precisely targeted to concentrate on two likely points of vulnerability. . . . The first point target is what can generally be termed as a ventilation “shaft” but is likely a more elaborate structure, which connects subsurface with a central hallway leading to the two main underground halls shown in the plot plan housing both equipment and centrifuges. The second point target is located on the other side of the mountain ridge. . . . [It] not only completely destroyed [a] surface structure but was likely intended to focus at depth on the south end of centrifuge cascade hall, which, once breached, would use the hall’s long side walls to channel the blast wave through the entire length of centrifuge cascade hall completely destroying all of the installed and otherwise operational centrifuges. Interestingly, the bomb blast waves that would have been generated down the two halls from these two points of attack run perpendicular to one another, further increasing the likelihood of maximum damage and destruction. . . .

It is possible that the Iranians tried to move the enriched uranium kept at the site. Dismantling and transporting some of the installed centrifuges, or at least their rotor assemblies, may also have occurred, but this process is complex and time consuming and may have damaged centrifuges. . . .

In a follow up attack, Israel struck the site on the night of June 22/23, reportedly targeting access routes to the facility, in order to obstruct access to the Fordow site, but as yet we are unable to confirm from imagery available to us.

Esfahan Nuclear Complex

The Esfahan complex has been targeted three times, twice by Israel and once by the U.S. Extensive damage has been done to the site.

The first attack was on June 14. Satellite imagery from the day of the strike shows damage to four buildings at the uranium conversion complex; the enriched uranium metal conversion plant was destroyed, a possible Shipping and Receiving Building was severely damaged, the Tehran Reactor Fuel Manufacturing Plant (FPFP) was partially damaged, and the Central Chemical Laboratory was also partially damaged. . . .

The enriched uranium metal conversion line, which converts uranium tetrafluoride into enriched uranium metal, is a key capability in making weapon-grade uranium cores of nuclear weapons. This line had been tested with 20% enriched uranium and could process any 90% enriched uranium. Destruction of this facility would cause a bottleneck in any effort by Iran to build nuclear weapons, requiring Iran to build a new clandestine one, if it wanted nuclear weapons, a risky and potentially time-consuming step.

The Tehran Reactor Fuel Manufacturing Plant (aka FPFP) can make natural uranium metal. This facility also stores(ed) 20% and 60% enriched uranium. . . .

A second attack was carried out on the night of June 20/21. The IAEA reported on June 21, “six other buildings at the same site have now also been attacked: a natural and depleted uranium metal production facility which had not yet begun operations, a fuel rod production facility, a building with low-enriched uranium pellet production as well as a laboratory and nuclear material storage, another laboratory building, a workshop handling contaminated equipment and an office building. . . .”

The next night, on June 22, the U.S. attacked the site with Tomahawk cruise missiles launched from a submarine. . . . Notably, the main uranium conversion facility that converts natural uranium into uranium hexafluoride was severely damaged. Uranium hexafluoride is the form of uranium entered into gas centrifuges. Tunnel entrances leading to an underground complex [rumored to hold stockpiles of enriched uranium] just north of the main Esfahan complex were also struck during the attack. All four tunnel entrances appear to have collapsed. The IAEA also assessed that “extensive damage” was done to the tunnel entrances.

America’s Long Road From Osirak to Fordow

By Elliott Abrams

The U.S. and Israel have long been allies, but Washington hasn’t always been friendly to the Jewish state’s efforts to stop the development of nuclear weapons by its enemies in the Middle East.

When Israel struck the Iraqi nuclear program on June 7, 1981, the U.S. was as surprised as the Iraqis. The Israelis had given no notice. The Reagan administration—in which I served as an assistant secretary of state—was split over how to react. I remember the attitude Secretary of State Alexander Haig showed in private: The strike against the Osirak reactor had been a terrific show of military power. Defense Secretary Caspar Weinberger urged an end to all aid to Israel. President Reagan suspended delivery of F-16 jets scheduled for days later. Reagan’s heart wasn’t in it, he quickly reversed himself, and Israel got the planes.

I was there when the U.S. condemned Israel’s strike against Iraq in 1981. A lot has changed in 44 years.

Impossible to reverse was United Nations Security Council Resolution 487, which “strongly condemns” the “premeditated Israeli air attack.” The U.S. voted for it. Jimmy Carter’s record of allowing or joining Security Council votes against Israel had elicited a scalding December 1980 Washington Post editorial titled “Joining the Jackals” and a February 1981 Commentary article of the same title by Sen. Daniel Patrick Moynihan. The U.N. ambassador who cast the U.S. vote for the condemnation of Israel over its elimination of the Iraqi reactor was Jeane Kirkpatrick, who had famously criticized Carter’s foreign policy in Commentary.

Defending her vote against Israel, Jeane sent a cable to Washington ending with these words: “I am not joining the jackals; The UN is for real.” I thought she had joined them. Jeane had been a family friend for many years, and our relationship never fully recovered.

By 2007, when Israel struck the Syrian nuclear program, the U.S. attitude had evolved. After discovering the reactor under construction in the desert near Al-Kibar in eastern Syria, the Israelis immediately shared the intelligence with the U.S. They sent the head of the Mossad, Meir Dagan, to Washington, where Vice President Dick Cheney, national security adviser Steve Hadley and I (Mr. Hadley’s deputy for the Middle East) met with him. He showed us the intelligence and told us Israel was firm that the reactor had to go.

During months of intelligence work and military planning by the U.S. and Israel, President George W. Bush held several meetings in the East Wing’s Yellow Oval Room. On June 17, the president asked for views. Defense Secretary Robert Gates and Secretary of State Condoleezza Rice urged diplomacy: Let the U.N. handle this. Mr. Cheney urged a U.S. strike; I suggested an Israeli strike. The president made his decision a few weeks later and called Israel’s Prime Minister Ehud Olmert on July 13. He said he had decided on the diplomatic option: There would be no strikes by the U.S. or Israel, and instead we would go to the United Nations.

Mr. Olmert rejected the idea of turning Israel’s security over to the U.N. and told Mr. Bush that if the U.S. wouldn’t strike, Israel would. Mr. Bush immediately accepted that decision and told Mr. Hadley and me to drop the diplomatic preparations and maintain absolute secrecy. Mr. Olmert later told me, and I agreed, that Mr. Bush expected and fully approved Israel’s decision to eliminate the Syrian reactor.

The Iraq and Afghanistan wars were hot, the Central Intelligence Agency wouldn’t say with “high confidence” that the reactor was part of a nuclear-weapons program, and the president would have had to reject the strong advice of both Ms. Rice and Mr. Gates to order a strike or agree in advance to an Israeli one. Instead, the president let Mr. Olmert decide, hung up the phone, and told Mr. Hadley and me: “That guy has guts.”

ABIR SULTAN/EPA-EFE/SHUTTERSTOCK

A billboard in Tel Aviv.

So the U.S. moved in 26 years from condemnation of a surprise Israeli attack on the Iraqi reactor to knowledge and effective approval of the Israeli strike on the Syrian reactor. Another 18 years later, the U.S. actually joined the effort to destroy the Iranian nuclear program. What explains this progression?

Relations between the U.S. and Israel grew closer in those four decades, except in the Obama years. American officials and analysts more broadly understood Israel’s value as an ally. U.S. aid budgets grew. Israel joined the U.S. Central Command and began to coordinate through it with Arab armed forces. It became increasingly obvious that Iran was a deadly enemy of the U.S. and the greatest state supporter of terrorism, and its growing alignment with Russia and China made it more dangerous.

It was also increasingly clear that Iran meant it when it said “Death to Israel.” Tehran built a “ring of fire” around the Jewish state with proxies such as Hamas and Hezbollah. The effort to stop the Iranian nuclear weapons program through negotiations produced only the Obama nuclear agreement, which permitted Iran to enrich uranium, didn’t constrain its missile program, and was only a temporary measure that would expire in 2030.

Iran kept on building, enriching uranium to 60% when there is no use for such levels of enrichment except a weapon, building thousands of advanced centrifuges, and hiding the program from the International Atomic Energy Agency. The IAEA’s May 2025 report showed that Iran was moving forward and had nine bombs’ worth of highly enriched uranium—and President Trump concluded that there was no way to stop them through talks. They refused any deal that would end their enrichment of uranium.

This time, the combination of dangers and experiences brought the U.S. to act on the principle presidents had enunciated decade after decade: Iran could never be permitted to build a nuclear weapon. This time, Israeli action wasn’t condemned or tacitly approved but followed and built on. Forty-four years after Israel was left to deal with the Iraqi nuclear threat alone, the Iranian nuclear-weapons program is in ruins thanks to America’s help.

Mr. Abrams is a senior fellow for Middle Eastern studies at the Council on Foreign Relations and served in the Reagan, George W. Bush and first Trump administrations.

Is the Fed Ready for an AI Economy?

By Derek Horstmeyer

Federal Reserve presidents have been clear about their concerns regarding artificial intelligence’s possible effects on productivity, banking customer service, and upheaval in the labor market.

But the Fed may be ignoring another AI issue that could turn out to dwarf all others: AI’s coming ability to create money and credit—and thereby determine the money supply in our economy.

This may sound like science-fiction, but AI will likely begin to control the extension of credit, and in effect the money supply, in the next few years. That’s a major issue for the Fed if it can’t easily observe the manner in which AI makes its decisions or constrain it to follow the central bank’s underlying interest-rate policies.

Here’s how it will work: Individual users will start with personal-assistant AIs, as many of us already have. As guardrails are established on AI’s behavior and their actions refined, users will employ them as purchasing agents, giving them the authority to use credit on behalf of the user.

On the banking side, business operations on the decision to extend credit or not will start to be tasked to AIs. These AIs will assess creditworthiness and make an assessment to create a loan or authorize a credit purchase. The aggregation of millions of such decisions will make AI a major influence on the expansion or contraction of the money supply.

Most likely this will first take place in the “shadow banking” part of the economy—lightly regulated fintech companies that are experimenting with new forms of credit creation—which is outside the direct purview of the Federal Reserve. The Genius Act, which passed the Senate last week, makes these events even easier to envision. The act would formalize the stablecoin industry. Stablecoin is a Treasury-backed cryptocoin that allows transactions to move onto the blockchain, a decentralized digital ledger outside the traditional banking sector. Companies like Amazon and Walmart have thrown their hats into the ring to create their own stablecoins, skirting the traditional banking system in all transactions.

With these elements in place, the Federal Reserve will face the problem of an AI purchasing agent talking to an AI credit agent with the only constraint on them being the underlying code dictating their behavior and the instructions users give them. Further, these two agents may conduct transactions using a form of currency that is lightly regulated and doesn’t move through the traditional banking system. Since these interactions would take place in the shadow banking sector, the Fed won’t see first movements in where the money supply is expanding or contracting, one of the main things central bankers need to observe to do their job correctly and guide the economy. And as AIs make financial decisions, how can anyone be certain that they will respond to Fed policy in the same way as our historical data tells us humans respond to Fed policy?

There are possible private-sector solutions to mitigate some of this, like insurance issued on the behavior of AIs making decisions. But if the Fed doesn’t have a clear picture of money creation by AIs or a direct way to intercede in AIs’ ability to change the money supply, it is in for a world of problems in an AI-driven economy.

The Fed needs to address this sooner rather than later. If the Genius Act becomes law, it will only make the problem more urgent. The pace at which personal AI products are being rolled out signals that this reality is fast approaching. If the Fed doesn’t have clarity on these innovative areas of the shadow banking sector and a playbook to deal with AI money creation, then it will realize the depth of this problem far too late to do anything about it.

Mr. Horstmeyer is a professor of finance at George Mason University.

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Crisis-Era Bank Capital Rules Eased

Treasury secretary says loosening requirements to help lift economy

By Dylan Tokar

The U.S. took a step toward easing some of the requirements placed on banks in the wake of the 2008-09 financial crisis, issuing a proposal that would let the largest lenders free up some of the capital they hold for times of market turmoil.

Banks have long lobbied for lowering what is known as the supplementary leverage ratio, and Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has said the change would help buttress global markets by allowing banks to buy more Treasurys.

The Federal Reserve Board voted 5-2 on Wednesday to issue a proposal to lower the enhanced supplementary leverage ratio.

The enhanced ratio dictates how much capital big banks like **JPMorgan Chase** and **Citigroup** must hold against their total assets.

One of the opposing votes came from Fed governor Michael Barr, who served as the central bank's top bank regulator before stepping down amid pressure from President Trump.

Barr said in a statement that the proposal would "significantly increase" the risk of a big bank failure.

The supplementary leverage ratio was originally meant to act as a backstop to rules that require banks to hold capital based on the riskiness of different assets.

"With the risk-based approach...there is a lot of room for flexibility—or to put it differently, manipulation," said Mayra Rodríguez Valladares, a financial regulatory consultant at the MRV Associates.

The proposal would reduce the amount of core capital that big banks hold at the holding-company level by an estimated $13 billion and at the subsidiary level by an estimated $210 billion, according to Fed officials. That would give banks more flexibility about how they allocate capital across their subsidiaries.

The Office of the Comptroller of the Currency released a parallel proposal Wednesday.

Please turn to page B2

Mediator Proposes $20 Million CBS Deal in Trump Suit

By Jessica Toonkel And Josh Dawsey

A mediator has proposed that President Trump and **Paramount Global** settle his lawsuit over a CBS News "60 Minutes" interview with former Vice President Kamala Harris for $20 million, according to people familiar with the matter.

The proposal would include a $17 million donation to Trump's presidential foundation or museum, the people said. It would also include millions more in legal fees and public-service announcements on Paramount-owned networks to fight antisemitism, the people said.

Trump's team has said it wants an apology—something Paramount isn't prepared to do, according to people familiar with the situation. It couldn't be learned whether Trump is still seeking an apology.

Settlement talks are still fluid and an agreement might not be reached.

Paramount, which owns CBS News, has been at an impasse with Trump's lawyers for weeks after entering mediation this spring. The company had offered $15 million to settle the suit, but Trump wanted more than $25 million.

Please turn to page B4

Bond Investors Sweep Fiscal Concerns to Side

By Sam Goldfarb

Not everybody on Wall Street is panicked about the U.S. fiscal outlook.

Just a month ago, a sharp selloff in U.S. Treasurys spurred widespread alarm that the bond market might finally be buckling under the pressure of outsize U.S. borrowing. But bonds have rallied since, boosted in part by mild inflation data that have driven up bets that the Federal Reserve will cut interest rates by the fall.

Now, with Republicans trying to push their giant package of tax cuts and spending measures over the finish line, the nuances of the U.S. fiscal situation are driving swings in bond yields.

Yields on longer-term Treasurys set a floor on a swath of borrowing costs, including mortgage rates. Yields themselves are dictated largely by investors' expectations for short-term interest rates set by the Fed. But they can also be influenced by the size of the budget deficit.

A larger deficit means the government needs to borrow more, which it does by issuing Treasurys. And if the government issues more Treasurys than investors want or need, it needs to win them over with higher interest rates.

Investors, though, are always looking ahead. When they suspect interest rates on bonds will be higher in the future, prices of existing Treasurys tend to fall right away—pushing yields upward. Thus, Treasury yields don't tend to rise just because the deficit is large now, but rather when expectations for future deficits shift higher.

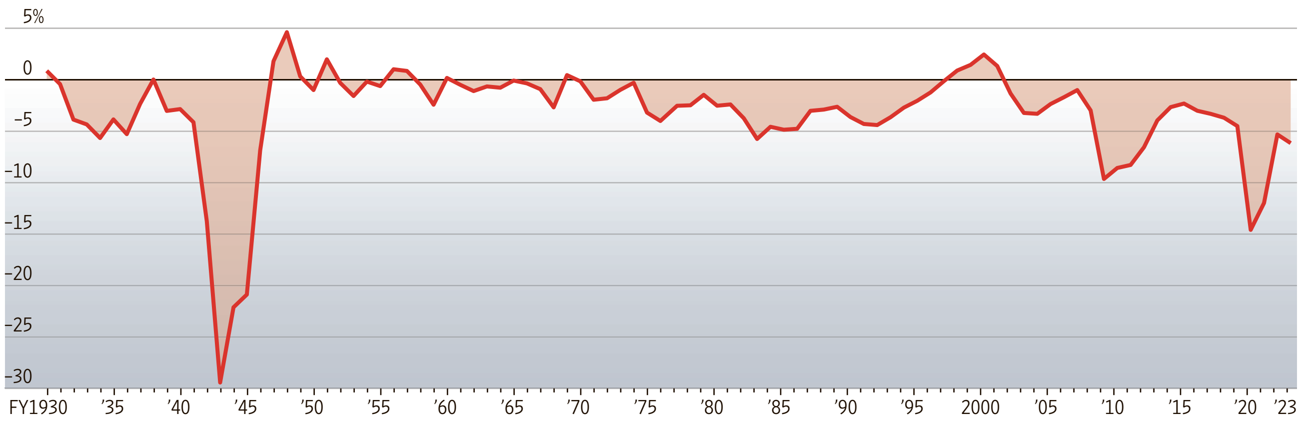
Benchmark 10-year Treasury notes snapped a three-day streak of falling yields on Wednesday—with the yield rising slightly to 4.294%. Bond yields rise as prices fall.

Last month's selloff came just as the House neared passage of a fiscal package that the Congressional Budget Office estimates would increase budget deficits by $2.4 trillion over the next decade.

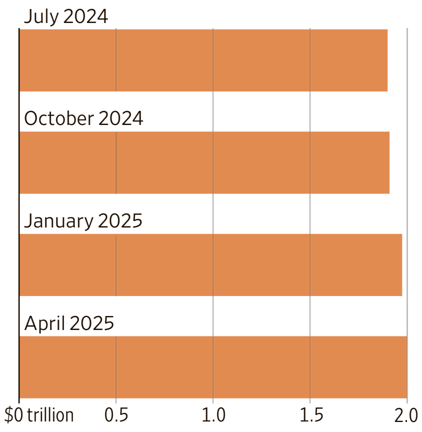
That estimate, though, is based on the assumption that tax cuts passed in 2017 would be allowed to fully expire if

Please turn to page B2

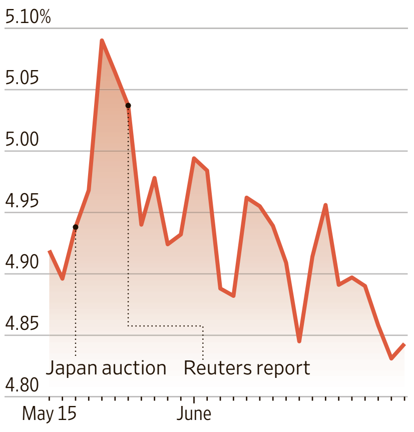
Federal budget deficit or surplus as a percentage of GDP*



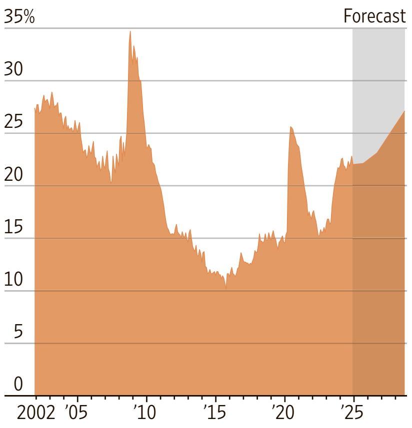
Evolution of fiscal 2026 deficit forecast†



Yield on the 30-year U.S. Treasury bond



T-bills' share of marketable debt outstanding‡



*For fiscal years ended Sept. 30 †Average forecast of primary dealers surveyed by the Treasury Department ‡Forecast assumes no increase in note-and-bond auction sizes

Sources: Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis (budget deficit); Treasury Department (deficit forecast, actual debt outstanding); Tradeweb FTSE closes (yield); Citigroup (forecast debt outstanding)

Meta Poaches Three From OpenAI

By Meghan Bobrowsky

Meta Chief Executive Mark Zuckerberg has poached three **OpenAI** researchers to join his superintelligence efforts, a recruiting coup intended to help steer Meta Platforms out of an artificial-intelligence crisis.

The social-media giant hired Lucas Beyer, Alexander Kolesnikov and Xiaohua Zhai, who were all working in OpenAI's Zurich office, according to people familiar with the matter. The three set up in OpenAI's Zurich office last year. Before that, they worked together at Google DeepMind, the company's AI unit.

A spokeswoman for OpenAI confirmed that the three researchers have left the company.

Zuckerberg has been on an intense recruiting drive to right Meta's AI efforts after the release of its latest model fell flat. In some cases, he has offered researchers $100 million to join a new team focused on building superintelligence, or AI that is smarter than humans.

Please turn to page B2

Platform To Let Anyone Bet On SpaceX

By Corrie Driebusch

An investment platform plans to use blockchain technology to sell investors exposure to SpaceX, another effort in an arms race to give regular traders access to hot startups.

Republic says it is starting to sell digital "tokens" that mirror the performance of private shares of Elon Musk's rocket and satellite company starting this week. The investment platform, which offers individual investors access to investments typically limited to the wealthy, plans to eventually expand its tokenization to other high-profile private companies like artificial-intelligence firms **OpenAI** and **Anthropic**.

Republic's plan is part of an array of efforts by crypto exchanges, brokerages and others to reinvent securities using similar blockchain technology that underpins bitcoin. Still largely untested with regulators, and even the underlying companies, the tokens are another attempt to trade on stocks that can't be found on the New York Stock Exchange or Nasdaq.

But there are plenty of questions. Token buyers won't have access to companies' financials and won't own actual stakes. Lawyers question if companies like SpaceX would fight it. The tokens could also draw scrutiny from regulators.

Republic CEO Kendrick Nguyen said he is confident in

Please turn to page B2

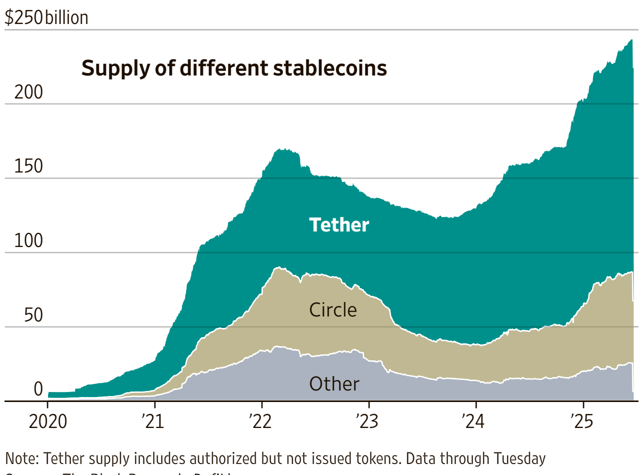
Stablecoin Bill Takes Aim at Tether

Congress is set to bring stablecoins into the financial mainstream, with legislation that has sparked a frenzy of interest from startups, banks and even retailers like Walmart that were previously wary of cryptocurrencies.

By Alexander Osipovich, Vicky Ge Huang and Angus Berwick

But the bill, known as the Genius Act, has a tough message for Tether, the No. 1 player in stablecoins: Shape up or get kicked out of the U.S. market.

The legislation, which passed the Senate last week, aims to bring more oversight to stablecoins—digital tokens with a fixed price, typically $1.



Note: Tether supply includes authorized but not issued tokens. Data through Tuesday

Sources: The Block Research; DefiLlama

Stablecoins function as a bridge from regular money to the crypto world, allowing people to make payments or send funds overseas using the technology behind bitcoin, but without bitcoin's volatility.

The Genius Act would require stablecoin issuers to underpin the value of their tokens with reserves of cash, short-term Treasurys and similarly safe assets.

Larger issuers would be required to publish annual, audited financial statements. That is bad news for Tether, which commands roughly two-thirds of the stablecoin market, with $156 billion in circulation.

Tether's stablecoins are partly backed by bitcoin and precious metals and the company has resisted being fully transparent about its finances. That means the legislation could make it untenable for Tether to keep operating in the U.S., said Scott Armstrong, a former federal prosecutor who handled crypto cases.

"It could definitely put Tether in a pinch," said Armstrong, now a partner at law

Please turn to page B2

INSIDE

MATEUSZ SLODKOWSKI/ZUMA PRESS

BUSINESS NEWS
Bumble is the latest dating company to cut jobs, laying off 30% of its workforce. **B3**

HEARD ON THE STREET
Nvidia threatens the giants of cloud computing. **B11**

Delta Sees an Opening in Online Delivery

By Esther Fung

There is a new contender aiming to deliver your e-commerce packages door-to-door, nationwide: **Delta Air Lines**.

Delta is now carrying tens of thousands of packages a day—products such as Figs scrubs and Arezzo shoes—through a new parcel service introduced last year. While small in comparison, Delta Cargo DeliverDirect is nipping at the heels of parcel giants **FedEx** and **United Parcel Service**.

The airline is taking advantage of unused space in the cargo holds of its planes.

"We've taught people really well to put suitcases up in the bin," said Jeffrey Elder, head of cargo products at Delta Air Lines. Belly space at Delta has

Please turn to page B4

WILFREDO LEE/AP

The airline is carrying thousands of packages a day, taking advantage of unused cargo space.

INDEX TO BUSINESSES

These indexes cite notable references to most parent companies and businesspeople in today's edition. Articles on regional page inserts aren't cited in these indexes.

INDEX TO PEOPLE

BUSINESS & FINANCE

'Genius' Bill Hurts Tether

Continued from page B1

firm McGovern Weems. "There's no ambiguity about those requirements. For anyone to participate now in the U.S. market and the stablecoin regime, they have to take those steps."

Representatives for Tether didn't respond to requests for comment. Tether Chief Executive Paolo Ardoino has said the firm may launch a separate, locally issued stablecoin to maintain a foothold in the U.S.

CAMILO FREEDMAN/BLOOMBERG NEWS

The legislation could make it untenable for Tether to keep operating in the U.S.

The Senate legislation provides a three-year grace period for companies to be compliant with the new requirements. A companion bill under consideration in the House of Representatives gives issuers 18 months. Differences between the two would have to be reconciled before President Trump, who supports the Genius Act, can sign it into law.

With the prospect of a legal framework that could make stablecoins widely used for payments, banks have explored teaming up to offer a joint stablecoin, while Walmart and Amazon.com have also considered issuing stablecoins, The Wall Street Journal has reported.

Tether's stablecoins already are popular tools for international payments in emerging markets. They are also used for illicit activities such as sanctions evasion, researchers say.

One of the Genius Act's biggest beneficiaries is Tether's homegrown U.S. rival **Circle**, which went public on the New York Stock Exchange this month and is the issuer of the second-largest stablecoin.

But it has a long way to catch up. Tether made $13.7 billion in profit last year, largely by collecting interest on the Treasury bills that back its stablecoin and gains on its bitcoin and gold holdings. Circle, whose stablecoin has less than half the circulating supply of Tether's, earned $156 million in 2024. Circle shares jumped 34% the day after the Genius Act passed the Senate.

For years, Tether was dogged by worries that it didn't have sufficient reserves to underpin the $1 value of its stablecoins. In 2021, to settle an investigation by the New York attorney general that Tether had covered up an $850 million shortfall, the firm began releasing quarterly attestations about its reserves. Those attestations aren't the same as a full public audit.

Some of the assets Tether is using for reserves, including bitcoin, could lose their value during a broad market drawdown, increasing the risk that Tether holders might be unable to redeem their tokens for $1 apiece.

Under the Genius Act, stablecoin issuers must register with U.S. regulators—unless they are regulated by a foreign country whose rules are deemed to be similar to those of the U.S. Tether recently moved its headquarters to El Salvador and acquired a license there to provide crypto services. The firm was previously domiciled in the British Virgin Islands.

"El Salvador is, in this moment, the only country that has a proper, intelligent, very thorough stablecoin regulation," Ardoino told CNBC in a recent interview.

Tether could maintain its access to U.S. markets if the Trump administration deems El Salvador to have sufficiently strong stablecoin rules. The country's president, Nayib Bukele, has partnered with Trump on accepting deportees, and the two leaders had a warm meeting in the Oval Office in April.

Another Tether ally is Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, who led financial-services firm **Cantor Fitzgerald** before he joined the administration. Cantor holds most of Tether's Treasury portfolio and has invested in Tether through a convertible bond. Lutnick agreed to transfer his ownership stake in Cantor to his children when he joined the cabinet.

Tether exited from the European Union earlier this year rather than comply with new EU rules on stablecoins. Similarly, the firm has the option to exit from the U.S. and double down on its thriving business in Asia, Latin America and other emerging markets. Most of the trading volume in Tether's stablecoins—which often exceeds $100 billion a day—is on platforms based outside the U.S., particularly Binance, the world's largest crypto exchange.

The Genius Act would require stablecoin issuers to fulfill law-enforcement requests to seize cryptocurrency, carry out bank-level customer checks and report suspicious transactions. Tether says it has complied with law-enforcement requests to freeze stablecoins used for illicit activity.

Bond Investors Stay Cool

Continued from page B1

Republicans don't pass their new bill.

Investors never expected that to happen—even if Democrats were in power, given their promises to extend tax cuts on all but the highest-income households.

Treasury yields had already ticked higher after the election, partly because investors thought a Republican sweep would lead to slightly larger deficits than other scenarios. Their base case was that all of the 2017 tax cuts would be extended, without any major offsets from spending cuts.

The House bill includes some additional tax cuts that would further add to the deficit. But it also makes cuts to programs like Medicaid. Meanwhile, revenue from tariffs have been higher than investors anticipated.

Although Senate Republicans could make changes to the House bill that would increase its cost, the net result is that the fiscal outlook hasn't changed much since the election. Banks surveyed by the Treasury Department at the end of April—when the GOP fiscal legislation was already taking shape—forecast that the deficit will total $2 trillion in fiscal 2026. That was up only slightly from their estimate of $1.975 trillion in January and $1.9 trillion last July.

Anatomy of selloff

Last month's selloff also raised concerns because it came just after the U.S. government lost its triple-A credit rating with a downgrade from Moody's Ratings.

Further stoking fears about a worldwide debt problem, a sale of 20-year bonds by Japan's government on May 20 met with especially weak demand from investors. That was followed up by a lackluster U.S. auction of 20-year Treasurys on May 21, which triggered the worst of the selloff.

After that, the bond market quickly calmed, however.

Yields fell sharply on May 27 after Reuters reported that Japan's government was considering reducing the size of its longer-term debt auctions (a step Japan formally announced last week). They then fell further after a disappointing reading on U.S. service-sector activity and a cooler-than-expected inflation report.

Cause for optimism

Helping to ease investors' anxieties is a growing expectation that, despite elevated deficits, the Trump administration will try to minimize issuance of longer-term Treasurys in the coming years.

The government typically tries to keep auctions of notes and bonds, which mature in two to 30 years, the same size for as long as possible. It uses bills, which mature in a year or less, to manage fluctuations in borrowing needs.

A year ago, most Wall Street banks were forecasting that Treasury officials would increase the sizes of its longer-term debt auctions this year. That was based on an assumption that officials would keep bills as a share of debt outstanding to around 20%—a private-sector advisory group's recommendation for what would achieve both low and stable government funding costs.

Early this year, however, the Treasury Department signaled that it was unlikely to boost auction sizes in the near future. Most banks now expect increases in 2026, if not later, and expect the increases to be concentrated in notes that mature in two to seven years.

Absent an increase in auction sizes, analysts expect the bill share would creep up to around 25% by the end of fiscal 2027.

JOE RAEDLE/GETTY IMAGES

Republic says it will sell digital 'tokens' that mirror the performance of private shares of the rocket and satellite company.

Platform Allows Bets On SpaceX

Continued from page B1

the tokens' legality, but added that it is possible regulators might take a different view.

Republic says it is able to offer the tokens in part because of a provision in the 2012 JOBS Act that lets private U.S. companies issue securities and raise up to $5 million a year from individual investors. Republic says it would be the issuing company, and the tokens are essentially a note that assures token holders will be paid any increase in the price of SpaceX's common stock if it goes public or is purchased.

Republic has a license through the Securities and Exchange Commission that allows it to use this Regulation Crowdfunding exemption to sell tokenized securities to individual investors. Nguyen said Republic won't need permission from the companies whose tokens it is selling because the tokens represent securities sold by Republic.

The tokens for SpaceX and other companies will initially be priced based on how the company's shares are trading in secondary markets where shares of private companies can be exchanged by accredited investors. When the company goes public or is sold, Republic says it will owe any increase in price to the token holders.

Republic plans to hold shares of or have some other exposure to the underlying security, Nguyen said. Token investors won't be acknowledged as shareholders in the company.

Wall Street wants to pitch stakes in highflying startups and other privately held companies to ordinary investors. Trump administration officials have said the private sector is a major engine of growth and are looking to increase everyday Americans' exposure to private-equity investments.

Others have flagged the possible risks. Moody's recently warned that the push to sell private investments to individual investors could trigger stress in the financial markets and that the investments can be harder to sell.

Republic will let people invest as little as $50 and up to $5,000 in the tokens. Typically, people who want to get in on private companies need to invest upward of $10,000, or even $100,000, and must meet certain income or net-worth requirements.

For the most popular companies, it helps to have an in with the founder.

After a year of holding the tokens, Republic says people will be able to trade them on INX, an alternative trading system Republic is in the process of acquiring.

For startups that want to stay private longer, one big hurdle is keeping their investor bases limited. Once there are 2,000 shareholders "of record," a company is legally required to disclose financial information that is similar to a public company. To help skirt the requirements, fund managers have created complex financial structures.

Tokenization could be another workaround.

Republic already lets investors buy tokenized securities in other private assets like sports clubs or films.

Some lawyers question how Republic will meet requirements that investors be given financial information about the companies before they invest.

Binance, the world's largest crypto exchange, introduced tokenized versions of Tesla and other U.S. stocks in 2021. But it pulled the plug on them a few months later after regulators around the world warned that Binance didn't have licenses to offer them locally.

Zuckerberg Poaches 3 At OpenAI

Continued from page B1

His company recently invested $14 billion in AI startup Scale and hired its CEO, Alexandr Wang, to lead the new team. Zuckerberg has also tried to recruit OpenAI co-founders Ilya Sutskever and John Schulman to join. Neither has.

OpenAI CEO Sam Altman said onstage at an event Tuesday that he wasn't worried about Zuckerberg's blitz.

"It's like OK, Zuckerberg is doing some new insane thing. What's next?" he said. Last week, Altman said his best people hadn't left for Meta.

Zuckerberg got personally involved in Meta's AI recruiting efforts in April after an underwhelming launch of its latest model. In May, The Wall Street Journal reported that Meta was delaying the release of another version of the model—the biggest one.

Some AI researchers have turned down the Meta CEO, and in several cases, OpenAI has counteroffered, giving its researchers more money and scope to stay.

Tech giants Meta and **Alphabet**'s Google and startups OpenAI and **Anthropic** are racing to develop cutting-edge AI technology that will power the next wave of innovation in Silicon Valley. Zuckerberg's overtures to top AI researchers and engineers are the latest developments in a fierce war for talent taking place all over the world.

Meta plans to spend up to $65 billion on capital expenditures this year, largely to build out its AI ambitions.

Capital Rules Eased On Banks

Continued from page B1

The Federal Deposit Insurance Corp. is expected to meet on the proposal Thursday.

The move is part of a set of rollbacks the Trump administration is expected to undertake, including changes to how banks are rated, how they are examined by regulators for financial stability and the annual stress tests the largest lenders must take.

The changes to bank capital rules in particular would strip away some of the "gold plating" U.S. banking rules—or the additional safeguards the U.S. placed on banks above what was required by international agreements.

Industry representatives say banks are unlikely to immediately buy more Treasurys as a result of leverage requirement changes, but that they would have more capacity to do so in times of stress.

The Fed's proposal also asks banks to comment on possibly excluding Treasurys from the leverage ratio denominator for all banks.

Banks and the public have 60 days to comment on the proposal. A final rule is expected later this year.

Officials have indicated they are also preparing to propose a set of risk-based capital requirements that the U.S. agreed to undertake as part of an international Basel III agreement following the financial crisis.

After intense industry pushback, the Fed had to pull back on a prior Basel proposal during the Biden administration.


DANIEL ACKER/BLOOMBERG NEWS

The Blue Buffalo brand will launch fresh pet food this year.

General Mills Logs Decline in Sales, Profit

By Connor Hart

General Mills said organic sales could fall again in the current fiscal year as consumers continue to spend less on snacks, despite efforts to return to growth.

The maker of Cinnamon Toast Crunch and Bisquick pancake mix on Wednesday said its top priority in fiscal 2026 is to restore volume-driven organic sales growth. "To do that, we'll invest further in consumer value, product news, innovation and brand building," Chief Executive Jeff Harmening said.

These investments will include launching Blue Buffalo into the quickly growing U.S. fresh-pet-food space later this calendar year, the Minneapolis company said. However, it warned that these investments, coupled with higher costs from tariffs, should outpace cost-saving efforts.

General Mills also said it expects to close the sale of its U.S. yogurt business by the end of this month. It continues to anticipate that this divestiture, together with that of its Canada yogurt business and last year's acquisition of North American Whitebridge Pet Brands, will reduce adjusted operating profit growth in the current fiscal year. The company guided for full-year organic net sales in the range of down 1% to up 1%, and for adjusted per-share earnings to fall between 10% and 15% from fiscal 2025.

The outlook came as General Mills logged lower profit and sales in its fiscal fourth quarter.

The company posted a profit of $294 million, or 53 cents a share, for its three months ended May 25, compared with a profit of $557.5 million, or 98 cents a share, in last year's comparable quarter. Sales fell 3.3% to $4.56 billion.

Bumble Cuts Staff by 30%

Smaller workforce will help the dating app return to growth, its CEO says

By Chip Cutter And Connor Hart

ANDREW KELLY/REUTERS

CEO Whitney Wolfe Herd says she wants Bumble to be faster, more decisive, and more agile.

The business of love is proving to be complicated.

Dating-app providers, hoping to woo younger users turned off by online swiping, want to return to growth. To accomplish that, executives are realizing they will need far fewer employees.

Bumble on Wednesday became the latest dating company to slim down its staff, announcing that it will lay off about 30% of its workforce, or roughly 240 employees, as it aims to change its structure and speed up how it operates.

"Bumble, like the online dating industry itself, is at an inflection point," Chief Executive Whitney Wolfe Herd said in a letter sent to employees Wednesday disclosing the staff cuts. "The reality is, we need to take decisive action to restructure to build a company that's resilient, intentional, and ready for the next decade."

After years of sagging growth and sinking stock prices, dating companies are looking to quickly reset their strategies. Wolfe Herd returned to Bumble in March.

Its biggest competitor, **Match Group**, which runs Tinder and Hinge, also appointed a new leader earlier this year. Spencer Rascoff, a co-founder and former CEO of Zillow, took the reins as Match Group's CEO in February.

Both executives are aiming to address an existential issue: Younger users, particularly those in Generation Z, have soured on online dating. That is forcing dating platforms to upend their features, change their marketing messages and find other ways to court this new generation.

Part of the solution, executives say, is how companies are organized. Like employers across corporate America, the leaders of the online-dating platforms are finding that larger workforces can impede their progress. Match Group in May said it would cut 13% of its workers, or about 325 people, as it reduced management layers—including around one in five managers overall—and returned to smaller teams focused on its products.

Wolfe Herd echoed such a message in her note to staff Wednesday, saying she wanted Bumble to return to a startup mentality and become "a faster, more decisive, and more agile organization."

Launching new products faster is the goal. One of the challenges online-dating companies face, Wolfe Herd told investors last month, is that the quality of the experience for many users has deteriorated. Dating apps perform at their best when people get quality matches, go on dates and fall in love. During the pandemic, apps grew by adding people in search of a connection, though that didn't translate to better outcomes.

"Dating apps don't work like social networks, where more people and content automatically makes the product better," Wolfe Herd told investors last month on a call. "What we learned is that just adding more profiles does not guarantee better matches. In fact, it can lead to the opposite: more mismatches, more fake or low-quality profiles, and a frustrating experience."

EU Launches Probe of Mars's $30 Billion Takeover of Kellanova

By Edith Hancock

The European Union said it would launch an in-depth investigation into Mars's bid to take over Pringles seller **Kellanova**, escalating its probe into the nearly $30 billion deal amid concerns it could stifle competition.

The European Commission, the EU's executive arm, said on Wednesday that both companies have strong market positions in multiple sectors and countries, with brands that are considered a "must have" for consumers.

Privately held Mars agreed to buy Kellanova in an all-cash deal last August as part of a plan to build out its snacks business—which includes M&M's, Twix and Skittles—with Kellanova's portfolio of products such as Pop-Tarts and Cheez-Its.

The deal would catapult Mars into supermarket's chips and crackers aisles. However, it comes as consumer-goods groups have been struggling with customers balking at higher prices as a result of inflation.

The commission said retailers are worried the transaction could increase Mars's bargaining power and force them to accept higher prices to avoid not being able to sell both its and Kellanova's products. The commission also said supermarket shoppers could switch to a different retailer if they can't find the products they want in one.

Mars said that it was disappointed but remained optimistic that the investigation would be resolved positively.

"We have cooperated with the regulatory authorities, furnishing substantial supporting information, and will continue to do so," the company said.

The deal was previously expected to close in the first half of 2025, but Mars said it now expects to wrap it up toward the end of the year.

Competition Commissioner Teresa Ribera said the EU executive would look at how the deal might affect product prices in the bloc.

"By acquiring Kellanova, Mars will add several very popular brands of potato chips and cereals to its already broad and strong product portfolio," she said.

Tesla's EU Sales Slumped in May

Drop in new-car registrations came despite growth in Europe's EV market

By Mauro Orru

Tesla's sales in the European Union logged another steep decline in May, continuing a downward trend for Elon Musk's electric-vehicle maker even as the bloc's EV market shows signs of growth.

New-car registrations for Tesla models, a reflection of sales, fell 40.5% to 8,729 vehicles across the EU last month, according to the European Automobile Manufacturers' Association, an industry body. When including the U.K., Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway and Switzerland, sales contracted nearly 28% to 13,863 vehicles.

The fall extends a streak of disappointing EU monthly sales for the company. Tesla's new-car registrations in the bloc slumped nearly 53% in April, 36% in March, 47% in February and 50% in January. December marked the last month when the group logged higher sales in the EU, with 5.9% growth.

May's decline for Tesla came despite signs that the bloc's EV market is improving. Sales of battery-electric vehicles increased 25% on year, with a nearly 45% jump in Germany alone. Registrations of hybrid-electric cars rose 16%, while plug-in-hybrid models climbed nearly 47%.

HANSCHKE/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Tesla faces tough competition from Chinese rivals and fallout from CEO Musk's involvement with the Trump administration.

Tesla, like many Western carmakers, faces tough competition from Chinese rivals as they seek to expand in Europe. The company is also dealing with the fallout from Musk's involvement with the Trump administration. The chief executive said last month that his tenure working for the administration was ending.

Investors were concerned that he had taken his eye off the ball. The billionaire wrote in a post on X last month that he had gone back to spending significant time at work, saying he had to be "super focused" on Tesla and his other companies.

The company recently rolled out its long-awaited robotaxi service in Austin, Texas, as it seeks to compete with the likes of Waymo in the autonomous ride-hailing market. Musk said the company was starting with as many as 20 Tesla Model Ys driving on public roads, before expanding the service further.

The European manufacturing association said overall EU passenger-car registrations grew 1.6% in May to 926,582 vehicles. Sales were up 1.2% in Germany but down more than 12% in France and 0.1% in Italy.

New-car registrations for Chinese state-owned automaker **SAIC Motor** jumped 38%, while Germany's **Volkswagen** logged 4.8% growth. **Stellantis**, the owner of the Jeep and Dodge brands, recorded a 5.2% decline in overall sales.

CBS-Trump $20 Million Deal Pushed

Continued from page B1
The Wall Street Journal previously reported.

Trump alleged in October that the network committed election interference by deceitfully editing a "60 Minutes" interview with Democratic presidential candidate Harris, making her sound better. The lawsuit ultimately sought $20 billion in damages. CBS has said it didn't doctor her comments, but rather aired a more succinct version of her response.

Paramount leaders have been wrestling with how to pay to settle the lawsuit without exposing directors and officers to liability in potential future shareholder litigation or to criminal charges for bribing a public official. By settling within the range of what other companies have paid to end litigation with Trump, some Paramount executives have said they hope to minimize such liability, people familiar with the matter said.

Paramount brought in law firm Gibson Dunn to assess whether it could offer more than $15 million without putting its directors and top executives at risk of future litigation or criminal charges, people familiar with the discussions said.

A potential settlement of $20 million, including legal fees, would be in line with what other media and tech companies have paid to settle lawsuits from Trump.

In December, **Disney** settled a defamation lawsuit against its ABC News division and star anchor George Stephanopoulos. Disney agreed to contribute $15 million to Trump's presidential foundation or museum and to pay $1 million in legal fees to Trump's lawyer.

The CBS suit has hung over Paramount's planned merger with Skydance Media, and the prospect of settling has angered some of the news organization's executives and staff.

Delta Looks To Online Delivery

Continued from page B1
also opened up in recent years as the U.S. Postal Service began delivering more letters and parcels using its own trucks.

Delta uses a technology platform called SmartKargo, which links flight schedules to trucking companies that carry packages on the first and final legs of their journeys.

The carrier aims to deliver hundreds of thousands of packages a day in the U.S. in the coming years. UPS delivered an average of 19 million packages a day domestically in 2024. FedEx's Express and Ground units delivered an average of 15 million parcels a day in its fiscal year ended May 2024.

Cargo generally accounts for less than 3% of passenger airlines' revenue. In recent quarters, revenue from the cargo units in Delta, American Airlines Group and United Airlines Holdings has outpaced passenger revenue growth, helping insulate against fluctuations in ticket sales.

American and United also are carrying more e-commerce packages in their cargo holds, but they don't offer the door-to-door service that Delta does.

There are potential drawbacks to sending a package on a passenger flight: Deliveries could be vulnerable to air-travel delays. And a package might get bumped from its flight. Passenger luggage gets first dibs for plane belly space. Human organ or tissue deliveries and human remains also get priority over other cargo.

But some businesses are seeking cheaper alternatives to traditional delivery services. Passenger airlines can generally get a parcel delivered within 2½ days, often at a lower price.

GoBolt, a logistics-service provider handling inventory and package deliveries for 400 brands in North America, started using Delta's DeliverDirect service in April. So far, it has gone well, said Jarrett Stewart, a senior vice president at GoBolt.

Delta's on-time performance has been on par with FedEx and UPS, and its delivery costs are 20% to 25% cheaper, Stewart said. Delivering 1,000 parcels by truck for the middle leg of a trip from New Jersey to Miami might cost around $3,000, or $3 for a parcel; with a passenger airline, the cost of the middle leg could be pennies for a parcel, he said.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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MARKETS DIGEST

EQUITIES

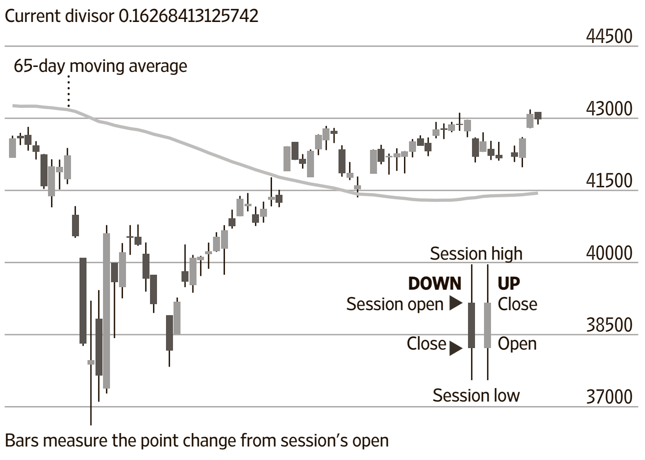
Dow Jones Industrial Average

42982.43 ▼106.59, or 0.25%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio	24.30	27.16
P/E estimate *	20.28	18.96
Dividend yield	1.70	2.16
All-time high	45014.04, 12/04/24	

Current divisor 0.16268413125742

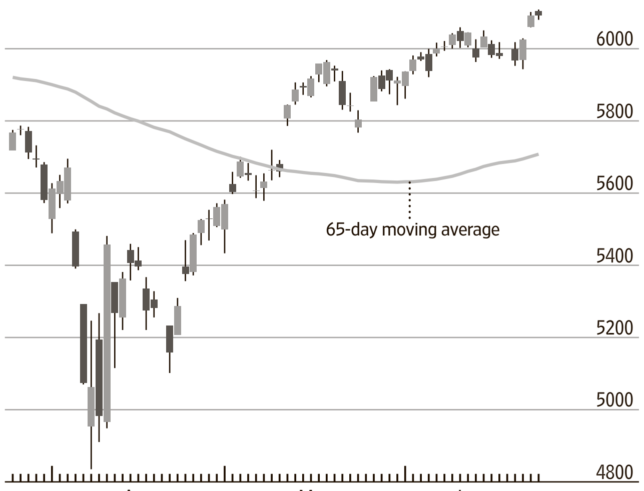


S&P 500 Index

6092.16 ▼0.02, or 0.0003%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *	23.58	24.01
P/E estimate *	22.75	22.27
Dividend yield *	1.28	1.34
All-time high	6144.15, 02/19/25	

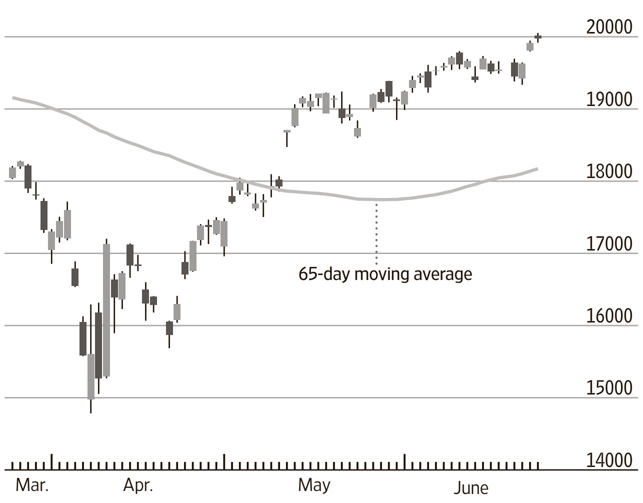


Nasdaq Composite Index

19973.55 ▲ 61.02, or 0.31%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *†	30.72	31.89
P/E estimate *†	28.58	28.97
Dividend yield *†	0.72	0.78
All-time high:	20173.89, 12/16/24	



*Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Birinyi Associates Inc.; †Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Major U.S. Stock-Market Indexes

	Latest High	Low	Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg	% chg YTD	3-yr. ann.
Dow Jones										
Industrial Average	43130.33	42871.50	42982.43	-106.59	-0.25	45014.04	37645.59	9.9	1.0	10.9
Transportation Avg	15296.50	15126.27	15209.72	-164.85	-1.07	17754.38	12637.04	-0.9	-4.3	3.9
Utility Average	1048.93	1036.51	1037.71	-13.47	-1.28	1079.88	898.82	14.0	5.6	2.9
Total Stock Market	60408.72	60082.74	60180.75	-68.77	-0.11	61024.05	49067.76	11.5	3.1	15.2
Barron's 400	1302.16	1289.99	1290.35	-9.85	-0.76	1356.99	1058.38	14.4	3.1	13.4
Nasdaq Stock Market										
Nasdaq Composite	20052.78	19918.08	19973.55	61.02	0.31	20173.89	15267.91	12.2	3.4	19.8
Nasdaq-100	22329.23	22175.08	22237.74	47.22	0.21	22237.74	17090.40	12.6	5.8	22.5
S&P										
500 Index	6108.51	6080.09	6092.16	-0.02	-0.0003	6144.15	4982.77	11.2	3.6	15.9
MidCap 400	3081.10	3051.19	3054.23	-24.65	-0.80	3390.26	2560.93	4.9	-2.1	9.4
SmallCap 600	1327.21	1312.58	1313.08	-13.14	-0.99	1544.66	1106.12	2.6	-6.8	4.4
Other Indexes										
Russell 2000	2163.67	2135.96	2136.18	-25.03	-1.16	2442.03	1760.71	5.9	-4.2	6.6
NYSE Composite	20217.34	20083.14	20087.45	-129.89	-0.64	20272.04	17188.46	11.6	5.2	10.7
Value Line	596.33	591.05	591.40	-4.85	-0.81	656.04	495.50	1.9	-3.2	2.9
NYSE Arca Biotech	5628.77	5555.52	5586.05	-42.72	-0.76	6318.63	5060.12	4.6	-2.8	5.6
NYSE Arca Pharma	928.46	918.98	924.14	-2.63	-0.28	1140.17	860.88	-13.6	-1.1	3.0
KBW Bank	136.40	134.89	136.29	1.04	0.77	140.59	102.02	33.6	6.9	9.1
PHLX§ Gold/Silver	204.97	202.76	203.97	0.16	0.08	210.81	136.20	48.8	48.7	19.6
PHLX§ Oil Service	58.50	57.44	57.56	-1.01	-1.72	92.31	50.70	-31.5	-20.7	-4.1
PHLX§ Semiconductor	5494.78	5443.40	5493.30	51.43	0.95	5904.54	3562.94	0.8	10.3	26.4
Cboe Volatility	17.51	16.68	16.76	-0.72	-4.12	52.33	12.03	33.5	-3.4	-14.9

§Nasdaq PHLX

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Late Trading

Most-active and biggest movers among NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE Amer. and Nasdaq issues from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. ET as reported by electronic trading services, securities dealers and regional exchanges. Minimum share price of $2 and minimum after-hours volume of 50,000 shares.

Most-active issues in late trading

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	After Hours % chg	High	Low
Lucid Group	LCID	21,177.2	2.15	0.01	0.47	2.15	2.14
Vanguard S&P 500 ETF	VOO	10,748.9	559.58	-0.15	-0.03	559.79	551.10
Micron Technology	MU	9,926.8	128.56	1.31	1.03	137.00	126.88
iShares Core S&P 500 ETF	IVV	9,805.1	609.97	0.01	0.002	610.05	609.21
Snap	SNAP	9,460.3	8.05	0.02	0.25	8.06	7.94
NVIDIA	NVDA	7,205.5	154.26	-0.05	-0.03	181.98	93.19
Direxion Dly SCOND 3 BL	SOXL	5,179.8	24.65	0.07	0.29	25.07	24.54
Palantir Technologies	PLTR	4,855.9	142.83	-0.07	-0.05	143.15	142.56

Percentage gainers…

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	After Hours % chg	High	Low
Worthington Steel	WS	54.4	30.09	3.83	14.58	31.15	26.00
MillerKnoll	MLKN	184.4	19.50	1.88	10.67	19.60	17.62
Genesis Energy	GEL	50.6	17.30	0.90	5.49	17.30	16.40
Amrize	AMRZ	177.2	52.89	2.64	5.25	52.89	49.86
Vestis	VSTS	53.1	6.36	0.31	5.12	6.36	6.05

…And losers

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	After Hours % chg	High	Low
Kratos Defense & Sec	KTOS	576.4	40.05	-2.28	-5.39	42.33	39.00
S&P Global	SPGI	54.8	502.49	-18.80	-3.61	525.67	502.49
Chemours	CC	131.1	11.00	-0.40	-3.51	11.70	11.00
Jefferies Financial Group	JEF	100.4	54.42	-1.50	-2.68	56.37	53.70
Steelcase	SCS	57.6	10.36	-0.26	-2.45	10.80	9.80

Trading Diary

Volume, Advancers, Decliners

	NYSE	NYSE Amer.
Total volume*	1,096,334,319	17,153,535
Adv. volume*	251,802,755	8,121,046
Decl. volume*	838,371,179	8,883,220
Issues traded	2,842	294
Advances	808	105
Declines	1,950	176
Unchanged	84	13
New highs	58	4
New lows	25	1
Closing Arms†	1.25	0.80
Block trades*	6,000	214

	Nasdaq	NYSE Arca
Total volume*	8,256,120,436	298,866,302
Adv. volume*	4,033,266,489	117,644,148
Decl. volume*	4,163,555,959	178,237,260
Issues traded	4,650	2,261
Advances	1,629	756
Declines	2,863	1,447
Unchanged	158	58
New highs	189	157
New lows	92	37
Closing Arms†	0.59	0.81
Block trades*	58,623	1,430

* Primary market NYSE, NYSE American NYSE Arca only.
†(TRIN) A comparison of the number of advancing and declining issues with the volume of shares rising and falling. An Arms of less than 1 indicates buying demand; above 1 indicates selling pressure.

International Stock Indexes

Region/Country	Index	Close	Latest Net chg	% chg	YTD % chg
World	MSCI ACWI	902.15	−0.88	−0.10	7.2
	MSCI ACWI ex-USA	372.69	−0.90	−0.24	14.4
	MSCI World	3950.11	−7.72	−0.20	6.5
	MSCI Emerging Markets	1220.72	8.88	0.73	13.5
Americas	MSCI AC Americas	2304.29	−1.44	−0.06	4.2
Canada	S&P/TSX Comp	26566.32	−152.30	−0.57	7.4
Latin Amer.	MSCI EM Latin America	2274.64	−16.73	−0.73	22.8
Brazil	Bovespa	135767.29	−1397.32	−1.02	12.9
Chile	S&P IPSA	4239.66	−3.81	−0.09	17.3
Mexico	S&P/BMV IPC	56933.19	189.91	0.33	15.0
EMEA	STOXX Europe 600	536.98	−4.00	−0.74	5.8
Eurozone	Euro STOXX	555.18	−4.21	−0.75	9.9
Belgium	Bel-20	4457.12	−34.30	−0.76	4.5
Denmark	OMX Copenhagen 20	1734.97	−41.07	−2.31	−17.5
France	CAC 40	7558.16	−57.83	−0.76	2.4
Germany	DAX	23498.33	−143.25	−0.61	18.0
Israel	Tel Aviv	2928.35	51.85	1.80	22.3
Italy	FTSE MIB	39319.14	−155.32	−0.39	15.0
Netherlands	AEX	917.86	−6.76	−0.73	4.5
Norway	Oslo Bors All-Share	1839.75	−7.28	−0.39	11.9
South Africa	FTSE/JSE All-Share	95311.22	−575.81	−0.60	13.3
Spain	IBEX 35	13811.80	−223.30	−1.59	19.1
Sweden	OMX Stockholm	934.65	−1.90	−0.20	−2.1
Switzerland	Swiss Market	11880.12	−108.80	−0.91	2.4
Turkey	BIST 100	9418.52	−30.38	−0.32	−4.2
U.K.	FTSE 100	8718.75	−40.24	−0.46	6.7
U.K.	FTSE 250	21298.04	−28.16	−0.13	3.3
Asia-Pacific	MSCI AC Asia Pacific	201.38	0.74	0.37	10.9
Australia	S&P/ASX 200	8559.20	3.66	0.04	4.9
China	Shanghai Composite	3455.97	35.41	1.04	3.1
Hong Kong	Hang Seng	24474.67	297.60	1.23	22.0
India	BSE Sensex	82755.51	700.39	0.85	5.9
Japan	NIKKEI 225	38942.07	151.51	0.39	−2.4
Singapore	Straits Times	3925.98	21.68	0.56	3.7
South Korea	KOSPI	3108.25	4.61	0.15	29.5
Taiwan	TAIEX	22430.61	241.85	1.09	−2.6
Thailand	SET	1107.69	7.68	0.70	−20.9

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Percentage Gainers…

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
Urgent.ly	ULY	8.19	3.70	82.37	22.50	2.99	-59.1
Anbio Biotechnology	NNNN	31.83	7.75	32.18	35.90	5.18	...
QuantumScape	QS	5.67	1.34	30.95	9.52	3.40	16.0
GlucoTrack	GCTK	7.84	1.63	26.25	3756.00	5.16	-99.7
Reitar Logtech Holdings	RITR	6.48	1.34	26.07	8.75	2.24	...
Bumble Cl A	BMBL	6.52	1.31	25.14	10.66	3.55	-35.8
Xenetic Biosciences	XBIO	3.88	0.74	23.37	5.27	2.20	-1.3
UP Fintech Holding ADR	TIGR	9.95	1.82	22.39	14.48	3.36	128.7
Aeluma	ALMU	17.04	3.05	21.80	19.50	2.50	442.7
AeroVironment	AVAV	234.94	41.66	21.55	250.00	102.25	21.9
Netcapital	NCPL	4.93	0.85	20.83	11.90	1.41	-38.4
Cyngn	CYN	5.01	0.86	20.72	1600.50	3.62	-99.5
Pluri	PLUR	5.30	0.88	19.91	7.13	3.33	4.3
Crescent Biopharma	CBIO	18.00	2.94	19.48	63.00	11.06	-38.3
Avalon GloboCare	ALBT	3.43	0.55	19.18	12.60	2.11	-51.9

Percentage Losers

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
XTI Aerospace	XTIA	1.68	-1.11	-39.78	187.50	0.96	-98.5
Torrid Holdings	CURV	3.15	-1.95	-38.24	9.14	2.18	-57.8
Fast Track Group	FTRK	1.66	-0.84	-33.60	9.69	1.35	...
Surf Air Mobility	SRFM	2.54	-1.06	-29.44	6.72	0.90	-15.6
Forte Biosciences	FBRX	10.59	-3.58	-25.26	28.68	4.11	-11.8
Annovis Bio	ANVS	2.29	-0.77	-25.16	17.88	1.11	-60.0
Maase	MAAS	5.10	-1.69	-24.89	467.95	2.41	-98.8
Bone Biologics	BBLG	4.19	-1.36	-24.55	25.50	3.42	-40.3
Ruanyun Edai Technology	RYET	5.80	-1.81	-23.78	15.30	2.68	...
CID HoldCo	DAIC	30.98	-9.64	-23.73	75.00	2.03	189.5
Robin Energy	RBNE	3.70	-1.15	-23.71	24.65	1.32	...
Nano Labs Cl A	NA	11.35	-3.50	-23.57	31.48	2.75	156.7
Cumberland Pharm	CPIX	2.55	-0.75	-22.73	7.25	1.04	67.8
KULR Technology Group	KULR	5.21	-1.33	-20.34	43.92	1.60	62.8
Know Labs	KNW	2.04	-0.51	-20.00	20.74	0.33	-89.4

Most Active Stocks

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
Plus Therapeutics	PSTV	725,029	7272.2	0.32	68.45	2.31	0.16
Greenlane Holdings	GNLN	292,782	2.4	0.01	-16.85	21.80	0.01
SeaStar Medical Holding	ICU	275,205	44663.7	0.42	17.63	13.85	0.31
NVIDIA	NVDA	266,619	7.0	154.31	4.33	154.45	86.62
BigBear.ai	BBAI	256,034	212.2	4.81	-8.03	10.36	1.17
Healthcare Triangle	HCTI	254,552	3.4	0.03	-6.06	1.90	0.01
Direxion TSLA Bull 2X	TSLL	233,404	4.1	12.58	-7.64	41.50	6.29
QuantumScape	QS	177,904	1495.9	5.67	30.95	9.52	3.40
DenisonMines	DNN	141,987	35.6	1.77	-1.67	2.47	1.08
Vor Biopharma	VOR	137,996	3151.0	0.55	74.28	1.80	0.13

* Volumes of 100,000 shares or more are rounded to the nearest thousand

Volume Movers

Ranked by change from 65-day average*

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
GlucoTrack	GCTK	24,046	23042	7.84	26.25	3756.00	5.16
NYLI MacKay Muni Insured	MMIN	6,398	4607	23.21	0.15	24.65	22.30
Saga Communications Cl A	SGA	180	3434	12.43	0.08	16.48	10.75
Republic Digital Cl A	RDAG	358	3392	10.33	-1.62	12.64	10.30
Torrid Holdings	CURV	9,191	3380	3.15	-38.24	9.14	2.18
First Northwest Bancorp	FNWB	572	3312	6.96	-8.72	12.10	6.05
VicSh Core Plus Interm Bd	UBND	7,193	3254	21.74	0.02	22.43	21.11
Nektar Therapeutics	NKTR	25,990	3117	29.12	19.10	37.38	6.48
Trio-Tech Intl	TRT	291	3019	5.26	-6.90	7.88	4.62
Forte Biosciences	FBRX	1,576	2698	10.59	-25.26	28.68	4.11

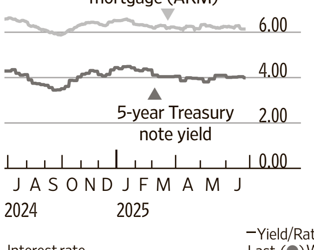
* Common stocks priced at $2 a share or more with an average volume over 65 trading days of at least 5,000 shares †Has traded fewer than 65 days

CREDIT MARKETS

Consumer Rates and Returns to Investor

U.S. consumer rates

A consumer rate against its benchmark over the past year



Selected rates

Five-year ARM, Rate

Bankrate.com avg†:	**6.14%**
Florence Savings Bank	**5.25%**
Florence, MA	800-644-8261
Baxter Credit Union	**5.38%**
Vernon Hills, IL	800-944-8143
FirstBank	**5.75%**
Lakewood, CO	303-238-9000
Union Savings Bank	**5.75%**
Danbury, CT	203-830-6955
Haven Savings Bank	**5.88%**
Hoboken, NJ	201-659-3600

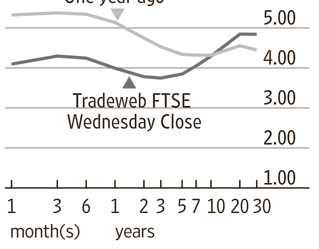
Interest rate	Yield/Rate (%) Last	Week ago	52-Week Range (%) Low	High	3-yr chg (pct pts)
Federal-funds rate target	4.25-4.50	4.25-4.50	4.25	5.50	2.75
Prime rate*	7.50	7.50	7.50	8.50	2.75
SOFR	4.30	4.31	4.26	5.40	2.84
Money market, annual yield	0.44	0.44	0.40	0.56	0.34
Five-year CD, annual yield	1.72	1.72	1.62	1.73	0.29
30-year mortgage, fixed†	6.85	6.87	6.68	7.50	0.95
15-year mortgage, fixed†	6.14	6.17	6.02	6.92	1.00
Jumbo mortgages, $726,200-plus†	6.98	7.01	6.75	7.60	1.09
Five-year adj mortgage (ARM)†	6.14	6.29	5.88	6.63	1.84
New-car loan, 48-month	7.20	7.20	6.81	7.94	2.64

Bankrate.com rates based on survey of over 1,500 online banks. *Base rate posted by 70% of the nation's largest banks.† Excludes closing costs.

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data; Bankrate.com

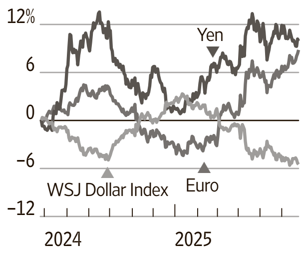
Treasury yield curve

Yield to maturity of current bills, notes and bonds



Forex Race

Yen, euro vs. dollar; dollar vs. major U.S. trading partners



Sources: Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close; Tullett Prebon; Dow Jones Market Data

Corporate Borrowing Rates and Yields

Bond total return index	Close	Yield (%) Last	Week ago	52-Week High	Low	Total Return (%) 52-wk	3-yr
U.S. Treasury, Bloomberg	2268.480	4.080	4.200	4.640	3.630	4.165	1.661
U.S. Treasury Long, Bloomberg	3111.060	4.850	4.910	5.120	3.990	−1.760	−3.347
Aggregate, Bloomberg	2167.610	4.570	4.690	5.110	4.100	4.856	2.632
Fixed-Rate MBS, Bloomberg	2145.570	4.990	5.110	5.520	4.340	5.257	2.497
High Yield 100, ICE BofA	3979.296	6.195	6.489	7.793	6.195	9.797	9.261
Muni Master, ICE BofA	590.166	3.724	3.732	4.179	3.074	0.893	2.251
EMBI Global, J.P. Morgan	941.271	7.355	7.443	8.073	7.084	8.677	7.612

Sources: J.P. Morgan; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; ICE Data Services

CURRENCIES & COMMODITIES

Currencies

U.S.-dollar foreign-exchange rates in late New York trading

Country/currency	Wed in US$	per US$	US$ vs, YTD chg (%)
Americas			
Argentina peso	.0008	1189.8115	15.4
Brazil real	.1797	5.5641	−10.0
Canada dollar	.7285	1.3727	−4.6
Chile peso	.001067	937.26	−5.7
Colombia peso	.000247	4053.75	−8.0
Ecuador US dollar	1	1	unch
Mexico peso	.0528	18.9274	−9.1
Uruguay peso	.02487	40.2150	−7.9
Asia-Pacific			
Australia dollar	.6512	1.5356	−5.0
China yuan	.1393	7.1768	−1.7
Hong Kong dollar	.1274	7.8500	1.0
India rupee	.01163	86.010	0.5
Indonesia rupiah	.0000614	16290	0.1
Japan yen	.006884	145.26	−7.6
Kazakhstan tenge	.001928	518.54	−1.2
Macau pataca	.1236	8.0910	1.1
Malaysia ringgit	.2359	4.2385	−5.2
New Zealand dollar	.6038	1.6562	−7.4
Pakistan rupee	.00352	283.700	1.9
Philippines peso	.0176	56.705	−2.4
Singapore dollar	.7822	1.2784	−6.4
South Korea won	.0007357	1359.26	−8.0
Sri Lanka rupee	.0033339	299.95	2.3
Taiwan dollar	.03404	29.379	−10.4
Thailand baht	.03076	32.510	−5.3

Country/currency	Wed in US$	per US$	US$ vs, YTD chg (%)
Vietnam dong	.00003823	26155	2.6
Europe			
Czech Rep. koruna	.04713	21.220	−12.8
Denmark krone	.1563	6.3992	−11.2
Euro area euro	1.1661	.8576	−11.2
Hungary forint	.002910	343.65	−13.5
Iceland krona	.008200	121.95	−12.3
Norway krone	.0987	10.1337	−11.0
Poland zloty	.2744	3.6446	−11.8
Sweden krona	.1054	9.4887	−14.3
Switzerland franc	1.2427	.8047	−11.3
Turkey lira	.0252	39.7586	12.5
Ukraine hryvnia	.0240	41.6500	−1.0
UK pound	1.3665	.7318	−8.4
Middle East/Africa			
Bahrain dinar	2.6508	.3772	0.04
Egypt pound	.0200	49.8941	−1.9
Israel shekel	.2937	3.4046	−6.5
Kuwait dinar	3.2715	.3057	−0.9
Oman sul rial	2.5990	.3848	−0.1
Qatar rial	.2747	3.641	−0.1
Saudi Arabia riyal	.2666	3.7506	−0.2
South Africa rand	.0563	17.7560	−5.9

	Close	Net Chg	% Chg	YTD % Chg
WSJ Dollar Index	94.76	−0.15	−0.16	−7.78

Sources: Tullett Prebon, Dow Jones Market Data

Commodities

	Wednesday Close	Net chg	% Chg	52-Week High	Low	% Chg	YTD % chg
DJ Commodity	1054.56	-1.96	-0.19	1115.06	942.52	2.94	3.15
FTSE/CC CRB Index	296.62	-0.34	-0.12	316.63	265.48	1.83	-0.03
Crude oil, $ per barrel	64.92	0.55	0.85	83.88	57.13	-19.75	-9.48
Natural gas, $/MMBtu	3.406	-0.131	-3.70	4.491	1.904	29.60	-6.25
Gold, $ per troy oz.	3327.10	9.70	0.29	3431.20	2299.20	44.71	26.54


CNBC HEADLINES
MongoDB plummets nearly 27% for worst day ever as weak outlook overshadows strong quarterly results
State Street teams up with Ray Dalio's Bridgewater on new 'All Weather' ETF
Government ethics watchdog fired by Trump drops lawsuit challenging dismissal
House censures Rep. Al Green for heckling Trump during speech to Congress
Meta is targeting 'hundreds of millions' of businesses in agentic AI deployment
SQUAWK BOX
S&P WINNERS - EXTENDED HOURS
Broadcom AVGO 197.86 +10.26%
Walgreens Boots WBA 11.25 +6.13%
Incyte INCY 72.00 +2.73%
Hologic HOLX 64.10 +2.56%
iShares Bitcoin Trust ETF IBIT 50.62 -0.02
ProShares Trust
+0.62
+0.27
IMPLIED DOW OPEN -11.08
CNBC 5:00A PACIFIC
S&P FUT MAR +4.00 +0.07%
S&P FV

BIGGEST 1,000 STOCKS

How to Read the Stock Tables

The following explanations apply to NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market listed securities. Prices are consolidated from trades reported by various market centers, including securities exchanges, Finra, electronic communications networks and other broker-dealers. The list comprises the 1,000 largest companies based on market capitalization.

Underlined quotations are those stocks with large changes in volume compared with the issue's average trading volume.

Boldfaced quotations highlight those issues whose price changed by 5% or more if their previous closing price was $2 or higher.

Footnotes:
▲-New 52-week high; ▼-New 52-week low; dd-Indicates loss in the most recent four quarters.

Stock tables reflect composite regular trading as of 4 p.m. ET and changes in the official closing prices from 4 p.m. ET the previous day.

Wednesday, June 25, 2025

A B C

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
AECOM	ACM	111.06	-1.30
Aflac	AFL	102.48	-1.68
AGNC Invt	AGNC	9.23	-0.08
ASE Tech	ASX	10.61	0.01
ASML	ASML	815.24	1.88
AST Space	**ASTS**	**49.97**	**-3.25**
AT&T	T	27.92	-0.36
ATI	ATI	82.99	-1.13
AXIS Capital	AXS	100.49	-2.43
AbbottLabs	ABT	137.40	-0.68
AbbVie	ABBV	185.39	-0.16
Accenture	ACN	294.60	-6.12
Acuity	AYI	287.49	3.05
Adobe	ADBE	387.55	5.21
AdvDrainageSys	WMS	116.08	-1.95
AdvMicroDevices	AMD	143.40	4.97
Aegon	AEG	6.88	-0.02
AerCap	AER	114.65	-1.36
▲**AeroVironment**	**AVAV**	**234.94**	**41.66**
AffirmA	AFRM	66.25	0.59
AgilentTechs	A	118.62	0.98
AgnicoEagleMines	AEM	119.78	-0.71
AgreeRealty	ADC	73.30	-1.60
AirProducts	APD	282.00	1.00
Airbnb	ABNB	129.67	-2.48
AkamaiTech	AKAM	79.53	-0.53
AlamosGold	AGI	26.11	0.26
Albertsons	ACI	21.28	-0.41
Alcon	ALC	87.57	0.36
AlexandriaRlEst	ARE	73.68	-1.69
Alibaba	BABA	114.55	-2.46
AlignTech	ALGN	187.14	0.56
Allegion	ALLE	142.82	-0.79
AlliantEnergy	LNT	60.09	-1.07
Allstate	ALL	190.94	-5.11
AllyFinancial	ALLY	38.15	0.20
AlnylamPharm	ALNY	321.94	-3.06
Alphabet C	GOOG	171.49	3.75
Alphabet A	GOOGL	170.68	3.91
Altria	MO	58.94	-0.97
Amazon.com	AMZN	211.99	-0.78
Ambev	ABEV	2.32	-0.08
Amcor	AMCR	9.05	-0.13
Amdocs	DOX	90.66	-1.96
AmerSports	AS	37.31	-0.37
Ameren	AEE	95.10	-1.27
AmericaMovil	AMX	17.33	0.08
AEP	AEP	101.41	-1.87
AmerExpress	AXP	308.59	0.21
AmericanFin	AFG	122.68	-3.45
AmHomes4Rent	AMH	35.81	-0.86
AIG	AIG	83.90	-1.56
AmerTowerREIT	AMT	220.22	-3.69
AmerWaterWorks	AWK	140.05	-2.13
Ameriprise	AMP	524.02	2.68
Ametek	AME	178.00	-1.24
Amgen	AMGN	280.35	2.86
▲Amphenol	APH	97.02	1.22
AnalogDevices	ADI	234.68	-0.30
AngloGoldAsh	AU	46.45	0.05
AB InBev	BUD	68.57	-1.64
AnnalyCap	NLY	19.24	-0.12
Ansys	ANSS	341.69	3.42
AnteroMidstream	AM	18.46	-0.04
AnteroResources	AR	41.06	-1.29
Aon	AON	354.46	-6.22
APi Group	APG	50.23	-0.50
ApolloGlbMgmt	APO	137.73	-2.18
AppFolio	APPF	230.79	-1.79
Apple	AAPL	201.56	1.26
AppliedIndlTechs	AIT	224.60	-10.29
ApplMaterials	AMAT	183.07	2.89
AppLovin	APP	338.80	-10.68
Aptargroup	ATR	153.93	0.06
Aptiv	APTV	67.41	-1.04
Aramark	ARMK	41.14	0.28
ArcelorMittal	MT	31.01	0.03
ArchCapital	ACGL	89.23	-1.74
ADM	ADM	52.30	-0.63
AresMgmt	ARES	168.80	-1.02
argenx	ARGX	560.53	-7.53
AristaNetworks	ANET	96.31	1.34
Arm	ARM	157.31	0.90
AscendisPharma	ASND	173.00	-6.10
Assurant	AIZ	194.60	-3.42
AsteraLabs	ALAB	89.63	2.37
AstraZeneca	AZN	69.68	-0.86
Atlassian	TEAM	198.36	-2.31
AtmosEnergy	ATO	152.73	-3.71
AuroraInnov	AUR	5.29	-0.16
Autodesk	ADSK	302.37	-1.82
▲Autoliv	ALV	110.65	-1.28
ADP	ADP	298.19	-13.21
AutoZone	AZO	3489.54	-88.00
Avalonbay	AVB	201.22	-4.91
Avantor	AVTR	13.58	0.12
AveryDennison	AVY	176.60	-2.53
AxonEnterprise	AXON	785.07	-9.18
BCE	BCE	21.94	-0.04
BHP Group	BHP	46.74	-0.55
BJ'sWholesale	BJ	113.75	-0.34
BP	BP	30.32	0.49
BWX Tech	BWXT	140.86	-1.45
BXP	**BXP**	**66.64**	**-3.70**
Baidu	BIDU	86.65	-0.03
BakerHughes	BKR	37.58	-0.39
Ball	BALL	56.75	-0.23
BBVA	BBVA	14.88	-0.44
BancoBradesco	BBDO	2.64	...
BancodeChile	BCH	29.46	-0.11
BancSanBrasil	BSBR	5.23	-0.16
BcoSantChile	BSAC	24.39	-0.05
BancoSantander	SAN	8.03	-0.24
BankofAmerica	BAC	46.85	0.19
BankMontreal	BMO	106.64	-0.09
BankNY Mellon	BK	90.00	-1.20
BankNovaScotia	BNS	54.26	-0.09
Barclays	BCS	18.17	-0.09
BarrickMining	B	20.87	0.19
BaxterIntl	BAX	30.61	0.02
BectonDicknsn	BDX	170.90	-0.67
▲BentleySystems	BSY	52.42	-0.13
BeOneMed	ONC	267.13	0.32
Berkley	WRB	71.80	-1.47
BerkHathwy A	BRK.A	730000	-10085
BerkHathwy B	BRK.B	486.21	-7.27
BestBuy	BBY	68.00	-0.84
Bilibili	BILI	20.78	0.08
Biogen	BIIB	127.31	1.00
BioMarinPharm	BMRN	54.14	-0.55
BioNTech	BNTX	104.80	-0.29
Birkenstock	BIRK	49.50	-0.92
BlackRock	BLK	1018.08	13.11
Blackstone	BX	143.57	-0.48
Block	XYZ	64.81	-0.53
BlueOwlCapital	OWL	19.03	-0.08
BlueprintMed	BPMC	128.25	-0.01
Boeing	BA	198.90	-2.04
Booking	BKNG	5485.35	3.12
BoozAllen	BAH	101.34	1.18
BostonSci	BSX	104.29	0.17
▲BridgeBioPharma	BBIO	44.38	-0.07
BrinkerIntl	EAT	176.67	-3.33
BristolMyers	BMY	46.68	-0.35
BritishAmTob	BTI	47.76	-0.74
BrixmorProp	BRX	25.46	-0.61
▲Broadcom	AVGO	264.65	0.88
BroadridgeFinl	BR	238.16	-3.64
BrookfieldAsset	BAM	54.38	-1.30
Brookfield	BN	60.20	-1.12
BrookfieldInfr	BIP	33.08	-0.07
BrookWealth	BNT	60.15	-1.25
Brown&Brown	BRO	108.38	-2.57
Brown-Forman B	BF.B	26.06	-0.23
Brown-Forman A	BF.A	26.69	-0.17
BuildersFirst	BLDR	115.96	-2.88
BungeGlobal	BG	82.22	-1.37
BurlingtonStrs	BURL	226.09	-2.01
CACI Intl	CACI	460.91	8.74
CAVA	CAVA	73.99	-0.24
CBRE Group	CBRE	135.22	-3.91
CDW	CDW	177.83	-2.01
CF Industries	CF	91.40	-3.28
CGI A	GIB	103.50	-2.03
CH Robinson	CHRW	92.71	-1.57
CME Group	CME	273.03	1.65
CMS Energy	CMS	68.57	-1.14
CNA Fin	CNA	45.41	-0.68
CNH Indl	CNH	12.60	-0.28
CRH	CRH	88.67	-2.85
CSX	CSX	32.49	0.01
CVS Health	CVS	66.37	-1.21
CadenceDesign	CDNS	297.53	0.73
CAE	CAE	26.33	-0.11
CamdenProperty	CPT	113.06	-2.47
Cameco	CCJ	71.43	-0.91
▼Campbell's	CPB	31.18	-0.99
CIBC	CM	70.19	-0.06
CanNtlRlwy	CNI	101.38	-0.74
CanadianNatRscs	CNQ	31.37	-0.15
CdnPacKC	CP	77.91	-1.35
CapitalOne	COF	208.03	1.67
CardinalHealth	CAH	163.75	-0.46
Carlisle	CSL	371.79	-0.12
Carlyle	CG	49.13	...
CarMax	KMX	67.50	-1.71
Carnival	CCL	25.48	-0.22
Carnival	CUK	23.16	-0.10
▲CarpenterTech	CRS	264.00	-1.52
CarrierGlobal	CARR	72.43	-0.03
Carvana	CVNA	315.76	-7.21
CaseysGenStores	CASY	505.13	-5.78
Caterpillar	CAT	371.58	-1.44
▲Celestica	CLS	149.04	5.20
CelsiusHldg	CELH	45.47	0.06
Cemex	CX	6.74	-0.20
Cencora	COR	292.32	-1.80
CenovusEnergy	CVE	13.64	-0.07
Centene	CNC	53.51	-0.54
CenterPointEner	CNP	36.30	-0.18
CentraisElBras	EBR	7.17	-0.16
CharterComms	CHTR	398.85	-4.65
CheckPoint	CHKP	218.93	-0.63
Chemed	CHE	552.50	-4.82
CheniereEnergy	LNG	236.32	-3.63
CheniereEnerPtrs	CQP	54.61	-1.79
Chevron	CVX	143.23	-0.32
Chewy	CHWY	42.63	-0.76
ChimeFinl	**CHYM**	**31.59**	**2.59**
Chipotle	CMG	55.14	0.49
Chubb	CB	282.82	-3.96
▲ChunghwaTel	CHT	46.29	0.14
Church&Dwight	CHD	95.25	-0.77
Ciena	CIEN	79.43	0.08
Cigna	CI	316.00	-0.83
CincinnatiFinl	CINF	143.72	-2.97
Cintas	CTAS	219.24	-3.96
CircleInternet	**CRCL**	**198.62**	**-24.03**
▲CiscoSystems	CSCO	68.19	0.30
Citigroup	C	82.63	1.49
CitizensFin	CFG	43.12	0.20
CleanHarbors	CLH	228.45	-4.20
▼Clorox	CLX	119.48	-2.54
▲Cloudflare	NET	190.12	3.69
Coca-Cola	KO	69.63	-0.58
Coca-ColaCon	COKE	107.65	-1.60
CocaColaEuropac	CCEP	91.56	-1.11
CognizantTech	CTSH	76.98	-0.61
Coherent	**COHR**	**85.63**	**4.67**
▲CoinbaseGlbl	COIN	355.37	10.55
ColgatePalm	CL	87.80	-0.38
Comcast A	CMCSA	34.84	-0.37
ComfortSystems	FIX	507.60	-5.72
CommerceBcshrs	CBSH	61.05	-0.42
SABESP	SBS	20.41	-0.38
ComstockRscs	CRK	28.33	-1.24
▼ConagraBrands	CAG	20.45	-1.01
Confluent	CFLT	23.89	-0.11
ConocoPhillips	COP	89.00	-0.39
ConEd	ED	98.05	-2.14
ConstBrands A	STZ	161.53	-2.96
ConstellationEner	CEG	315.14	-5.52
Cooper	COO	69.54	-1.39
Copart	CPRT	48.14	-0.51
CorceptTherap	CORT	73.99	-2.78
Core&Main	CNM	58.90	-0.50
CorebridgeFin	CRBG	33.07	-0.18
CoreWeave	**CRWV**	**159.50**	**-13.12**
Corning	GLW	51.39	-0.03
Corpay	CPAY	326.47	-3.00
Corteva	CTVA	73.24	-0.05
CoStar	CSGP	81.26	0.26
Costco	COST	986.54	-15.38
CoterraEnergy	CTRA	26.07	-0.74
Coupang	CPNG	28.84	-0.11
Crane	CR	185.27	0.92
Credicorp	BAP	217.43	-0.36
▲CredoTech	CRDO	92.20	0.28
▲CrowdStrike	CRWD	494.09	8.71
CrownCastle	CCI	101.82	-1.37
Crown Holdings	CCK	103.92	-0.47
CubeSmart	CUBE	42.13	-0.98
Cullen/Frost	CFR	127.10	0.60
Cummins	CMI	318.75	-5.10
▲Curtiss-Wright	CW	476.50	0.48
CyberArkSoftware	CYBR	399.44	2.31

D E F

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
DTE Energy	DTE	130.87	-2.35
DT Midstream	DTM	106.81	-0.57
Danaher	DHR	201.00	3.53
Darden	DRI	217.46	-3.37
Datadog	DDOG	130.24	-0.59
DaVita	DVA	140.36	-0.59
Dayforce	DAY	55.00	-2.75
DeckersOutdoor	DECK	101.04	-1.18
Deere	DE	506.74	-7.36
DellTechC	DELL	120.46	-0.13
DeltaAir	DAL	48.31	-1.25
DescartesSystems	DSGX	100.60	-2.83
DeutscheBank	DB	29.28	-0.03
DevonEnergy	DVN	32.13	-0.22
DexCom	DXCM	84.68	-2.89
Diageo	DEO	99.86	-1.34
DiamondbkEner	FANG	138.04	-1.31
Dick's	DKS	185.66	7.39
DigitalRealty	DLR	172.25	-5.41
Disney	DIS	119.42	0.77
DocuSign	DOCU	75.01	-0.63
DollarGeneral	DG	112.77	-0.54
DollarTree	DLTR	99.45	0.77
DominionEner	D	55.20	-0.78
Domino's	DPZ	453.13	-6.84
Donaldson	DCI	69.03	-0.33
▲DoorDash	DASH	232.68	-3.49
Dover	DOV	180.05	0.11
Dow	DOW	26.82	-0.71
Doximity	DOCS	60.17	1.53
DrReddy'sLab	RDY	15.50	-0.09
DraftKings	DKNG	42.74	-0.07
Dropbox	DBX	28.54	-0.30
DukeEnergy	DUK	115.95	-1.00
Duolingo	**DUOL**	**397.68**	**-25.11**
DuPont	DD	67.99	-0.22
DutchBros	BROS	68.55	-1.84
Dynatrace	DT	54.69	-1.07
EMCOR	EME	502.57	1.92
ENI	E	31.95	-0.02
EOG Rscs	EOG	119.82	-0.86
EPAM Systems	EPAM	173.10	0.35
EQT	EQT	58.23	-2.11
EastWestBncp	EWBC	98.83	-0.13
EastGroup	EGP	167.91	-5.81
EastmanChem	EMN	75.87	-0.59
Eaton	ETN	342.35	-0.91
eBay	EBAY	74.52	0.17
Ecolab	ECL	266.46	-0.38
Ecopetrol	EC	9.33	-0.07
EdisonIntl	EIX	50.41	-0.98
EdwardsLife	EW	76.97	1.12
Elastic	ESTC	80.98	-2.93
ElbitSystems	ESLT	431.61	9.07
ElectronicArts	EA	157.82	-0.13
ElevanceHealth	ELV	373.86	-2.56
Embraer	ERJ	52.90	-0.33
Emera	EMA	44.85	-0.04
EmersonElec	EMR	129.44	-1.29
Enbridge	ENB	44.48	-0.56
EncompassHealth	EHC	120.67	-0.25
EnergyTransfer	ET	17.67	-0.02
EnsignGroup	ENSG	152.52	-1.05
Entegris	ENTG	82.15	0.42
Entergy	ETR	81.32	-1.65
EnterpriseProd	EPD	30.75	-0.37
Equifax	EFX	258.03	-3.78
Equinix	**EQIX**	**824.31**	**-82.19**
Equinor	EQNR	25.10	-0.05
Equitable	EQH	54.41	0.42
EquityLife	ELS	62.40	-1.13
EquityResdntl	EQR	65.64	-1.90
▼ErieIndemnity	ERIE	341.30	-12.33
EssentialUtil	WTRG	37.09	-0.77
EssexProp	ESS	281.90	-4.13
EsteeLauder	EL	77.56	0.51
EvercoreA	EVR	267.06	1.93
Everest	EG	336.44	-4.39
Evergy	EVRG	68.19	-0.59
EversourceEner	ES	62.46	-1.38
ExactSciences	EXAS	51.92	0.75
Exelixis	EXEL	43.53	-2.19
Exelon	EXC	42.29	-0.81
ExpandEnergy	EXE	119.08	-3.45
Expedia	EXPE	165.75	-3.47
ExpeditorsIntl	EXPD	112.28	-1.88
ExtraSpaceSt	EXR	145.44	-3.09
ExxonMobil	XOM	108.37	0.03
F5	FFIV	294.41	-1.49
FTAI Aviation	**FTAI**	**125.00**	**-10.05**
▲Fabrinet	FN	285.89	9.39
FactSet	FDS	439.87	2.27
FairIsaac	FICO	1893.45	-33.07
Fastenal	FAST	41.12	-0.41
FederalRealty	FRT	93.71	-2.56
FedEx	FDX	222.00	-7.51
FergusonEnts	FERG	219.40	0.25
Ferrari	RACE	475.12	2.70
Ferrovial	FER	52.25	0.15
FidNatlFinl	FNF	55.24	-0.78
FidNatlInfo	FIS	80.73	-1.40
FifthThirdBncp	FITB	40.68	0.09
FirstCitizBcshA	FCNCA	1911.75	3.33
FirstHorizon	FHN	20.34	-0.04
FirstSolar	FSLR	152.70	1.52
FirstEnergy	FE	39.92	-0.59
FirstService	FSV	171.37	-5.94
Fiserv	FI	170.36	-2.30
▲Flex	FLEX	49.02	1.11
Floor&Decor	FND	76.00	-0.68
Fluor	FLR	49.75	-1.49
FlutterEnt	FLUT	267.98	-7.85
FEMSA	FMX	100.78	-0.45
FordMotor	F	10.48	-0.25
Fortinet	FTNT	103.69	-0.73
Fortis	FTS	46.60	-0.77
Fortive	FTV	70.08	-0.59
FoxA	FOXA	55.99	0.09
FoxB	FOX	51.38	0.07
Franco-Nevada	FNV	163.40	-1.80
FranklinRscs	BEN	23.21	-0.02
FreedomHolding	FRHC	143.14	-2.04
FreeportMcM	FCX	41.61	-0.40
FreseniusMedCare	FMS	27.73	-0.07
FrontierComms	FYBR	36.33	-0.03
FullTruck	YMM	12.07	-0.47

G H I

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
GE Aerospace	GE	249.90	1.15
GE HealthCare	GEHC	72.75	0.77
▲GE Vernova	GEV	502.67	-8.17
GFLEnvironmental	GFL	49.69	-0.33
GSK	GSK	38.28	-0.40
Gallagher	AJG	317.43	-8.55
GameStop	GME	23.55	0.26
Gaming&Leisure	GLPI	46.39	-0.94
Gap	GAP	21.46	-0.11
Garmin	GRMN	203.54	-1.54
Gartner	IT	402.64	2.25
GenDigital	GEN	29.08	-0.29
Generac	GNRC	139.42	3.44
GeneralDynamics	GD	285.91	4.86
▼**GeneralMills**	**GIS**	**50.68**	**-2.73**
GeneralMotors	GM	48.13	-0.87
Genmab	GMAB	20.52	-0.22
GenuineParts	GPC	119.15	-2.05
GileadSciences	GILD	105.93	-1.27
GlobalPayments	GPN	77.72	-1.26
GlobalFoundries	GFS	38.57	-0.52
GlobeLife	GL	121.42	-1.49
GoDaddy	GDDY	177.37	-2.12
GoldFields	GFI	24.01	0.17
GoldmanSachs	GS	669.87	7.76
Grab	GRAB	4.59	-0.15
Graco	GGG	85.29	-0.25
Grainger	GWW	1023.87	-17.51
GAP	PAC	223.57	2.56
ASUR	ASR	309.95	3.36
▲GrupoCibest	CIB	45.20	0.23
GpoFinGalicia	GGAL	51.67	-1.01
Guidewire	GWRE	236.01	-1.44
HCA Healthcare	HCA	374.19	-4.83
HDFC Bank	HDB	75.96	0.86
HP	HPQ	24.53	-0.01
HSBC	HSBC	61.09	0.37
H World	HTHT	34.05	-0.50
Haleon	HLN	10.50	0.01
Halliburton	HAL	20.26	-0.52
HarmonyGold	HMY	14.02	-0.07
HartfordIns	HIG	124.00	-2.58
Hasbro	HAS	71.68	-0.90
HealthEquity	HQY	103.97	-0.21
HealthpeakProp	DOC	17.31	-0.18
Heico	HEI	316.73	-0.88
HeicoA	HEI.A	248.86	-0.50
HenrySchein	HSIC	72.79	0.11
Hershey	HSY	167.54	-4.51
Hess	HES	138.12	-0.48
HessMidstream	HESM	37.78	-0.44
HewlettPackard	HPE	18.49	0.34
Hilton	HLT	253.72	-2.21
Hims&HersHealth	HIMS	41.41	-1.54
Hologic	HOLX	64.27	-0.56
HomeDepot	HD	361.86	1.44
HondaMotor	HMC	28.59	-0.29
Honeywell	HON	221.79	-2.81
HormelFoods	HRL	29.84	-0.56
DR Horton	DHI	127.29	-2.34
HostHotels	HST	15.50	-0.17
HoulihanLokey	HLI	181.19	1.34
▲HowmetAerospace	HWM	176.08	-0.49
Hubbell	HUBB	399.06	-3.93
HubSpot	HUBS	543.36	-13.96
Humana	HUM	238.51	-0.28
JBHunt	JBHT	142.74	-0.69
HuntingtonBcshs	HBAN	16.28	0.02
HuntingIngalls	HII	235.12	3.49
HyattHotels	H	137.10	1.08
ICICI Bank	IBN	32.89	-0.01
ICL Group	ICL	6.73	0.09
IDEX	IEX	174.50	-0.38
▲IdexxLab	IDXX	530.40	-0.10
ING Groep	ING	21.30	-0.06
IQVIA	IQV	158.71	0.13
ITT	ITT	154.78	-0.24
IcahnEnterprises	IEP	8.00	-0.13
Icon	ICLR	145.91	-2.63
IllinoisToolWks	ITW	245.69	-0.11
Illumina	ILMN	93.23	1.71
ImperialOil	IMO	80.08	1.33
Incyte	INCY	67.55	-1.46
Informatica	INFA	24.25	0.05
Infosys	INFY	18.51	0.21
IngersollRand	IR	83.28	-0.41
Ingredion	INGR	134.04	-3.46
▲Insmed	INSM	104.85	-1.05
Insulet	PODD	306.23	-4.67
Intel	INTC	22.20	-0.35
InteractiveBrkrs	IBKR	52.26	0.62
ICE	ICE	180.53	-0.32
InterContHtls	IHG	113.73	-1.33
▲IBM	IBM	291.06	-2.73
IntlFlavors	IFF	74.23	-0.49
IntlPaper	IP	46.40	-0.19
Interpublic	IPG	24.11	-0.58
Intuit	INTU	757.86	-1.17
IntuitiveSurgical	ISRG	521.63	-1.45
InvitatHomes	INVH	32.96	-0.87
IonQ	**IONQ**	**38.11**	**-2.75**
IronMountain	IRM	102.68	-2.57
ItauUnibanco	ITUB	6.59	-0.20

J K L

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
JBS	JBS	13.87	0.06
JD.com	JD	32.94	0.36
▲JPMorganChase	JPM	284.06	2.80
▲Jabil	JBL	214.66	2.71
JackHenry	JKHY	178.06	-2.96
JacobsSolns	J	128.06	-1.48
JamesHardie	JHX	25.60	0.97
JefferiesFinl	JEF	55.92	0.58
J&J	JNJ	152.28	0.09
JohnsonControls	JCI	103.35	-0.25
JonesLang	JLL	244.50	-6.38
JuniperNetworks	JNPR	36.55	-0.01
KB Financial	KB	81.31	-1.13
KE Holdings	BEKE	18.33	-0.12
KKR	KKR	128.84	1.07
KLA	KLAC	893.46	4.43
KT	KT	19.92	-0.35
Kanzhun	BZ	17.55	-0.54
Kaspi.kz	KSPI	82.14	0.60
Kellanova	K	77.85	-0.67
Kenvue	KVUE	21.17	-0.02
KeurigDrPepper	KDP	32.98	-0.57
KeyCorp	KEY	16.77	0.02
KeysightTech	KEYS	164.12	-0.61
KilroyRealty	KRC	34.12	-0.66
KimberlyClark	KMB	128.15	-1.80
KimcoRealty	KIM	20.83	-0.41
KinderMorgan	KMI	28.31	-0.23
KinrossGold	KGC	15.31	...
KinsaleCapital	KNSL	465.83	-12.50
Klaviyo	KVYO	32.76	-0.20
Philips	PHG	23.92	0.02
▲KoreaElecPwr	KEP	13.70	1.09
KraftHeinz	KHC	25.73	-0.30
Kroger	KR	72.22	-1.20

Continued on Page B10

Dividend Changes

Company	Symbol	Yld %	Amount New/Old	Frq	Payable / Record
Stocks					
AYRO	AYRO		1:16		/Jun26
Brera Holdings	BREA		1:10		/Jun26
Foreign					
Banco Bradesco Ord ADR	BBDO	5.3	.00314	M	Aug11/Jul03

Note: Dividend yields as of 3:30 p.m. ET

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

KEY: A: annual; M: monthly; Q: quarterly; r: revised; SA: semiannual; S2:1: stock split and ratio; SO: spin-off.

Borrowing Benchmarks

wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Money Rates

June 25, 2025

Key annual interest rates paid to borrow or lend money in U.S. and international markets. Rates below are a guide to general levels but don't always represent actual transactions.

Inflation

	May index level	Chg From (%) April '25	May '24
U.S. consumer price index			
All items	321.465	0.21	2.4
Core	327.509	0.21	2.8

International rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Prime rates				
U.S.	7.50	7.50	8.50	7.50
Canada	4.95	4.95	6.95	4.95
Japan	1.875	1.875	1.875	1.475
Policy Rates				
Euro zone	2.15	2.15	4.25	2.15
Switzerland	0.50	0.75	1.75	0.50
Britain	4.25	4.25	5.25	4.25
Australia	3.85	3.85	4.35	3.85
Overnight repurchase				
U.S.	4.40	4.33	5.45	4.00

U.S. government rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Discount	4.50	4.50	5.50	4.50
Federal funds				
Effective rate	4.3300	4.3300	5.3400	4.3200
High	4.5500	4.5500	5.6500	4.3700
Low	4.3200	4.3200	5.3300	4.3000
Bid	4.3200	4.3200	5.3300	4.3200
Offer	4.3300	4.3300	5.3600	4.3300
Treasury bill auction				
4 weeks	4.060	4.060	5.285	4.060
13 weeks	4.195	4.240	5.240	4.175
26 weeks	4.120	4.155	5.140	4.000

Other short-term rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week high	52-Week low
Call money	6.25	6.25	7.25	6.25
Commercial paper (AA financial)				
90 days	n.a.	4.28	5.35	4.19
Secured Overnight Financing Rate	4.30	4.31	5.40	4.26

DTCC GCF Repo Index	Latest	Value Traded	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Treasury	4.408	30.152	5.471	4.286
MBS	4.422	80.410	5.526	4.294

Weekly survey

	Latest	Week ago	Year ago
Freddie Mac			
30-year fixed	6.81	6.81	6.87
15-year fixed	5.96	5.96	6.13

Notes on data:

U.S. prime rate is the base rate on corporate loans posted by at least 70% of the 10 largest U.S. banks, and is effective December 19, 2024. **Other prime rates** aren't directly comparable; lending practices vary widely by location; **Discount rate** is effective December 19, 2024. **Secured Overnight Financing Rate** is as of June 24, 2025. **DTCC GCF Repo Index** is Depository Trust & Clearing Corp.'s weighted average for overnight trades in applicable CUSIPs. Value traded is in billions of U.S. dollars. **Federal-funds rates** are Tullett Prebon rates as of 5:30 p.m. ET.

Sources: Federal Reserve; Bureau of Labor Statistics; DTCC; FactSet; Tullett Prebon Information, Ltd.

IPO Scorecard

Performance of IPOs, most-recent listed first

Company SYMBOL / IPO date/Offer price	Wed's close ($)	% Chg From Offer price	% Chg From 1st-day close
Kandal M Venture / **FMFC** June 25/$4.00	4.40	10.0	...
LightWave Acquisition / **LWACU** June 25/$10.00	10.03	0.3	...
Oxley Bridge Acquisition / **OBAWU** June 25/$10.00	10.00	...	...
Happy City Hldgs / **HCHL** June 24/$5.00	5.38	7.6	7.6
Axiom Intelligence Acquisition 1 / **AXINU** June 18/$10.00	10.09	0.9	0.5
Caris Life Sciences / **CAI** June 18/$21.00	26.43	25.9	-5.6
Enigmatig / **EGG** June 18/$5.00	3.54	-29.2	-45.8
Pioneer Acquisition I / **PACHU** June 18/$10.00	10.00	...	-0.1
Slide Insurance Hldgs / **SLDE** June 18/$17.00	21.32	25.4	5.3
Jyong Biotech / **MENS** June 17/$7.50	8.29	10.5	-18.0

Sources: Dow Jones Market Data; FactSet

COMMODITIES

wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Futures Contracts

Metal & Petroleum Futures

	Open	Contract High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Copper-High (CMX)-25,000 lbs.; $ per lb.						
June	4.8905	4.8915	4.8900	4.9130	0.0460	1,160
Sept	4.9485	4.9850	4.9260	4.9715	0.0470	95,966
Gold (CMX)-100 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
June	3321.60	3331.20	3310.60	3327.10	9.70	324
July	3322.90	3335.60	3312.00	3329.00	9.00	6,405
Aug	3338.10	3351.30	3325.50	3343.10	9.20	323,411
Sept	3352.00	3363.00	3342.60	3357.90	9.30	872
Oct	3365.00	3378.90	3353.70	3370.80	9.40	22,386
Nov	3388.60	3390.30	3386.70	3385.70	9.60	145
Palladium (NYM)-50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
June	1091.50	1096.00	1084.00	1065.40	-1.60	4
Sept	1077.50	1083.50	1048.50	1067.40	1.10	19,035
Platinum (NYM)-50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
June	1337.70	1345.80 ▲	1303.00	1329.60	25.40	50
Oct	1331.10	1377.90 ▲	1308.00	1343.00	20.80	77,261
Silver (CMX)-5,000 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
June	35.830	35.830	35.600	36.085	0.384	9
Sept	36.190	36.615	35.960	36.441	0.374	106,541
Crude Oil, Light Sweet (NYM)-1,000 bbls.; $ per bbl.						
Aug	65.12	66.03	64.51	64.92	0.55	292,144
Sept	63.85	64.53	63.20	63.46	0.31	235,886
Oct	62.91	63.38	62.19	62.35	0.13	136,369
Dec	62.05	62.50	61.16	61.24	-0.16	247,458
June'26	62.05	62.47	60.98	61.09	-0.41	113,499
Dec	62.33	62.62	61.22	61.37	-0.38	151,152
NY Harbor ULSD (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.						
July	2.3242	2.3360	2.2816	2.2964	.0113	18,256
Aug	2.2816	2.2997	2.2495	2.2565	.0069	86,589
Gasoline-NY RBOB (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.						
July	2.1071	2.1217	2.0790	2.0824	-.0023	27,504
Aug	2.0923	2.1083	2.0639	2.0660	-.0049	121,348
Natural Gas (NYM)-10,000 MMBtu.; $ per MMBtu.						
July	3.549	3.587	3.372	3.406	-.131	14,705
Aug	3.677	3.709	3.554	3.569	-.086	153,910
Sept	3.675	3.706	3.570	3.582	-.069	170,664
Oct	3.767	3.797	3.672	3.686	-.060	143,250
Nov	4.147	4.184	4.071	4.086	-.048	113,753
Jan'26	5.010	5.040	4.945	4.959	-.035	137,360

Agriculture Futures

	Open	Contract High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Corn (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	415.50	417.50 ▼	408.00	410.25	-6.00	158,136
Dec	429.25	430.50 ▼	421.00	422.50	-6.50	567,044
Oats (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	357.00	364.75	355.00	359.25	-4.25	298
Dec	347.00	347.00	338.50	341.00	-3.25	1,925
Soybeans (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	1047.25	1054.75	1023.50	1025.25	-21.50	81,155
Nov	1037.00	1041.75	1017.00	1018.50	-18.50	358,281
Soybean Meal (CBT)-100 tons; $ per ton.						
July	280.50	281.00 ▼	275.50	276.00	-4.50	53,876
Dec	295.60	295.80 ▼	290.30	290.70	-4.60	253,135
Soybean Oil (CBT)-60,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	52.30	52.93	51.64	51.82	-.35	31,726
Dec	52.75	53.34	52.18	52.32	-.29	254,217
Rough Rice (CBT)-2,000 cwt.; $ per cwt.						
July	13.55	13.58	13.20	13.26	-.30	1,577
Sept	13.90	13.91	13.52	13.59	-.31	6,752
Wheat (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	535.00	537.00	526.50	528.25	-7.50	30,337
Sept	551.75	553.50	542.50	544.50	-7.50	190,740
Wheat (KC)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	535.00	536.50	522.00	524.25	-10.50	23,392
Sept	551.50	551.75	537.00	539.25	-10.50	146,117
Cattle-Feeder (CME)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Aug	303.025	304.300	301.575	302.300	.050	43,006
Sept	303.400	304.475	301.850	302.600	.150	19,594
Cattle-Live (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
June	222.350	222.825	221.375	221.600	...	3,694
Aug	210.000	210.950	208.600	208.975	-.575	155,005
Hogs-Lean (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	111.975	113.075	111.500	112.825	.600	35,468
Aug	110.750	111.775	110.125	111.225	.275	116,193
Lumber (CME)-27,500 bd. ft., $ per 1,000 bd. ft.						
July	609.50	619.00	604.50	618.50	9.00	3,592
Sept	638.50	648.50	635.50	648.00	9.00	3,584
Milk (CME)-200,000 lbs., cents per lb.						
June	18.68	18.76	18.67	18.67	...	3,451
July	16.96	17.21 ▼	16.94	17.00	.04	4,001
Cocoa (ICE-US)-10 metric tons; $ per ton.						
July	9,300	9,300	9,138	9,081	-355	671
Sept	8,761	8,937	8,630	8,696	-67	40,383
Coffee (ICE-US)-37,500 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	325.25	325.25	315.00	308.65	-6.70	602
Sept	317.50	322.60 ▼	300.60	304.50	-6.85	71,834
Sugar-World (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	15.77	16.00 ▼	15.70	15.98	.21	58,791
Oct	16.36	16.65	16.31	16.61	.25	408,329
Sugar-Domestic (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Sept	34.95	34.95 ▼	34.95	34.95	...	742
Jan'26	34.70	34.70	34.70	34.70	...	1,464
Cotton (ICE-US)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	66.56	67.02	66.56	66.44	.43	232
Dec	67.80	68.70	67.65	68.32	.53	156,034
Orange Juice (ICE-US)-15,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	226.20	241.85	226.20	236.80	8.00	1,170
Sept	229.10	245.00	229.10	239.45	8.45	6,012

Interest Rate Futures

	Open	Contract High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Ultra Treasury Bonds (CBT) - $100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	117-290	118-130	117-040	117-270	-7.0	1,881,442
Treasury Bonds (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	114-200	115-000	114-010	114-180	-5.0	1,765,809
Dec	114-110	114-190	113-220	114-060	-5.0	2,294
Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	111-190	111-240	111-175	111-220	1.0	4,914,480
Dec	111-175	111-215	111-100	111-200	1.0	3,931
5 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
June	108-227	108-227	108-172	108-230	1.2	2,003
Sept	108-212	108-257	108-167	108-240	1.2	7,071,409
2 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$200,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
June	103-137	103-217	103-206	103-231	1.2	100
Sept	103-280	103-299	103-265	103-291	.2	4,158,456
30 Day Federal Funds (CBT)-$5,000,000; 100 - daily avg.						
June	95.6700	95.6725 ▼	95.6700	95.6700		354,403
July	95.6700	95.6750 ▼	95.6700	95.6750		475,857
Three-Month SOFR (CME)-$1,000,000; 100 - daily avg.						
April	95.6675	95.6700	95.6650	95.6675	-.0025	8,864
June	95.6750	95.6825	95.6700	95.6775	.0025	1,292,901

Currency Futures

	Open	Contract High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Japanese Yen (CME)-¥12,500,000; $ per 100¥						
July	.6917	.6930	.6866	.6904	-.0023	1,662
Sept	.6965	.6980	.6915	.6953	-.0023	309,848
Canadian Dollar (CME)-CAD 100,000; $ per CAD						
July	.7293	.7295	.7281	.7292	-.0002	562
Sept	.7316	.7321	.7301	.7315	-.0002	196,075
British Pound (CME)-£62,500; $ per £						
July	1.3621	1.3672 ▲	1.3593	1.3664	.0032	680
Sept	1.3622	1.3678 ▲	1.3598	1.3670	.0032	178,015
Swiss Franc (CME)-CHF 125,000; $ per CHF						
Sept	1.2544	1.2567	1.2504	1.2563	.0001	69,056
Dec	1.2663	1.2700	1.2640	1.2699	...	377
Australian Dollar (CME)-AUD 100,000; $ per AUD						
July	.6490	.6513	.6487	.6512	.0005	881
Sept	.6500	.6526	.6495	.6521	.0005	149,029
Mexican Peso (CME)-MXN 500,000; $ per MXN						
July	.05194	.05272	.05252	.05279	.00026	156
Sept	.05216	.05245	.05209	.05243	.00027	146,652
Euro (CME)-€125,000; $ per €						
July	1.1623	1.1680 ▲	1.1605	1.1676	.0036	5,255
Sept	1.1672	1.1729 ▲	1.1653	1.1725	.0036	744,598

Index Futures

	Open	Contract High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Mini DJ Industrial Average (CBT)-$5 x index						
Sept	43419	43468	43174	43306	-118	81,825
Dec	43754	43758	43481	43611	-115	425
Mini S&P 500 (CME)-$50 x index						
Sept	6144.75	6160.25	6130.75	6147.00	0.75	1,874,134
Dec	6190.25	6210.50	6182.25	6197.75	0.50	9,635
Mini S&P Midcap 400 (CME)-$100 x index						
Sept	3099.90	3106.10	3071.40	3077.00	-26.20	35,526
Dec		3124.40	3115.00	3099.70	-24.80	n.a.
Mini Nasdaq 100 (CME)-$20 x index						
Sept	22412.00	22548.25	22384.50	22461.00	48.25	252,931
Dec	22607.75	22764.50	22603.75	22676.75	47.50	338
Mini Russell 2000 (CME)-$50 x index						
Sept	2176.50	2181.50	2149.20	2153.30	-24.60	389,460
Dec	2190.00	2197.00	2165.90	2169.50	-24.90	294
Mini Russell 1000 (CME)-$50 x index						
Sept	3360.70	3369.70	3354.10	3361.60	-2.60	5,340
U.S. Dollar Index (ICE-US)-$1,000 x index						
Sept	97.54	97.80	97.23	97.27	-.18	30,757
Dec	97.16	97.45 ▼	96.90	96.92	-.18	468

Source: FactSet

Cash Prices

Wednesday, June 25, 2025

These prices reflect buying and selling of a variety of actual or "physical" commodities in the marketplace—separate from the futures price on an exchange, which reflects what the commodity might be worth in future months.

	Wednesday
Energy	
Coal,C.Aplc.,12500Btu,1.2SO2-r,w	79.000
Coal,PwdrRvrBsn,8800Btu,0.8SO2-r,w	14.300
Metals	
Gold, per troy oz	
Engelhard industrial	3317.00
LBMA Gold Price AM	*3319.50
LBMA Gold Price PM	*3302.50
Krugerrand,wholesale-e	3479.96
Maple Leaf-e	3563.22
American Eagle-e	3563.22
Mexican peso-e	4296.17
Austria crown-e	3267.17
Austria phil-e	3496.62
Silver, troy oz.	
Engelhard industrial	35.8000
Handy & Harman base	36.0350
Handy & Harman fabricated	45.0440
LBMA spot price	*£26.5000
(U.S.$ equivalent)	*36.0650
Coins,wholesale $1,000 face-a	26936
Other metals	
LBMA Platinum Price PM	*1304.0
LBMA Palladium Price PM	*1071.0
Platinum,Engelhard industrial	1312.0
Palladium,Engelhard industrial	1058.0
Aluminum, LME, $ per metric ton	*2572.5
Copper,Comex spot	4.9130

	Wednesday
Iron Ore, 62% Fe CFR China-s	*93.0
Steel, HRC USA, FOB Midwest Mill-s	*865.0
Battery/EV metals	
BMI Lithium Carbonate, EXW China, =99.5%-v,w	8300
BMI Lithium Hydroxide, EXW China, =56.5% -v,w	8250
BMI Cobalt sulphate, EXW China, >20.5% -v,w	6603
BMI Nickel Sulphate, EXW China, >22%-v,k	3600
BMI Flake Graphite, FOB China, -100 Mesh, 94-95% -v,m	435
Fibers and Textiles	
Burlap,10-oz,40-inch NY yd-n,w	0.8950
Cotton,1 1/16 std lw-mdMphs-u	0.6662
Cotlook 'A' Index-t	*78.40
Hides,hvy native steers piece fob-u	n.a.
Wool,64s,staple,Terr del-u,w	n.a.
Grains and Feeds	
Bran,wheat middlings, KC-u,w	69
Corn,No. 2 yellow,Cent IL-bp,u	3.9200
Corn gluten feed,Midwest-u,w	102.3
Corn gluten meal,Midwest-u,w	426.3
Cottonseed meal-u,w	n.a.
Hominy feed,Cent IL-u,w	112
Meat-bonemeal,50% pro Mnpls-u,w	263
Oats,No.2 milling,Mnpls-u	3.8925
Rice, Long Grain Milled, No. 2 AR-u,w	34.88
Sorghum,(Milo) No.2 Gulf-u	n.a.
SoybeanMeal,Cent IL,rail,ton48%-u,w	279.10
Soybeans,No.1 yllw IL-bp,u	9.9900
Wheat,Spring14%-pro Mnpls-u	7.5450

	Wednesday
Wheat,No.2 soft red,St.Louis-u	5.2238
Wheat - Hard - KC (USDA) $ per bu-u	5.3925
Wheat,No.1soft white,Portld,OR-u	6.2000
Food	
Beef,carcass equiv. index	
choice 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	371.34
select 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	353.90
Broilers, National comp wtd. avg.-u,w	1.3676
Butter,AA Chicago-d	2.5200
Cheddar cheese,bbl,Chicago-d	162.75
Cheddar cheese,blk,Chicago-d	161.00
Milk,Nonfat dry,Chicago lb.-d	125.00
Coffee,Brazilian,Comp-y	3.1785
Coffee,Colombian, NY-y	3.4043
Eggs,large white,Chicago-u,w	2.9550
Flour,hard winter KC-p	15.55
Hams,17-20 lbs,Mid-US fob-u	n.a.
Hogs,Iowa-So. Minnesota-u	107.46
Pork bellies,12-14 lb MidUS-u	2.2327
Pork loins,13-19 lb MidUS-u	1.1780
Steers,Tex.-Okla. Choice-u	n.a.
Steers,feeder,Okla. City-u,w	360.75
Fats and Oils	
Degummed corn oil, crude wtd. avg.-u,w	n.a.
Grease,choice white,Chicago-h	0.5750
Lard,Chicago-u	0.6000
Soybean oil,crude;Centl IL-u,w	0.5597
Tallow,bleach;Chicago-h	0.6175
Tallow,edible,Chicago-u	n.a.

KEY TO CODES: A=ask; B=bid; BP=country elevator bids to producers; C=corrected; D=CME; E=Manfra,Tordella & Brookes; H=American Commodities Brokerage Co; K=bi-weekly; M=monthly; N=nominal; n.a.=not quoted or not available; P=Sosland Publishing; R=SNL Energy; S=Platts-TSI; T=Cotlook Limited; U=USDA; V=Benchmark Mineral Intelligence; W=weekly; Y=International Coffee Organization; Z=not quoted. *Data as of 6/24

Source: Dow Jones Market Data

Bonds | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Tracking Bond Benchmarks

Return on investment and spreads over Treasurys and/or yields paid to investors compared with 52-week highs and lows for different types of bonds

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Broad Market Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2167.61	3.6	U.S. Aggregate	4.570	4.100	5.110
U.S. Corporate Indexes Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
3308.06	3.6	U.S. Corporate	5.070	4.640	5.550
3253.96	4.0	Intermediate	4.740	4.400	5.420
4248.92	2.7	Long term	5.790	5.070	6.150
624.60	3.2	Double-A-rated	4.780	4.260	5.200
903.66	3.7	Triple-B-rated	5.260	4.850	5.810
High Yield Bonds ICE BofA					
591.91	4.0	High Yield Constrained	7.146	6.975	8.654
604.50	2.4	Triple-C-rated	12.429	11.050	14.946
3979.30	5.0	High Yield 100	6.195	6.195	7.793
515.75	3.8	Global High Yield Constrained	6.924	6.808	8.254
386.31	2.8	Europe High Yield Constrained	5.445	5.219	6.567
U.S Agency Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
1901.70	3.2	U.S Agency	4.290	3.960	5.000
1688.71	3.2	10-20 years	4.210	3.920	4.990
3527.85	3.2	20-plus years	5.030	4.240	5.320
2916.36	4.1	Yankee	4.750	4.380	5.360

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Mortgage-Backed Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2145.57	3.8	Mortgage-Backed	4.990	4.340	5.520
2111.62	3.7	Ginnie Mae (GNMA)	5.000	4.460	5.580
1266.02	3.8	Fannie mae (FNMA)	4.990	4.310	5.500
1956.74	4.1	Freddie Mac (FHLMC)	4.800	4.150	5.450
590.17	-0.7	Muni Master	3.724	3.074	4.179
421.67	0.7	7-12 year	3.464	2.858	4.016
468.69	-2.6	12-22 year	4.433	3.469	4.704
441.87	-3.6	22-plus year	4.941	3.959	5.143
Global Government J.P. Morgan†					
553.63	1.7	Global Government	3.550	3.010	3.740
833.31	0.6	Canada	3.300	2.820	3.610
364.96	0.6	EMU§	3.116	2.726	3.403
661.12	0.9	France	3.290	2.900	3.530
468.40	-0.4	Germany	2.620	2.080	2.860
263.31	-2.6	Japan	1.890	1.220	2.040
510.74	-0.5	Netherlands	2.820	2.290	3.060
802.71	2.6	U.K.	4.740	4.030	5.070
941.27	4.9	Emerging Markets **	7.355	7.084	8.073

*Constrained indexes limit individual issuer concentrations to 2%; the High Yield 100 are the 100 largest bonds † In local currency § Euro-zone bonds

** EMBI Global Index

Sources: ICE Data Services; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; J.P.Morgan

Global Government Bonds: Mapping Yields

Yields and spreads over or under U.S. Treasurys on benchmark two-year and 10-year government bonds in selected other countries; arrows indicate whether the yield rose(▲) or fell (▼) in the latest session

Coupon (%)	Country/ Maturity, in years	Yield (%) Latest(●)	Previous	Month ago	Year ago	Spread Under/Over U.S. Treasurys, in basis points Latest	Prev	Year ago
3.750	**U.S.** 2	3.780 ▼	3.811	3.985	4.732			
4.250	10	4.294 ▲	4.291	4.508	4.237			
4.750	**Australia** 2	3.205 ▼	3.242	3.418	4.033	-58.4	-58.9	-72.0
2.750	10	4.129 ▼	4.164	4.431	4.212	-16.8	-13.2	-4.0
0.750	**France** 2	2.140 ▼	2.154	1.910	3.087	-164.9	-167.8	-166.6
3.200	10	3.256 ▲	3.252	3.279	3.113	-104.1	-104.5	-113.9
1.700	**Germany** 2	1.839 ▼	1.858	1.763	2.814	-195.0	-197.3	-193.9
2.500	10	2.572 ▲	2.547	2.572	2.411	-172.5	-174.9	-184.1
2.550	**Italy** 2	2.082 ▼	2.082	2.034	3.524	-170.7	-174.9	-123.0
3.650	10	3.484 ▲	3.467	3.605	3.931	-81.4	-82.9	-32.1
0.800	**Japan** 2	0.726 ▼	0.735	0.725	0.305	-306.3	-309.6	-444.8
1.400	10	1.405 ▼	1.420	1.549	1.000	-289.3	-287.6	-325.2
2.500	**Spain** 2	2.015 ▲	1.985	1.968	3.128	-177.4	-184.6	-162.5
3.150	10	3.170 ▲	3.136	3.205	3.272	-112	-116.0	-98.0
4.125	**U.K.** 2	3.864 ▼	3.878	3.975	4.230	7.5	4.7	-52.3
4.250	10	4.484 ▲	4.479	4.683	4.082	18.7	18.3	-17.0

Source: Tullett Prebon, Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close

Corporate Debt

Prices of firms' bonds reflect factors including investors' economic, sectoral and company-specific expectations

Investment-grade spreads that tightened the most...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Spread*, in basis points Current	One-day change	Last week
APA	APA	7.750	5.84	Dec. 15, '29	195	–15	215
Macquarie Bank	...	4.331	4.10	June 12, '28	33	–14	38
Western–Southern Global Funding*	...	4.900	4.67	May 1, '30	80	–9	86
Glencore Canada	...	6.200	5.80	June 15, '35	148	–5	140
Timken	TKR	6.875	4.88	May 8, '28	110	–5	146
Board of Trustees of the Leland Stanford Junior University	...	3.460	5.51	May 1, '47	65	–4	n.a.
Archer–Daniels–Midland	ADM	7.000	4.74	Feb. 1, '31	85	–3	83

...And spreads that widened the most

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
New York Life Global Funding*	...	4.400	4.20	April 25, '28	44	19	44
Coca–Cola	KO	3.000	5.50	March 5, '51	65	17	61
EDP Finance	...	1.710	4.47	Jan. 24, '28	70	12	58
John Deere Capital	...	4.950	4.16	July 14, '28	41	8	38
Netflix	NFLX	4.875	4.18	April 15, '28	44	8	37
Loews	L	6.000	4.94	Feb. 1, '35	63	7	60
American Express	AXP	4.050	5.53	Dec. 3, '42	66	6	58
Toyota Motor Credit	...	5.050	4.36	May 16, '29	52	6	50

High-yield issues with the biggest price increases...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Bond Price as % of face value Current	One-day change	Last week
Bausch Health	...	11.000	12.03	Sept. 30, '28	97.250	0.74	96.000
Transocean	RIG	7.500	11.95	April 15, '31	81.767	0.64	85.438
Venture Global Calcasieu Pass	...	4.125	5.63	Aug. 15, '31	92.280	0.53	91.500
Methanex US Operations	...	6.250	6.34	March 15, '32	99.497	0.50	98.500
Cleveland–Cliffs	CLF	6.250	9.17	Oct. 1, '40	76.250	0.37	75.550
Bath & Body Works	BBWI	5.250	5.05	Feb. 1, '28	100.469	0.34	98.531
Rakuten	...	9.750	6.88	April 15, '29	109.431	0.33	108.800
Paramount Global	PARA	6.875	6.63	April 30, '36	101.862	0.20	101.417

...And with the biggest price decreases

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
DISH DBS	...	7.750	24.86	July 1, '26	85.438	–0.58	85.250
Verde Purchaser	...	10.500	7.75	Nov. 30, '30	108.132	–0.22	107.250
Paramount Global	PARA	4.375	7.13	March 15, '43	72.533	–0.16	72.727
Advance Auto Parts	AAP	5.900	5.88	March 9, '26	100.001	–0.09	100.125
Mauser Packaging Solutions Holding	...	7.875	6.92	April 15, '27	101.600	–0.06	101.224
Bath & Body Works	BBWI	6.750	6.72	July 1, '36	100.247		99.007

*Estimated spread over 2-year, 3-year, 5-year, 10-year or 30-year hot-run Treasury; 100 basis points=one percentage pt.; change in spread shown is for Z-spread.
Note: Data are for the most active issue of bonds with maturities of two years or more

Source: MarketAxess

Macro & Market Economics

Watching the Gauges: U.S. Supply and Demand

Inventories, imports and demand for the week ended June 20. Current figures are in thousands of barrels or thousands of gallons per day, except natural-gas figures, which are in billions of cubic feet. Natural-gas import and demand data are available monthly only.

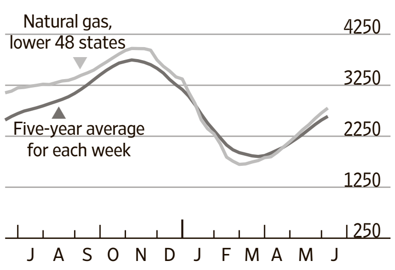
	Inventories, 000s barrels Current	Expected change	Previous week	Year ago	4-week avg	5-year avg	Imports, 000s barrels per day Current	Expected change	Previous week	Year ago	4-week avg	5-year avg
Crude oil and petroleum prod	1,230,719	...	1,235	1,296	1,236	1,292	7,723	...	7,342	8,570	7,795	9,004
Crude oil excluding SPR	415,106	-1,300	421	461	426	462	5,944	...	5,504	6,611	5,993	6,739
Gasoline	227,938	...	230	234	229	231	1,007	...	960	762	932	878
Finished gasoline	15,049	200	16	18	15	19	246	...	78	166	205	126
Reformulated	28	...	0	0	0	0	0	...	0	0	0	0
Conventional	15,021	...	16	18	15	19	246	...	78	166	205	126
Blend. components	212,889	...	214	216	214	213	761	...	882	595	727	752
Natural gas (bcf)	2,802	...	3	3	3	3	...	...	...	...	...	...
Kerosene-type jet fuel	44,520	...	44	44	44	42	13	...	212	173	109	137
Distillates	105,332	700	109	121	108	132	73	...	153	133	124	103
Heating oil	5,734	...	6	8	6	8	0	...	0	1	0	10
Diesel	99,598	...	103	114	102	62	73	...	153	131	124	93
Residual fuel oil	22,676	...	23	28	23	32	114	...	39	87	99	147
Other oils	318,128	...	316	311	315	301	509	...	397	730	456	916
Net crude, petroleum products, incl. SPR	1,633,245	...	1,637	1,668	1,638	1,790	-3,724	...	-3,841	-1,619	-2,988	-269

Weekly Demand, 000s barrels per day

	Current	Expected change	Previous week	Year ago	4-week avg	5-year avg
Total petroleum product	20,513	...	20,391	20,689	20,049	20,490
Finished motor gasoline	9,688	...	9,299	8,969	9,105	9,449
Kerosene-type jet fuel	1,706	...	1,814	1,683	1,777	1,524
Distillates	3,794	...	3,746	3,536	3,517	3,753
Residual fuel oil	167	...	352	276	254	269
Propane/propylene	305	...	825	1,027	625	...
Other oils	4,854	...	4,354	5,199	4,771	...

Natural gas storage

Billions of cubic feet; weekly totals



Note: Expected changes are provided by Dow Jones Newswires' survey of analysts. Previous and average inventory data are in millions.
Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data; U.S. Energy Information Administration; Dow Jones Newswires

Exchange-Traded Portfolios | wsj.com/market-data/mutualfunds-etfs

Largest 100 exchange-traded funds. Preliminary close data as of 4:30 p.m. ET

Wednesday, June 25, 2025

ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)
CommSvsSPDR	XLC	105.21	-0.02	8.7
CnsmrDiscSel	XLY	213.05	-1.18	-5.0
DimenUSCoreEq2	DFAC	35.20	-0.14	1.8
EnSelSectorSPDR	XLE	84.54	-0.44	-1.3
FidWiseBTC	FBTC	94.13	2.06	15.4
FinSelSectorSPDR	XLF	51.41	-0.33	6.4
HealthCrSelSect	XLV	133.90	0.09	-2.7
IndSelSectorSPDR	XLI	143.78	-0.88	9.1
InvscNasd100	QQQM	222.73	0.26	5.8
InvscQQQI	QQQ	541.16	0.26	5.9
InvscS&P500EW	RSP	178.88	-0.72	2.1
iShBitcoin	IBIT	61.27	2.02	15.5
iShBrdUSDHYCpBd	USHY	37.31	...	1.4
iShCoreDivGrowth	DGRO	63.00	-0.36	2.7
iShCoreMSCIEAFE	IEFA	81.56	-0.48	16.1
iShCoreMSCIEM	IEMG	59.55	0.07	14.0
iShCoreMSCITotInt	IXUS	76.03	-0.28	15.0
iShCoreS&P500	IVV	609.96	0.07	3.6
iShCoreS&P MC	IJH	61.04	-0.80	-2.0
iShCoreS&P SC	IJR	107.56	-0.99	-6.6
iShCoreS&PTotUS	ITOT	132.57	-0.11	3.1
iShCoreS&PUSGrw	IUSG	147.35	0.28	5.7
iShCoreS&PUSVal	IUSV	93.26	-0.35	0.7
iShCoreTotUSDBd	IUSB	46.03	0.02	1.8
iShCoreUSAggBd	AGG	98.81	-0.01	2.0
iShEdgeMSCIMinUSA	USMV	92.35	-0.86	4.0
iShEdgeMSCIUSAQual	QUAL	179.37	-0.13	0.7
iShGoldTr	IAU	62.85	0.27	26.9
iShiBoxx$IGCpBd	LQD	108.79	-0.12	1.8
iShMBS	MBB	93.54	0.02	2.0
iShMSCIACWI	ACWI	126.41	-0.07	7.6

ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)
iShMSCI EAFE	EFA	87.56	-0.55	15.8
iShMSCIEAFEValue	EFV	62.41	-0.53	19.0
iShNatlMuniBd	MUB	104.19	-0.02	-2.2
iSh1-5YIGCpBd	IGSB	52.60	-0.06	1.7
iSh1-3YTreaBd	SHY	82.73	0.02	0.9
iShRussMC	IWR	90.57	-0.84	2.5
iShRuss1000	IWB	333.46	-0.01	3.5
iShRuss1000Grw	IWF	415.44	0.35	3.5
iShRuss1000Val	IWD	191.48	-0.57	3.4
iShRuss2000	IWM	211.97	-1.17	-4.1
iShS&P500Grw	IVW	107.83	0.33	6.2
iShS&P500Value	IVE	192.51	-0.32	0.9
iSh7-10YTreaBd	IEF	95.30	0.04	3.1
iShShortTreaBd	SHV	110.36	0.01	0.2
iSh20+YTreaBd	TLT	87.51	0.13	0.2
iShUSTreasuryBd	GOVT	22.89	0.09	-0.4
iSh0-3MTreaBd	SGOV	100.64	0.01	0.3
JPMNasdEqPrem	JEPQ	53.90	0.26	-4.4
JanusHendersonAAA	JAAA	50.66	-0.08	-0.1
JPM EqPrem	JEPI	56.36	-0.37	-2.0
JPM UltShIncm	JPST	50.61	...	0.5
PacerUSCashCows	COWZ	54.34	-0.69	-3.8
ProShUltPrQQQ	TQQQ	78.48	0.77	-0.8
SPDRBbg1-3MTB	BIL	91.67	0.01	0.3
SPDR DJIA Tr	DIA	429.86	-0.22	1.0
SPDR Gold	GLD	307.12	0.30	26.8
SPDRPtfDevxUS	SPDW	39.64	-0.63	16.1
SPDRS&P500Value	SPYV	51.64	-0.25	1.0
SPDRPtfS&P500	SPLG	71.63	0.06	3.9
SPDRS&P500Growth	SPYG	93.37	0.37	6.2
SPDR S&P 500	SPY	607.12	0.06	3.6
SchwabIntEquity	SCHF	21.66	-0.53	17.1
SchwabUS BrdMkt	SCHB	23.39	-0.08	3.0

ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)
SchwabUS Div	SCHD	26.20	-1.06	-4.1
SchwabUS LC	SCHX	24.03	-0.07	3.7
SchwabUS LC Grw	SCHG	28.63	0.41	2.7
SPDR S&PMdCpTr	MDY	557.67	-0.81	-2.1
TechSelectSector	XLK	249.35	0.85	7.2
VanEckSemicon	SMH	275.20	1.35	13.6
VangdSC Val	VBR	192.73	-0.88	-2.8
VangdExtMkt	VXF	189.29	-0.99	-0.4
VangdDivApp	VIG	202.33	-0.34	3.3
VangdFTSEAWxUS	VEU	66.12	-0.32	15.2
VangdFTSEDevMk	VEA	55.87	-0.50	16.8
VangdFTSE EM	VWO	49.11	0.24	11.5
VangdFTSE Europe	VGK	75.96	-0.61	19.7
VangdGrowth	VUG	430.27	0.45	4.8
VangdHiDiv	VYM	130.99	-0.48	2.7
VangdInfoTech	VGT	652.02	0.84	4.9
VangdIntermBd	BIV	76.99	0.05	3.0
VangdIntrCorpBd	VCIT	82.41	-0.05	2.7
VangdIntermTrea	VGIT	59.60	0.07	2.8
VangdLC	VV	281.41	0.19	4.3
VangdMegaGrwth	MGK	359.47	0.45	4.7
VangdMC	VO	275.79	-0.72	4.4
VangdRealEst	VNQ	89.22	-2.41	0.2
VangdRuss1000Grw	VONG	106.92	0.38	3.5
VangdS&P500ETF	VOO	559.72	0.05	3.9
VangdST Bond	BSV	78.52	-0.03	1.6
VangdSTCpBd	VCSH	79.27	-0.05	1.6
VangdShortTrea	VGSH	58.70	0.03	0.9
VangdSC	VB	233.78	-1.01	-2.7
VangdTaxExemptBd	VTEB	48.90	-0.02	-2.5
VangdTotalBd	BND	73.30	0.03	1.9
VangdTotIntlBd	BNDX	49.43	-0.08	0.8
VangdTotIntlStk	VXUS	67.96	-0.26	15.3
VangdTotalStk	VTI	299.36	-0.12	3.3
VangdTotWrldStk	VT	126.27	-0.17	7.5
VangdValue	VTV	174.97	-0.54	3.3

MARKETS

Stocks Hover Near Record Levels, As Oil Recovers Some Lost Ground

By Heather Gillers

With the Israel-Iran ceasefire holding, stocks hung near record levels on Wednesday.

Major indexes finished mixed. The S&P 500 was unchanged and Nasdaq Composite edged up 0.3%, leaving both within 1% of their all-time highs. The Dow Jones Industrial Average fell 0.2%, or around 107 points, to 42982.43.

WEDNESDAY'S MARKETS

Tech stocks shone, with **Nvidia** gaining 4.3% to notch its first record close since early January and retaking the title of largest company by market size, ahead of Microsoft. Big tech companies helped lead the rebound from the lows of April's tariff-fueled market meltdown, and their rapid recovery has some investors piling back in.

"It's a kind of a momentum tech trade that's going to be really hard to derail," said Jay Hatfield, chief executive at Infrastructure Capital Advisors.

Oil prices nudged higher, suggesting the selloff of the past three sessions could have overshot. While the Israel-Iran truce appears fragile, analysts say moves in oil futures are likely to stay subdued—as long as neither side attacks energy-export infrastructure or disrupts shipping through the Strait of Hormuz.

"We snapped right back to prewar status as if it all never happened," said Joe Brusuelas, chief economist at RSM.

The moves came while Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell gave his second day of testimony on Capitol Hill. Bets on a July interest-rate cut have risen modestly in recent days, after two Fed officials signaled they were open to the possibility. Powell has said recent economic data would likely have justified cutting, were it not for concerns higher tariffs might fuel price rises.

President Trump said Wednesday he is reviewing candidates to succeed Powell once his term ends, as the two men clash over monetary policy.

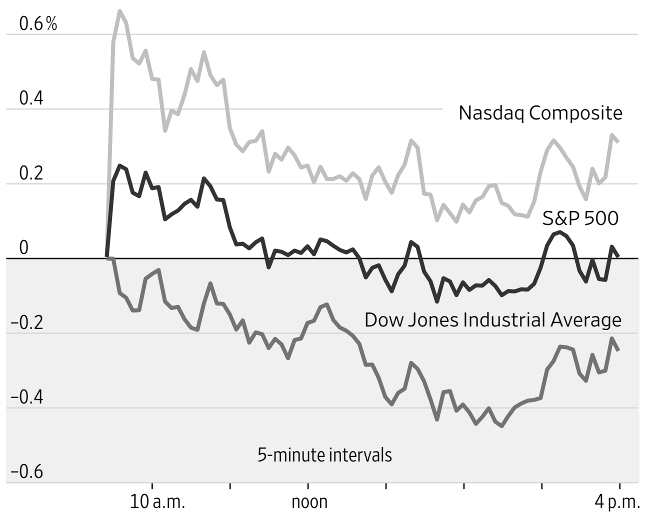
The yield on the benchmark 10-year Treasury note settled at 4.294% on Wednesday, according to Tradeweb. It settled Tuesday at 4.291%, the lowest level since early May.

Investors have also been encouraged by the race to secure trade deals with the U.S. ahead of looming tariff increases. Canada's new lead negotiator, Kirsten Hillman, said U.S. and Canadian officials would meet three times this week to hash out an agreement. Ottawa wants the U.S. to back down from levies on steel, aluminum and autos.

The European Union is also rushing to clinch a deal. But the bloc will launch retaliatory levies if the U.S. opts for even baseline tariffs on its goods, the bloc's industry chief warned, according to a Bloomberg News report.

European stocks mostly fell, while the Shanghai Composite gained 1%.

Index performance on Wednesday



Source: FactSet

THURSDAY'S EVENTS:

◆ Economic data: Weekly jobless claims, durable-goods orders for May, the third estimate for first-quarter GDP, pending home sales.

◆ Fed speaker: Governor Barr speaks at 1:15 p.m.

EARNINGS EXPECTED:

A.M.
McCormick
Walgreens
P.M.
Nike

STOCK SPOTLIGHT

Shell
The energy company is holding early-stage talks to acquire BP in what would be the largest oil deal in a generation. U.S.-listed stock in BP jumped 1.6%, while Shell's shares fell 1%.

Bumble
The online-dating company said it would lay off about one-third of its staff—roughly 240 employees. Shares soared 25%.

Tesla
The EV maker logged another month of steep sales declines in the European Union. Tesla's new-car registrations fell more than 40% in May, data from a European industry body showed. Shares dropped 3.8%.

QuantumScape
Shares surged 31% after it announced a breakthrough in its process for making solid-state batteries.

General Mills
The maker of Cheerios and other packaged foods warned sales could fall this year, as consumer spend less on snacks, and tariffs raise costs. Shares fell 5.1%.

BlackBerry
The cybersecurity company raised its annual sales guidance after posting better-than-expected quarterly results. Shares gained 13%.

Robinhood Markets
The online brokerage's shares edged 0.9% higher. The stock notched several record closing highs in recent sessions, ending above $82 for the first time on Tuesday. Shares in rival Webull fell 2.5%.

Winnebago
The motor-home manufacturer cut its annual guidance, citing the challenging macroeconomic environment, while quarterly results topped forecasts. Shares declined 9.9%.

AUCTION RESULTS

Here are the results of Wednesday's Treasury auctions. All bids are awarded at a single price at the market-clearing yield. Rates are determined by the difference between that price and the face value.

17-WEEK BILLS

Applications	$197,350,175,300
Accepted bids	$63,264,275,300
" noncompetitively	$520,341,300
" foreign noncompetitively	$0
Auction price (rate)	98.613319 (4.195%)
Coupon equivalent	4.313%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	84.50%
Cusip number	912797RE9

The bills, dated July 1, 2025, mature on Oct. 28, 2025.

ONE-YEAR, 10-MONTH FRNs

Applications	$78,134,121,900
Accepted bids	$28,000,029,900
" noncompetitively	$17,121,900
Spread	0.160%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	65.53%
Cusip number	91282CMX6

The floating-rate notes, dated June 27, 2025, mature on April 30, 2027.

FIVE-YEAR NOTES

Applications	$171,940,062,500
Accepted bids	$76,966,020,900
" noncompetitively	$94,148,600
" foreign noncompetitively	$5,000,000
Auction price (rate)	99.981978 (3.879%)
Interest rate	3.875%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	6.32%
Cusip number	91282CNK3

The notes, dated June 30, 2025, mature on June 30, 2030.

Biggest 1,000 Stocks | WSJ.com/stocks

Continued From Page B8

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
Kyndryl	KD	41.27	0.39
LatamAirlines	LTM	39.01	-0.21
LKQ	LKQ	36.94	-0.71
LPL Financial	LPLA	360.95	6.85
L3HarrisTech	LHX	247.87	1.22
Labcorp	LH	258.70	-3.83
LamResearch	LRCX	96.02	0.39
LamarAdv	LAMR	119.26	-2.34
LasVegasSands	LVS	42.90	0.27
Leidos	LDOS	153.96	1.73
Lennar A	LEN	109.77	-1.92
Lennar B	LEN.B	104.04	-2.58
LennoxIntl	LII	564.98	-4.17
LeonardoDRS	DRS	43.47	0.35
LiAuto	LI	28.11	-0.42
LibertyBroadbandC	LBRDK	94.67	-1.31
LibertyBroadbandA	LBRDA	93.65	-1.38
LibertyLiveC	LLYVK	78.48	-1.03
LibertyLiveA	LLYVA	77.25	-0.81
LibertyFormOne C	FWONK	103.80	-1.19
LibertyFormOne A	FWONA	93.50	-1.32
EliLilly	LLY	792.30	14.22
LincolnElectric	LECO	206.81	0.69
Linde	LIN	460.20	-2.96
Lineage	LINE	44.00	-2.29
LithiaMotors	LAD	331.37	-7.98
LiveNationEnt	LYV	146.19	-1.59
LloydsBanking	LYG	4.18	-0.03
LockheedMartin	LMT	458.39	-1.81
Loews	L	88.90	-1.08
LogitechIntl	LOGI	88.42	0.52
Lowe's	LOW	220.70	0.72
lululemon	LULU	231.52	-1.41
LyondellBasell	LYB	57.48	-0.85
M N			
Macom Tech	MTSI	139.17	-0.67
M&T Bank	MTB	191.23	1.11
MGM Resorts	MGM	33.88	-0.32
MPLX	MPLX	51.96	0.12
MSCI	MSCI	569.99	-5.70
MagnaIntl	MGA	37.52	-0.09
MakeMyTrip	MMYT	95.08	-0.91
ManhattanAssoc	MANH	191.48	-3.16
ManulifeFinl	MFC	31.28	-0.24
Maplebear	CART	43.33	-1.64
MarathonPetrol	MPC	165.69	0.40
Markel	MKL	1965.00	-23.98
MarketAxess	MKTX	223.16	0.43
Marriott	MAR	265.99	-2.74
Marsh&McLen	MMC	216.31	-3.36

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
MartinMarietta	MLM	534.42	-17.95
MarvellTech	MRVL	75.93	0.72
Masco	MAS	63.19	-0.59
Masimo	MASI	169.30	-0.97
▲ MasTec	MTZ	168.56	-0.95
Mastercard	MA	549.70	-7.83
McCormickVtg	MKC.V	73.41	-1.03
McCormick	MKC	73.64	-1.07
McDonald's	MCD	285.55	-5.92
McKesson	MCK	718.41	-2.41
Medpace	MEDP	311.14	-4.14
Medtronic	MDT	85.97	-0.11
MercadoLibre	MELI	2540.50	11.55
Merck	MRK	79.67	-0.65
MetaPlatforms	META	708.68	-3.52
MetLife	MET	79.11	-0.55
Mettler-Toledo	MTD	1192.85	7.67
MicrochipTech	MCHP	71.60	1.17
MicronTech	MU	127.25	-0.95
▲ Microsoft	MSFT	492.27	2.16
MicroStrategy	MSTR	388.67	11.65
MidAmApt	MAA	145.91	-3.26
MitsubishiUFJ	MUFG	14.32	-0.07
MizuhoFin	MFG	5.51	-0.09
Mobileye	MBLY	17.92	-0.03
Moderna	MRNA	26.86	0.06
MolinaHealthcare	MOH	294.14	-0.37
MolsonCoorsB	TAP	47.24	-0.98
monday.com	MNDY	298.36	-1.97
Mondelez	MDLZ	67.28	-1.15
MongoDB	MDB	206.76	-2.49
MonolithicPower	MPWR	722.82	6.24
MonsterBev	MNST	62.20	-1.37
Moody's	MCO	481.65	-7.35
MorganStanley	MS	137.72	1.82
Morningstar	MORN	310.00	0.12
Mosaic	MOS	35.47	-0.07
MotorolaSol	MSI	419.00	0.65
MrCooper	COOP	150.05	-5.91
MuellerIndustries	MLI	77.18	-0.35
MurphyUSA	MUSA	406.27	-9.17
NICE	NICE	165.53	0.32
NNN REIT	NNN	42.79	-0.21
NRG Energy	NRG	153.32	-0.36
NVR	NVR	7193.18	-84.41
NXP Semicon	NXPI	216.28	-1.22
Nasdaq	NDAQ	88.05	-0.07
Natera	NTRA	164.16	-7.71
NationalGrid	NGG	73.23	-0.02
NatWest	NWG	13.84	-0.17
Nebius	NBIS	48.52	-2.50
NetApp	NTAP	105.18	-0.95

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
NetEase	NTES	133.16	-0.89
▲ Netflix	NFLX	1275.25	-3.86
Neurocrine	NBIX	127.28	-0.40
NewOrientalEduc	EDU	54.62	-0.88
NYTimes A	NYT	55.29	0.53
Newmont	NEM	58.06	-0.03
NewsCorp B	NWS	33.72	0.12
NewsCorp A	NWSA	29.40	0.15
NextEraEnergy	NEE	70.34	-1.06
Nextracker	NXT	57.56	0.30
Nike	NKE	60.83	-0.59
NiSource	NI	39.73	-0.79
Nokia	NOK	5.17	-0.03
Nomura	NMR	6.21	-0.04
Nordson	NDSN	212.72	-0.64
NorfolkSouthern	NSC	255.21	-2.25
▲ NorthernTrust	NTRS	123.80	5.62
NorthropGrum	NOC	486.92	2.92
NorwegCruise	NCLH	19.02	-0.38
Novartis	NVS	118.00	-0.83
NovoNordisk	NVO	67.35	-3.38
NuHoldings	NU	13.23	-0.02
Nucor	NUE	128.21	0.01
NuScalePower	**SMR**	**38.66**	**-4.58**
Nutanix	NTNX	73.42	-0.85
Nutrien	NTR	58.64	-0.78
nVentElectric	NVT	72.00	-0.34
▲ NVIDIA	NVDA	154.31	6.41
O P Q			
OGE Energy	OGE	43.75	-0.97
ONEOK	OKE	80.19	-0.37
ON Semi	ON	53.74	-0.47
O'ReillyAuto	ORLY	87.84	-1.34
OccidentalPetrol	OXY	42.42	-0.06
Oklo	**OKLO**	**55.57**	**-5.14**
Okta	OKTA	98.21	-0.32
OldDomFreight	ODFL	160.35	-1.62
OldRepublic	ORI	37.30	-0.66
OmegaHealthcare	OHI	36.64	-0.47
Omnicom	OMC	70.69	-1.79
OnHolding	ONON	51.48	-0.98
▲ Oracle	ORCL	210.72	-4.55
Orix	IX	21.30	-0.08
OtisWorldwide	OTIS	96.63	-0.78
Ovintiv	OVV	38.00	-0.67
OwensCorning	OC	136.04	-1.95
PDD	PDD	107.32	-0.02
PG&E	PCG	13.79	-0.37
PNC Finl	PNC	182.51	0.49
POSCO	PKX	49.85	0.66
PPG Ind	PPG	113.26	-0.62

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
PPL	PPL	33.50	-0.71
PTC	PTC	168.60	-1.33
Paccar	PCAR	94.14	0.13
PackagingCpAm	PKG	186.08	-2.57
▲ PalantirTech	PLTR	142.90	-0.33
PaloAltoNtwks	PANW	204.30	2.61
PanAmerSilver	PAAS	28.68	0.29
ParamountA	PARAA	22.91	0.12
ParamountB	PARA	12.22	0.01
ParkerHannifin	PH	673.50	-1.74
Paychex	**PAYX**	**137.94**	**-14.31**
PaycomSoftware	**PAYC**	**222.79**	**-12.26**
Paylocity	PCTY	175.50	-7.12
PayPal	PYPL	73.07	-0.51
Pearson	PSO	14.47	-0.10
Pegasystems	PEGA	50.57	-1.04
PembinaPipeline	PBA	36.69	-0.24
PenskeAuto	PAG	174.37	-3.19
Pentair	PNR	101.06	-0.17
Penumbra	PEN	253.22	-2.50
▲ PepsiCo	PEP	128.02	-3.03
PerformanceFood	PFGC	85.53	-1.24
PermianRscs	PR	13.71	-0.30
PetroleoBrasil	PBR	12.27	-0.14
PetroleoBrasilA	PBR.A	11.25	-0.08
Pfizer	PFE	24.26	-0.05
PhilipMorris	PM	179.60	-4.89
Phillips66	PSX	119.63	0.17
PilgrimsPride	PPC	44.91	-1.71
PinnacleFinPtrs	PNFP	106.87	-1.64
PinnacleWest	PNW	88.74	-1.43
Pinterest	PINS	35.34	-0.40
PlainsAllAmPipe	PAA	17.95	-0.17
PlainsGP	PAGP	19.07	-0.25
PlanetFitness	PLNT	105.48	-2.56
Pool	POOL	298.17	-2.57
Primerica	PRI	263.72	-4.86
PrimoBrands	PRMB	29.13	-0.50
PrincipalFinl	PFG	77.06	-0.87
ProcoreTech	PCOR	67.51	-0.81
Procter&Gamble	PG	158.97	-1.39
Progressive	PGR	259.67	-6.34
Prologis	PLD	104.78	-3.35
PrudentialFinl	PRU	105.52	-0.78
Prudential	PUK	23.18	-0.52
PSEG	PEG	82.75	-0.38
PublicStorage	PSA	289.44	-6.16
PulteGroup	PHM	103.56	-1.93
PureStorage	PSTG	54.93	0.22
QXO	QXO	21.81	-1.70
Qiagen	QGEN	47.45	0.22
Qualcomm	QCOM	159.93	0.22
▲ QuantaServices	PWR	374.07	1.01
QuestDiag	DGX	178.65	-1.25

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
R S			
RBC Bearings	RBC	380.57	-7.62
RB Global	RBA	104.66	-0.95
RELX	RELX	53.07	-0.24
RPM	RPM	109.00	-1.22
RTX	RTX	141.38	-0.47
RalphLauren	RL	274.67	1.08
RangeResources	RRC	41.06	-0.87
RaymondJames	RJF	151.73	0.85
RealtyIncome	O	57.08	-0.90
Reddit	RDDT	141.68	0.89
RegalRexnord	RRX	143.63	-1.50
RegencellBio	**RGC**	**21.73**	**-1.22**
RegencyCtrs	REG	70.03	-1.63
RegenPharm	REGN	520.29	-1.98
RegionsFinl	RF	22.89	0.01
ReinsGrp	RGA	195.42	-2.11
Reliance	RS	309.04	0.14
RenaissanceRe	RNR	240.84	-3.35
Rentokillnit	RTO	23.48	-0.36
RepublicSvcs	RSG	243.88	-6.87
ResMed	RMD	257.91	2.00
RestaurantBrands	QSR	64.86	-0.65
Revvity	RVTY	97.70	1.31
RexfordIndlRealty	REXR	35.81	-1.35
RioTinto	RIO	56.71	-0.48
Rivian	RIVN	13.76	-0.05
▲ Robinhood	HOOD	82.75	0.74
▲ Roblox	RBLX	102.84	-1.94
RocketCos.	RKT	14.33	-0.62
▲ RocketLab	RKLB	32.35	-1.11
Rockwell	ROK	322.47	-3.48
RogersComm B	RCI	29.10	-0.04
Roku	ROKU	83.63	-0.06
Rollins	ROL	56.14	-1.38
RoperTech	ROP	566.94	-4.08
RossStores	ROST	127.28	-1.05
RoyalBkCanada	RY	128.07	-0.25
RoyalCaribbean	RCL	284.34	3.87
RoyalGold	RGLD	176.68	-1.46
RoyaltyPharma	RPRX	35.91	-0.23
Rubrik	RBRK	90.56	0.46
RyanSpecialty	RYAN	67.11	-2.06
Ryanair	RYAAY	56.22	-0.90
SAP	SAP	293.29	-3.79
S&P Global	SPGI	521.29	-1.68
SBA Comm	SBAC	232.68	-3.92
SEI Investments	SEIC	86.85	0.70
SK Telecom	SKM	22.88	-0.16
SS&C Tech	SSNC	80.48	-0.95
SailPoint	SAIL	23.19	-1.07
Salesforce	CRM	267.76	-3.41
Samsara	IOT	38.65	-1.63

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
Sanofi	SNY	47.80	-0.62
Schlumberger	SLB	33.18	-0.52
SchwabC	SCHW	89.80	0.48
Sea	SE	155.81	-2.48
▲ Seagate	STX	138.54	2.95
Sempra	SRE	75.02	-1.07
ServiceIntl	SCI	79.76	0.16
ServiceNow	NOW	1005.16	8.84
ServiceTitan	TTAN	104.16	-1.78
SharkNinja	SN	93.37	-1.06
Shell	SHEL	69.44	-0.70
SherwinWilliams	SHW	343.62	-2.07
Shift4Paymts	FOUR	96.45	-0.69
ShinhanFin	SHG	44.40	...
Shopify	SHOP	113.89	-0.53
SimonProperty	SPG	157.40	-2.72
SkechersUSA	SKX	62.83	0.06
Skyworks	SWKS	74.27	0.85
SmithAO	AOS	65.04	0.10
Smith&Nephew	SNN	29.90	0.05
SmithfieldFds	SFD	23.06	-0.50
Smucker	SJM	95.72	-1.47
SmurfitWestrock	SW	42.48	-1.02
Snap	SNAP	8.03	-0.29
Snap-On	SNA	307.14	-1.32
▲ Snowflake	SNOW	221.52	-1.62
SOQUIMICH	SQM	34.27	0.32
SoFiTech	SOFI	16.08	0.23
Solventum	SOLV	74.95	-0.03
Somnigroup	SGI	65.78	-1.44
Sony	SONY	24.92	-0.07
SouthState	SSB	88.83	-0.80
Southern	SO	90.40	-0.49
SoCopper	SCCO	97.08	0.17
SouthwestAir	LUV	31.34	-0.52
▲ Sportradar	SRAD	26.85	-0.12
▲ Spotify	SPOT	736.30	-13.61
SproutsFarmers	SFM	164.62	-1.85
StandardAero	SARO	30.16	0.03
StanleyB&D	SWK	66.25	-0.11
Stantec	STN	106.99	0.07
Starbucks	SBUX	91.10	-0.40
StateStreet	STT	104.35	1.65
SteelDynamics	STLD	128.48	0.26
Stellantis	STLA	9.86	0.27
Steris	STE	240.37	0.78
StifelFinancial	SF	102.40	1.76
STMicroelec	STM	29.94	-0.23
Stryker	SYK	392.23	5.77
SumitomoMits	SMFG	14.91	-0.26
SummitTherap	SMMT	21.27	0.35
SunComms	SUI	127.00	-1.10
SunLifeFinancial	SLF	64.90	-0.20
SuncorEnergy	SU	37.97	-0.31
Sunoco	SUN	51.45	-1.35

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
SuperMicroComp	**SMCI**	**46.61**	**3.77**
Suzano	SUZ	9.27	-0.14
Symbotic	**SYM**	**34.91**	**2.71**
SynchronyFinl	SYF	64.93	0.19
Synopsys	SNPS	487.27	8.29
Sysco	SYY	75.05	-0.82
T U V			
TC Energy	TRP	46.98	-0.21
TD Synnex	SNX	137.79	0.91
▲ TE Connectivity	TEL	167.87	1.39
Telus	TU	15.93	-0.10
TIM	TIMB	18.63	-0.50
TJX	TJX	122.48	-2.12
TKO	TKO	174.94	-1.95
T-MobileUS	TMUS	230.90	1.08
TPG	TPG	52.91	-0.11
TRowePrice	TROW	94.95	-0.15
TaiwanSemi	TSM	222.74	2.65
Take-TwoSftwr	TTWO	241.64	-1.41
TakedaPharm	TAK	14.97	-0.11
▲ TalenEnergy	TLN	288.00	-6.17
Tapestry	TPR	85.42	-1.84
TargaResources	TRGP	170.49	2.76
Target	TGT	96.70	-0.83
TechnipFMC	FTI	34.07	0.02
TeckResourcesB	TECK	38.25	-0.30
TeledyneTech	TDY	497.23	2.60
Ericsson	ERIC	8.33	-0.05
TelefonicaBras	VIV	10.76	-0.15
Telefonica	TEF	5.16	-0.10
TelekomIndns	TLK	15.91	-0.15
TempusAI	TEM	65.47	-2.81
Tenaris	TS	35.51	-0.19
TencentMusic	TME	18.73	-0.03
TenetHealthcare	THC	169.01	-2.51
Teradyne	TER	90.20	-0.19
Tesla	TSLA	327.55	-12.92
TetraTech	TTEK	35.99	0.26
TevaPharm	TEVA	17.00	-0.09
TexasInstruments	TXN	205.38	-0.43
TexasPacLand	TPL	1036.88	-23.55
TexasRoadhouse	TXRH	184.01	-4.78
Textron	TXT	79.28	0.52
ThermoFisher	TMO	410.65	-5.29
ThomsonReuters	TRI	195.73	-1.46
3M	MMM	147.75	-2.12
Toast	**TOST**	**41.50**	**-3.17**
TollBros	TOL	111.31	-1.99
TopBuild	BLD	319.46	-7.13
TorontoDomBk	TD	72.00	0.20
TotalEnergies	TTE	61.04	0.64
ToyotaMotor	TM	169.15	-2.43
TractorSupply	TSCO	52.80	-0.71

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
TradeDesk	TTD	69.80	-2.04
Tradeweb	TW	144.05	2.59
TraneTech	TT	427.53	-1.49
TransDigm	TDG	1457.24	-15.71
TransUnion	TRU	88.51	-1.30
Travelers	TRV	260.81	-5.33
Trimble	TRMB	74.12	0.41
Trip.com	TCOM	59.37	0.48
TruistFinl	TFC	41.40	-0.05
Twilio	TWLO	119.82	-1.80
TylerTech	TYL	581.24	-7.39
TysonFoods	TSN	54.64	-0.87
UBS Group	UBS	32.25	0.20
UDR	UDR	40.11	-0.87
U-Haul	UHAL	60.79	-0.54
U-Haul N	UHAL/B	54.16	-0.29
▲ UL Solutions	ULS	70.62	-2.29
US Foods	USFD	76.19	-0.50
Uber	UBER	90.90	-0.75
Ubiquiti	UI	395.23	-2.41
UltaBeauty	ULTA	459.09	-5.40
Unilever	UL	61.29	-1.05
UnionPacific	UNP	226.81	-1.10
UnitedAirlines	UAL	76.73	-2.29
UnitedMicro	UMC	7.66	-0.23
UPS B	UPS	99.37	-1.25
UnitedRentals	URI	736.18	-4.59
US Bancorp	USB	44.82	0.28
UnitedTherap	UTHR	285.97	-3.97
UnitedHealth	UNH	302.02	-3.60
UnitySoftware	U	24.15	0.11
UniversalHealthB	UHS	175.69	0.49
UnumGroup	UNM	78.03	-1.40
VICI Prop	VICI	32.26	-0.55
Vale	VALE	9.06	-0.15
ValeroEnergy	VLO	135.72	-0.13
VeevaSystems	VEEV	279.50	-2.13
Ventas	VTR	63.51	0.16
VentureGlobal	VG	16.16	-0.56
Veralto	VLTO	100.17	-0.14
VeriSign	VRSN	282.44	-2.59
VeriskAnalytics	VRSK	304.17	-5.76
Verizon	VZ	42.12	-0.51
VeronaPharma	VRNA	95.11	-2.11
VertexPharm	VRTX	445.82	-4.45
Vertiv	VRT	121.64	-0.68
Viatris	VTRS	8.89	-0.06
Viking	VIK	51.27	-0.11
VinFastAuto	VFS	3.51	0.04
ViperEnergy	VNOM	38.07	-0.52
Visa	V	345.26	-6.37
Vistra	VST	186.32	0.15
Vodafone	VOD	10.37	-0.07
VornadoRealty	**VNO**	**35.89**	**-2.57**

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
VulcanMatls	VMC	254.64	-9.84
W X Y Z			
WEC Energy	WEC	102.87	-2.49
W.P.Carey	WPC	62.65	-1.74
Wabtec	WAB	203.77	-2.10
WalgreensBoots	WBA	11.31	-0.04
Walmart	WMT	97.26	-0.74
WarnerBrosA	WBD	10.87	-0.03
WarnerMusic	WMG	26.19	-0.83
WasteConnections	WCN	185.68	-2.48
WasteMgt	WM	228.58	-5.56
Waters	WAT	350.01	3.21
▼ Watsco	WSO	423.60	-7.61
WattsWater	WTS	244.03	-2.11
WebsterFin	WBS	53.08	-0.60
WellsFargo	WFC	79.07	0.96
Welltower	WELL	153.43	-0.82
WescoIntl	WCC	182.13	-2.86
WestPharmSvcs	WST	221.02	-1.66
WestAllianceBcp	WAL	75.50	-0.41
▲ WesternDigital	WDC	62.55	0.48
WesternMidstrm	WES	37.70	-0.46
Westlake	WLK	74.91	-0.87
Weyerhaeuser	WY	26.07	-0.58
WheatonPrecMtls	WPM	89.30	0.73
Williams	WMB	60.69	-0.43
Williams-Sonoma	WSM	158.90	1.02
WillisTowers	WTW	298.78	-3.60
Wingstop	WING	356.09	-8.02
WintrustFinl	WTFC	121.34	-1.55
Wipro	WIT	3.08	0.01
Wix.com	WIX	159.77	-1.44
WoodsideEnergy	WDS	15.50	-0.08
▲ Woodward	WWD	243.42	0.73
▲ WooriFinl	WF	49.16	0.57
Workday	WDAY	233.46	-5.73
WynnResorts	WYNN	91.91	0.94
XP	XP	19.27	-0.14
XPO	XPO	124.03	-1.90
XcelEnergy	XEL	67.32	-0.91
XPeng	XPEV	19.20	-0.65
Xylem	XYL	127.49	0.34
YPF	YPF	33.06	-1.29
Yum!Brands	YUM	147.18	4.48
YumChina	YUMC	44.47	0.07
ZTO Express	ZTO	17.84	0.23
ZebraTech	ZBRA	303.05	4.11
Zillow C	Z	68.45	-1.77
Zillow A	ZG	67.01	-1.66
ZimmerBiomet	ZBH	92.79	0.45
Zoetis	ZTS	157.23	-0.54
ZoomComms	ZM	76.62	0.17
▲ Zscaler	ZS	311.98	3.52

New Highs and Lows

The following explanations apply to the New York Stock Exchange, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market stocks that hit a new 52-week intraday high or low in the latest session. % CHG-Daily percentage change from the previous trading session.

Wednesday, June 25, 2025

Highs

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
ABVC Bio	ABVC	2.29	9.2
AbCelleraBio	ABCL	4.09	3.3
AcadianAsset	AAMI	33.48	0.8
AdaptiveBiotech	ADPT	12.07	12.5
AdvEnergyInds	AEIS	135.69	0.6
AeroVironment	AVAV	250.00	21.6
AevaTechWt	AEVAW	0.61	-8.3
Amphenol	APH	97.41	2.1
ArbioBiotechnology	NNNN	35.90	32.2
Arm ADRhedged	ARMH	67.43	0.2
ArmadaAcqnIIWt	AACIW	0.40	3.7
AtlasNts2027	ATCOL	25.28	...
Autoliv	ALV	113.20	-1.1
AutoNation	AN	201.67	-0.6
AvisBudget	CAR	176.76	2.3
AxiomIntelli	AXINU	10.16	...
BestSpacIAcqn	BSAAU	10.04	0.1
BentleySystems	BSY	52.90	-0.2
BleichroederI Rt	BACQR	0.35	13.9

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
Brainsway	BWAY	12.65	0.6
BridgeBioPharma	BBIO	45.18	-0.2
Broadcom	AVGO	269.87	0.3
CalRedwoodAcqn	CRAQU	10.26	...
CalRedwoodAcqnRt	CRAQR	0.28	8.0
Calix	CALX	49.86	-0.3
CarpenterTech	CRS	268.64	-0.6
CartesianGrwIII	CGCTU	11.16	-0.2
CartesianIII A	CGCT	10.03	...
Celestica	CLS	152.23	3.6
ChampionsGate	CHPGU	11.08	-0.2
ChunghwaTel	CHT	46.91	0.3
CiscoSystems	CSCO	68.53	0.4
Cloudflare	NET	192.00	2.0
CoinbaseGlbl	COIN	369.28	3.1
CommScope	COMM	7.83	5.7
CompoSecureWt	CMPOW	6.62	-1.9
ConcordeIntl	CIGL	9.00	-14.6
CraneHarborRt	CHACR	0.28	2.1
CredoTech	CRDO	95.00	0.3
CrowdStrike	CRWD	500.41	1.8

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
Curtiss-Wright	CW	484.05	0.1
DieboldNixdorf	DBD	54.00	-1.3
DoorDash	DASH	238.45	-1.5
Ducommun	DCO	84.34	-0.3
DuneAcqnIIWt	IPODW	0.27	-10.0
EMX Royalty	EMX	2.51	2.4
ESCO Tech	ESE	192.37	1.3
ESGL	ESGL	3.59	18.9
EnlightRenewableEn	ENLT	23.60	3.1
Espey	ESP	42.60	2.6
EupraxiaPharma	EPRX	4.49	-0.9
EurekaAcqn	EURKU	11.60	3.0
EvolvTech	EVLV	6.38	-1.9
Fabrinet	FN	288.72	3.4
51TalkOnlineEd	COE	34.03	...
FirstCash	FCFS	135.64	3.1
Flex	FLEX	49.44	2.3
FourLeafAcqn	FORLU	11.95	2.2
FourLeafAcqnA	FORL	12.79	-0.5
FuelTech	FTEK	2.81	17.4
FutureVisionII	FVN	10.39	0.6
GE Vernova	GEV	522.97	-1.6

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
G Willi-Food	WILC	18.82	0.7
GenieEnergy	GNE	28.47	2.2
GrupoCibest	CIB	45.46	0.5
GuarantyBcshrs	GNTY	43.29	0.2
HappyCity	HCHL	5.85	7.6
HomestAerospace	HWH	178.69	-0.3
IdexxLab	IDXX	533.32	...
InnovSolSuprt	ISSC	13.49	-2.0
Insmed	INSM	106.83	-1.0
IBM	IBM	296.16	-0.9
Iron	IRON	59.29	-1.7
JPMorganChase	JPM	284.28	1.0
JVSPAC Acqn A	JVSA	19.28	-12.7
JVSPAC Acqn Rt	JVSAR	0.58	7.3
Jabil	JBL	215.97	1.3
KKR Nts2065	KKRT	25.47	0.2
KandalMVenture	FMFC	6.33	10.0
KeenVisionAcqn	KVAC	11.40	0.1
KenonHoldings	KEN	39.49	-0.3
KoreaElecPwr	KEP	13.95	8.6
LaunchOneWt	LPAAW	0.34	-19.7
LifecoreBiomed	LFCR	8.45	0.7
LightWaveAcqn	LWACU	10.07	0.3
LiminatusPharma	LIMN	3.36	-10.1
LiminatusWt	LIMNW	0.47	-9.6
MagicSoftware	MGIC	18.26	0.9
MasTec	MTZ	171.87	-0.6
MaywoodAcqnRt	MAYAR	0.34	-7.2

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
mF Intl	MFI	6.95	-18.4
MicrochipTechPfdA	MCHPP	66.61	1.4
Microsoft	MSFT	494.56	0.4
MirionTech	MIR	21.95	6.1
Nasdaq	NDAQ	88.78	-0.1
NationalVision	EYE	23.42	-0.2
NektarTherap	NKTR	37.38	19.1
Neonode	NEON	22.63	2.7
Netflix	NFLX	1298.00	-0.3
NorthernDynasty	NAK	1.56	15.7
NorthernTrust	NTRS	124.15	4.8
NVIDIA	NVDA	154.45	4.3
OFSCapNts2028	OFSSH	23.18	0.4
O-I Glass	OI	15.33	3.3
Ollie'sBargain	OLLI	132.22	1.5
Oracle	ORCL	216.93	-2.1
OstinTech	OST	9.10	5.9
OxfordSquareNt25	OXSQZ	25.06	0.2
OxfordSquareNt28	OXSQG	23.74	0.3
OxleyBridge	OBAWU	10.02	...
OysterEntsII	OYSEU	10.13	...
PagayaTech	PGY	20.60	-3.9
PalantirTech	PLTR	147.62	-0.2
ParkHaBio	PHH	32.81	3.0
Paysign	PAYS	6.75	-0.2
PelicanAcqn	PELI	10.02	...
PelicanAcqnRt	PELIR	0.25	-9.1
PepsiCo	PEP	128.24	-2.3
Phenton	PHTON	22.34	-8.6
PhoenixAsia	PHOE	13.29	-5.9

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
PioneerBancorp	PBFS	12.39	1.2
Pitanium	PTNM	7.65	-1.0
PlayAGS	AGS	12.44	0.2
PowerSolutions	PSIX	67.00	-3.8
PriorityIncmPfdK	PRIFpK	23.69	0.4
Prudential	PUK	25.13	0.9
QuantaServices	PWR	375.53	0.5
QuantumSi	QSI	2.24	34.8
Radware	RDWR	28.97	1.0
Robinhood	HOOD	85.55	0.9
Roblox	RBLX	105.30	-1.9
RocketLab	RKLB	34.50	-3.3
Sanmina	SANM	95.96	1.7
Seagate	STX	138.69	2.2
SentientTech	SXT	99.59	0.8
Sezzle	SEZL	164.29	-3.3
Snowflake	SNOW	225.68	-0.7
Sportradar	SRAD	27.48	-0.4
Spotify	SPOT	759.17	-1.8
Spottt	SII	67.96	4.8
SunCokeEn	STT	104.54	1.6
Strat	SWAG	1.63	-3.8
SuperGroup	SGHC	10.44	2.7
TE Connectivity	TEL	168.49	0.8
TMCthemetals	TMC	8.12	13.3
TMCtheMtlsWt	TMCWW	2.04	21.5
TTM Tech	TTMI	40.57	3.5
TalenEnergy	TLN	300.00	-2.1

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
TexasVenturesIII	TVACU	10.30	0.7
TutorPerini	TPC	44.78	-1.0
UL Solutions	ULS	73.98	-3.1
UMBFinPfdB	UMBFO	25.89	0.1
WesternDigital	WDC	62.89	0.8
Willdan	WLDN	60.43	4.1
Woodward	WWD	244.87	0.3
WooriFinl	WF	49.39	1.2
WorldAcceptance	WRLD	165.34	3.2
WorthPenn	WPN	150.30	...
XAIOctagonPfd	XFLTpA	25.48	0.2
XenteicBiosci	XBIO	5.27	23.4
YY Group	YYGH	2.79	11.2
YatsenHolding	YSG	11.57	13.0
Zscaler	ZS	316.44	1.1

Lows

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
Aditxt	ADTX	1.28	22.6
AdvancedBiomed	ADVB	0.67	-4.7
Agriforce	AGRI	0.86	-4.3
AlphaMetal	AMIX	97.41	-4.7
AmicusTherap	FOLD	5.51	-1.2
AquaMetals	AQMS	0.53	-5.2
AscentSolar	ASTI	1.10	-2.7
AspenInsurance	AHL	29.81	-3.1
AtegritySpecIns	ASIC	21.16	-1.7
AvitaMedical	RCEL	4.71	-3.4
BRileyFinlPfdA	RILYP	1.73	-0.2
B.RileyPfdB	RILYL	1.81	-7.0
Baiyanll	BIYA	0.59	-5.7
BeasleyBroadcast	BBGI	3.67	-6.1
BertoAcqnWt	TACOW	0.56	-24.4
Biodexa	BDRX	4.63	-6.1
BeyondAir	XAIR	0.15	-6.1
BlackStoneMin	BSM	12.78	-1.3
BlueOwlTech	OTF	15.37	-2.1
BostonBeer	SAM	188.20	-4.4
BrighthousePfdD	BHFAM	13.08	-4.2
BrookfldBRP27Nt	BEPJ	21.09	0.2
BrookfieldNts2084	BIPJ	22.71	0.3
CSP	CSPI	10.39	-4.9
CalidiBiotherap	CLDI	0.22	-11.7
Campbell's	CPB	31.17	-3.1
CantorEqPtrsII	CEPT	10.71	-3.9
CardioDiag	CDIO	3.22	-6.3
Chagee	CHA	25.51	-8.8
Clorox	CLX	119.41	-2.1
ConagraBrands	CAG	20.45	-4.7
DermataTherap	DRMA	0.60	-0.7
DigitalAssetWt	DAAQW	0.75	-26.7
DragonflyEnergy	DFLI	0.17	-8.6
EntradaTherap	TRDA	6.93	-0.3
ErieIndemnity	ERIE	340.79	-3.5
FangddNetwork	DUO	2.31	-4.1
FastTrack	FTRK	1.35	-33.6
FirstNWBncp	FNWB	6.05	-8.7
Freshpet	FRPT	67.72	-6.0

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
GIBO	GIBO	0.27	-13.8
GabelliDivPfdH	GDVpH	22.40	-1.4
GabelliEquityPfdK	GABpK	20.48	-0.1
GabelliMultiPfdG	GGTpG	22.25	-0.6
GeneralMills	GIS	50.66	-5.1
GreenPowerMotor	GP	0.38	-6.1
Heartbeam	BEAT	1.40	-4.1
HuachenAIPkg	HCAI	0.84	-5.2
Insperity	NSP	57.87	-2.5
InspireMD	NSPR	1.99	-9.5
IntrepidPotash	IPI	33.06	-3.6
IronHorseAcqns	IROH	8.40	-10.5
InspireTechnology	ISPR	2.24	-3.8
JVSPAC Acqn A	JVSA	9.54	-12.7
JX Luxventure	JXG	1.70	-9.8
JianzhiEduc	JZ	1.65	-4.0
KalarisTherap	KLRS	2.28	-4.4
LexariaBioscience	LEXX	0.86	-6.8
Lifeward	LFWD	0.50	-36.8
LixiangEduc	LXEH	1.49	1.1
MaidenNts46	MHLA	13.90	-0.1
MainzBiomed	MYNZ	1.34	0.7
MaxCyte	MXCT	2.00	0.7
MolsonCoorsB	TAP	47.05	-2.0
MullenAuto	MULN	0.86	-10.9
NewGenIvf	NIVF	1.00	-3.7
Ostrak	OTRK	0.94	-7.2
OpendoorTech	OPEN	0.51	-6.9
OrientalRise	ORIS	0.60	-31.7

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
OxfordIndustries	OXM	36.99	-2.1
PaxMedica	PRFX	1.25	-12.5
PasitheaTherap	KTTA	0.71	-1.0
PepsiCo	PEP	127.63	-2.3
PrairieOperating	PROP	3.14	-2.2
ProficientAuto	PAL	6.58	-5.2
ProMISNeurosci	PMN	0.47	...
REE Automotive	REE	0.55	-1.8
RenatusTacticalWt	RTACW	1.46	-24.2
RepublicDigiA	RDAG	10.30	-1.6
RepublicDigWt	RDAGW	0.56	-31.8
RockwellMedical	RMTI	0.80	-3.9
SaratogaTherap	SRPT	17.00	-8.0
SeaStarMedicalWt	ICUCW	0.02	5.4
SigmaLithium	SGML	4.25	-5.9
SimulationsPlus	SLP	16.72	-1.2
TEN Holdings	XHLD	0.16	-9.6
Talphera	TLPH	0.43	3.8
TreeHouseFoods	THS	19.54	-6.2
TruistFinPfdI	TFCpI	20.16	-1.0
USA Rare Earth Wt	USAR	418.31	-1.8
UTStarcom	UTSI	2.50	...
WenAcqn	WENNU	10.30	-2.9
WindtreeTherap	WINT	0.36	-6.4
Winnebago	WGO	28.19	-9.9
X4 Pharm	XFOR	2.05	-8.3
XcelBrands	XELB	1.60	-8.6
Zspace	ZSPC	2.76	-6.5

Mutual Funds

Data provided by LSEG

Top 250 mutual-funds listings for Nasdaq-published share classes by net assets.

e-Ex-distribution. **f**-Previous day's quotation. **g**-Footnotes x and s apply. **j**-Footnotes e and s apply. **k**-Recalculated by LSEG, using updated data. **p**-Distribution costs apply, 12b-1. **r**-Redemption charge may apply. **s**-Stock split or dividend. **t**-Footnotes p and r apply. **v**-Footnotes x and e apply. **x**-Ex-dividend. **z**-Footnote x, e and s apply. **NA**-Not available due to incomplete price, performance or cost data. **NE**-Not released by LSEG; data under review. **NN**-Fund not tracked. **NS**-Fund didn't exist at start of period.

Wednesday, June 25, 2025

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD % Ret
AB Funds			
MuniIncmShares	10.88	...	-0.4
AB Funds - ADV			
LgCpGrAdv	114.87	+0.42	5.0
American Century Inv			
Ultra	93.92	+0.45	0.6
American Funds Cl A			
AmcpA	43.30	+0.01	5.8
AMutlA	58.47	-0.24	6.8
BalA	36.16	-0.04	6.5
BondA	11.31	...	3.6
CapIBA	75.29	-0.30	10.6
CapWGrA	69.70	-0.07	10.6
EupacA	59.42	-0.15	13.7
FdInvA	86.04	-0.13	9.4
GwthA	80.27	-0.03	7.8
HI TrA	9.80	+0.01	3.5
ICAA	61.60	-0.02	8.4
IncoA	26.28	-0.12	9.0
N PerA	68.45	-0.11	10.2
NEcoA	66.62	+0.07	9.0
NwWrldA	87.64	+0.06	13.7
SmCpA	71.00	-0.02	2.5
TxExA	12.12	...	-0.7
WshA	62.68	-0.21	6.9

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD % Ret
Artisan Funds			
IntlVal Inst	51.91	-0.30	10.6
Baird Funds			
AggBdInst	9.81	...	3.6
CorBdInst	10.17	+0.01	3.6
IntBdInst	10.46	+0.01	3.8
BlackRock Funds			
HiYBlk	7.17	+0.01	4.4
HiYldBd Inst	7.16	...	4.2
BlackRock Funds III			
iShS&P500IdxK	715.18	...	4.3
BlackRock Funds Inst			
StratIncOpptyIns	9.66	...	4.3
Calamos Funds			
MktNeutI	15.35	...	3.3
CausewayInst	22.10	-0.11	19.1
Columbia Class I			
DivIncom I	34.33	-0.16	5.0
Dimensional Fds			
EmgMktVa	34.00	+0.09	13.9
EmMktCorEq	26.23	+0.07	12.9
IntlCoreEq	18.29	-0.05	18.9
IntSmCo	23.23	-0.02	19.9
IntSmVa	27.34	-0.05	24.8

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD % Ret
LgCo	40.51	...	4.2
US CoreEq1	44.47	-0.07	3.1
US CoreEq2	39.56	-0.07	2.8
US Small	47.36	-0.41	-2.9
US SmCpVal	45.86	-0.44	-5.1
US TgdVal	32.94	-0.33	-3.7
USLgVa	50.50	-0.22	3.0
Dodge & Cox			
Balanced	106.47	-1.21	7.3
Income	12.58	-0.13	3.8
Intl Stk	60.10	-0.26	20.4
Stock	266.15	-2.25	5.6
DoubleLine Funds			
TotRetBdI	8.84	...	4.0
Edgewood Growth Instituti			
EdgewoodGrInst	46.25	...	4.7
Fidelity			
500IdxInstPrem	212.15	+0.01	4.3
Contrafund K6	34.09	+0.05	9.8
ExtMktIdxInstPre	90.92	-0.85	...
FidSer5	7.66	+0.01	4.3
FidSerIntl	8.72	-0.01	0.9
FidSerToMarket	19.85	-0.02	3.7
FIDZroLgCpIx	21.83	...	4.3
GlexUSIdxInstPre	16.86	-0.04	16.9

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD % Ret
GrowthCompanyK6	31.27	+0.15	2.8
IntlIdxInstPrem	56.14	-0.24	18.1
LgCpGwId InstPre	40.65	+0.14	3.8
LgCpVlIdxInstPrem	18.94	-0.11	4.4
MidCpIdxInstPrem	34.85	-0.28	3.2
SAIUSLgCpIndxFd	24.22	...	4.2
SeriesBondFd	9.02	+0.01	3.6
SeriesOverseas	15.81	-0.04	17.6
SerLTTreBdIdx	5.34	...	2.4
SmCpIdxInstPrem	26.70	-0.31	-3.5
TMktIdxInstPrem	167.13	-0.19	3.7
TotalMarketIndex	21.14	-0.02	3.8
TtlIntIdxInstPr	15.69	-0.03	16.8
USBdIdxInstPrem	10.50	...	3.7
Fidelity Advisor			
TotBdFdClZ	9.54	+0.01	3.8
Fidelity Freedom			
Freedom2030 K	18.47	-0.01	7.6
Idx2030InsPre	21.39	...	7.6
Idx2035InsPre	24.84	-0.02	7.0
Idx2040InsPre	26.46	-0.02	7.8
Idx2045InsPre	27.99	-0.03	7.8
Idx2050InsPre	28.09	-0.03	8.3
Fidelity Invest			
Balanc	30.57	+0.03	3.9
BluCh	230.94	+0.96	1.7
BluChpGr K6	38.03	+0.15	3.1
Contra	22.79	+0.02	9.2
ContraK	22.88	+0.02	9.3
Cplnc	10.39	...	4.6
DivIntl	49.13	-0.09	16.5
GroCo	41.07	+0.21	1.8
InvGrBd	10.07	+0.01	4.0
LowP	45.42	-0.17	5.2
Magin	15.27	-0.02	8.0
NASDAQ	253.93	+0.78	3.7
OTC	21.66	+0.10	2.4
Puritn	25.23	+0.01	2.9
SAIUSMinVolIndFd	22.34	-0.13	4.1

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD % Ret
SAIUSQtyIdx	22.23	+0.01	4.5
SrsBlChGroRetail	20.18	+0.10	1.7
SrsEmrgMkt	21.28	+0.02	16.2
SrsGlobal	16.33	-0.03	16.9
SrsGroCoRetail	24.54	+0.13	2.4
SrsIntlGrw	19.35	-0.08	11.0
SrsIntlVal	14.95	-0.05	25.4
TotalBond	9.56	+0.01	3.8
Fidelity SAI			
FidSAIInfltnFnd	10.21	+0.01	4.3
TotalBd	9.05	...	3.8
Fidelity Selects			
Semiconductors r	34.75	+0.45	9.7
Tech	37.89	+0.39	5.6
Fidelity Strategic A			
StratAdEmMkt	NA	...	NA
First Eagle Funds			
GlbA	75.90	-0.31	13.2
Franklin A1			
IncomeA1	2.40	...	4.6
FrankTemp/Frank Adv			
IncomeAdv	2.37	...	4.2
FrankTemp/Franklin A			
DynaTech A	185.56	+0.50	6.3
Growth A	140.31	-0.17	4.7
RisDv A	92.75	-0.29	4.4
Guggenheim Funds Tru			
TotRtnBdFdClInst	23.83	+0.01	4.1
Harbor Funds			
CapApInst	119.08	+0.15	4.8
JHF III DispVal			
DispValMCI	28.07	-0.19	4.2
John Hancock			
BondR6	13.53	+0.01	3.7
JPMorgan I Class			
CoreBond	10.31	+0.01	3.8
EqInc	24.82	-0.11	4.4
LgCpGwth	82.88	+0.06	4.0
JPMorgan R Class			

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD % Ret
CoreBond	10.33	+0.01	3.9
CorePlusBd	7.24	+0.01	3.8
Lord Abbett I			
ShtDurInc p	3.88	...	3.1
Metropolitan West			
TotRetBdI	NA	...	NA
MFS Funds			
IIE	38.84	-0.11	14.8
MFS Funds Class I			
GrowthI	210.88	+0.26	4.6
ValueI	50.93	-0.27	4.9
Natixis Funds			
InvGradeBdY	9.85	...	3.4
LSGrowthY	31.00	-0.09	4.9
Northern Funds			
StkIdx	61.73	...	4.2
Old Westbury Fds			
LrgCpStr	NA	...	NA
Parnassus Fds			
ParnEqFd	62.81	+0.03	5.5
PGIM Funds Cl Z			
TotalReturnBond	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Fds Instl			
TotRt	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds A			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds I2			
Income	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds Instl			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
Price Funds			
BlChip	196.16	+1.02	5.3
DivGro	81.18	-0.28	5.9
Growth	108.68	+0.56	3.1
LgCapGow I	86.35	+0.40	5.0
R2020	24.37	...	3.9
PutLargCap p	36.14	-0.20	5.2
Putnam Funds Class Y			

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD % Ret
PutLargCap	36.17	-0.20	5.3
Schwab Funds			
1000 Inv r	131.05	-0.09	4.1
Intl Sel r	26.67	-0.12	18.0
S&P Sel	94.10	...	4.2
TSM Sel r	102.76	-0.12	3.7
Strategic Adviser			
StratAdCorIncFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdFidEmr	13.87	+0.03	14.4
StratAdFidUS	18.09	-0.01	4.3
StratAdIntlFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdMunBnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdSmMidCp	NA	...	NA
StratAdvFidIntl	13.95	-0.05	18.2
TIAA/CREF Funds			
EqIdxInst	42.55	-0.05	3.8
IntlEqIdxInst	25.96	-0.12	19.0
LrgCpGrIdxInst	69.49	+0.24	3.8
VANGUARD ADMIRAL			
500Adml	563.80	...	4.2
BalAdml	49.48	-0.03	4.2
CAITAdml	11.21	...	3.0
CapOpAdml r	197.72	+0.16	4.5
DivAppIdxAdm	54.89	-0.21	3.8
EMAdmr	40.66	+0.09	11.0
EqIncAdml	91.73	-0.58	5.4
ExplrAdml	103.94	-0.86	-2.7
ExtndAdml	143.66	-1.34	...
GroIncAdml	106.51	+0.05	4.5
GrwthAdml	209.36	+0.60	3.0
HlthCareAdml r	72.85	-0.19	4.2
HYCorAdml r	5.51	+0.01	4.8
InfProAd	23.40	+0.02	4.7
IntlGrAdml	116.14	-0.30	11.1
ITBondAdml	10.41	+0.01	4.8
ITIGradeAdml	8.76	...	4.6
LarCapAd	141.83	+0.01	4.3
MidCpAdml	341.51	-2.66	4.9

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD % Ret
MuHYAdml	10.35	...	-0.5
MuIntAdml	13.39	...	0.2
MuLTAdml	10.47	...	-1.3
MuLtdAdml	10.88	...	1.6
MuShtAdml	15.80	...	1.8
PrmcpAdml r	175.71	-0.07	5.6
RealEstatAdml	126.43	-3.15	1.1
SmCapAdml	112.02	-1.16	-2.3
SmGthAdml	95.70	-1.13	-2.4
STBondAdml	10.28	+0.01	3.2
STIGradeAdml	10.45	+0.01	3.2
STIPSIxAdm	25.16	+0.02	3.8
TotBdAdml	9.64	...	3.6
TotIntBdIdxAdm	19.77	+0.01	1.9
TotIntlAdmIdx r	36.48	-0.08	16.3
TotStAdml	145.69	-0.19	3.7
TxMCapAdml	312.84	-0.19	4.0
TxMIn r	17.96	-0.06	18.4
USGroAdml	195.98	+1.18	2.9
ValAdml	68.22	-0.40	3.9
WdsrllAdml	81.09	-0.22	4.5
WellsIAdml	61.65	-0.15	4.7
WelltnAdml	76.96	-0.05	5.3
WndsrAdml	71.02	-0.40	1.7
VANGUARD FDS			
DivdGro	35.84	-0.18	1.5
IntlVal	42.61	-0.10	13.4
LifeGro	47.51	-0.06	7.6
LifeMod	33.33	-0.03	6.5
PrmcpCor	35.69	+0.03	6.7
STAR	29.11	-0.03	5.9
TgtRe2020	29.86	...	5.6
TgtRe2025	19.84	-0.01	6.2
TgtRe2030	38.94	-0.02	6.6
TgtRe2035	25.65	-0.03	7.0
TgtRe2040	46.36	-0.05	7.3
TgtRe2045	31.93	-0.04	7.6
TgtRe2050	53.88	-0.09	8.1

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD % Ret
TgtRe2060	55.40	-0.09	8.1
TgtRet2055	60.12	-0.09	8.1
TgtRetInc	13.69	...	5.1
WellnTn	44.57	+0.03	5.3
WndsrII	45.72	-0.12	4.1
VANGUARD INDEX FDS			
ExtndIstPl	354.51	-3.31	...
IdxIntl	21.81	-0.05	16.2
MdCpVlAdml	84.39	-0.81	1.4
SmValAdml	82.82	-0.76	-2.1
TotBd2	9.51	...	3.5
TotIntlInstIdx r	145.88	-0.32	16.3
TotItlInstPlId r	145.91	-0.32	16.3
TotSt	145.64	-0.18	3.6
VANGUARD INSTL FDS			
DevMktsIndInst	28.10	-0.11	18.3
ExtndInst	143.65	-1.34	...
FTScInst	41.90	+0.05	3.7
GrwthInst	221.21	+0.03	3.0
InPrSeIn	9.53	+0.01	4.7
InstIdx	496.60	...	4.2
InstPlus	496.61	+0.01	4.2
InstTStPlus	101.77	-0.13	3.7
MidCpInst	75.44	-0.59	4.9
MidCpIstPl	372.07	-2.91	5.0
SmCapIstInst	112.02	-1.16	-2.3
SmCapIstPl	323.34	-3.33	-2.3
STIGradeInst	10.45	+0.01	3.2
STIPSIxins	25.18	+0.02	3.8
TotBdInst	9.64	...	3.6
TotBdInst2	9.51	...	3.5
TotBdInstPl	9.64	...	3.6
TotIntBdIdxInst	29.67	+0.02	1.9
TotStInst	145.72	-0.18	3.7
ValueInst	68.22	-0.40	3.9
WCM Focus Funds			
WCMFocIntlGrwIns	26.57	-0.07	22.1

HEARD ON THE STREET

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS & COMMENTARY

Nvidia Threatens Giants With Cloud Move

Things are getting awkward for tech incumbents as the AI-chip manufacturer eyes their turf

Cloud computing generates big profits for **Amazon.com**, **Microsoft** and Google. Now that cash cow faces a nascent threat with the rise of artificial-intelligence cloud specialists and a new industry power broker: **Nvidia**.

AI-chip maker Nvidia launched its own cloud-computing service two years ago called DGX Cloud. It also nurtured upstarts competing with the big cloud companies, investing in AI cloud players **CoreWeave** and Lambda.

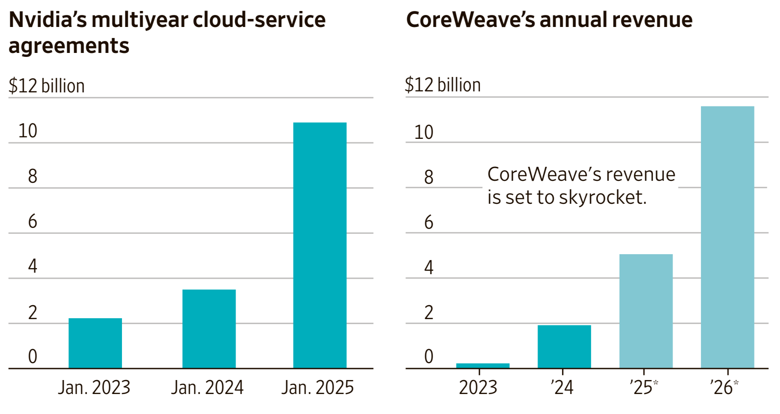
Those moves have yet to make an enormous dent, but a competitive shift is easy to imagine if computing demand continues to shift toward AI and Nvidia remains the sector's principal arms dealer.

DGX Cloud is already growing fast. UBS analysts estimated when it launched that it could grow into a more than $10 billion annual revenue business. And CoreWeave, which listed shares on the Nasdaq in March, is forecasting around $5 billion of revenue this year.

Those businesses are limited by their narrow focus on AI computing, and they pale in comparison to the more than $107 billion of sales Amazon's market-leading cloud business generated last year.

Yet any challenge in cloud computing would be worrying for Amazon: While the company's cloud division accounted for 29% of its revenue in its latest quarter, it accounted for more than 60% of its operating income thanks to its high margins.

Nvidia is raising spending on computing infrastructure to help DGX Cloud grow, and has also invested in AI cloud upstart CoreWeave.



*Consensus analyst estimates

Sources: Nvidia (agreements); CoreWeave, FactSet (revenue)

Microsoft and **Alphabet's** Google, the next two largest cloud companies, have a lot to lose if the cloud-computing landscape shifts, too. Growing macroeconomic concerns are raising caution about IT spending. Google is under antitrust scrutiny in the U.S., and its golden goose—the search engine—is being challenged by OpenAI.

All the big cloud companies effectively offer AI chips for rent, many of them made by Nvidia, which has a market share estimated at around 80%. In what is perhaps a testament to Nvidia's market power, though, the cloud companies are helping Nvidia grow its own cloud business.

Under DGX Cloud's unusual arrangement, the cloud giants buy and manage equipment—including Nvidia's chips—that forms the backbone of the service. Then Nvidia leases back that equipment from them and rents it out to corporate clients.

It also offers access to its AI experts and software as part of the package.

That has left cloud-computing giants in an uncomfortable position. While they make money through the arrangement, they are also being asked to help a service that could compete with them.

Some of them haven't rushed to participate, even if they do eventually join up; Google was notably absent from a roster of companies participating in a DGX Cloud chip-rental marketplace announced in May.

Roy Illsley, the chief analyst at tech research firm Omdia, said participating made sense for the cloud companies a couple of years ago because their own AI services weren't well-developed, although they have gotten better recently. "They needed to respond to the market when the AI revolution took off, and what Nvidia did was give them a solution when they hadn't got their own ducks in order," he said.

It isn't clear how big DGX Cloud is—Nvidia doesn't break out its revenue or profits. But the company said in its latest fiscal year that it had $10.9 billion in multiyear cloud-service agreements, up from $3.5 billion the year before, in large part to support DGX Cloud. If the service is more than breaking even—a fair bet given usually high cloud-computing profit margins—that is already a fairly sizable business.

Nvidia is adamant that it isn't trying to outshine the cloud-computing giants with DGX Cloud. In the company's telling, it aims to help connect customers with AI computing power and Nvidia's expertise in ways that weren't otherwise possible.

That may be true for now, but it would be naive to think Nvidia doesn't have any further designs. At minimum, DGX Cloud gives Nvidia an option in the future to grow a big cloud business and the power now to help shape how AI is developed. Some of the same logic likely helps drive its investments in CoreWeave and Lambda.

Nvidia has reason to be wary of the durability of its relationships with the existing cloud players, too: As it encroaches on the cloud giants' territory, they are increasingly trespassing on Nvidia's.

All of the cloud giants are developing their own custom AI chips that eventually could supplant Nvidia's. That would save them money at the expense of Nvidia's revenue, unless the chip maker can find it somewhere else.

As Nvidia seeks new areas to conquer after its runaway AI success, cloud computing looks increasingly like fertile territory—even if some of its biggest customers may not be thrilled about it.

—Asa Fitch

A Blockbuster Investing Lesson

The next Netflix or Amazon may be lost in AI hype

With bidding wars for AI companies and talent in the news almost every day, is the next trillion-dollar opportunity getting the cold shoulder?

Please be kind and rewind 25 years to when one dominant company missed a monster opportunity and another agreed to what's been called the worst deal in history. They show that fast-growing, asset-light businesses can "disrupt" existing ones but also risk getting disrupted themselves after attracting silly prices.

Before anyone could imagine it becoming the world's most valuable entertainment company, Netflix co-founders Reed Hastings and Marc Randolph were renting DVDs by mail. The brick-and-mortar video-rental business was dominated by Blockbuster. According to Hastings and Randolph, the two met that year with Blockbuster and offered to sell themselves to the chain for $50 million.

They were practically laughed out of the room. Netflix shareholders, now sitting on a company worth 10,000 times that spurned offer, are laughing all the way to the bank. Blockbuster filed for bankruptcy a decade later. You can stream a documentary about the world's last Blockbuster video store…it's on Netflix.

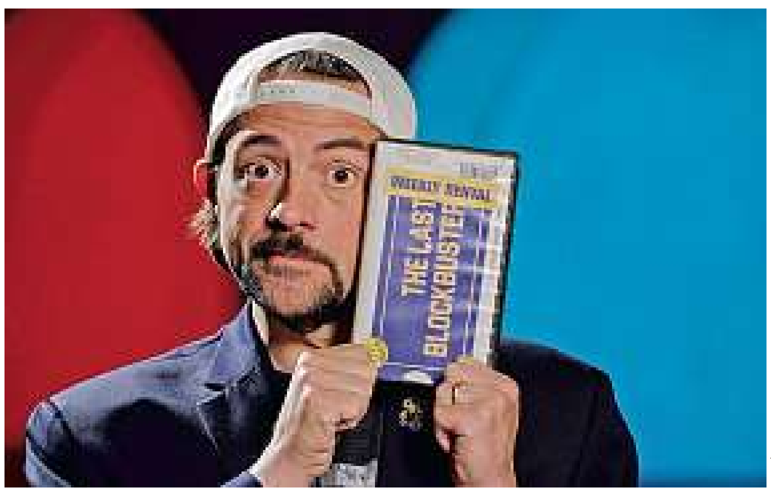
The same year, with internet pixie dust in its eyes, media giant Time Warner entered the largest merger in history with web portal AOL. From The Wall Street Journal's coverage that day: "Time Warner has essentially admitted that its own costly efforts to move the company into the digital era have failed, forcing it to hitch a ride into the future with AOL."

Two years after the deal closed Time Warner admitted it had made a gigantic mistake, removing "AOL" from the company's name. Technology moved on and imagined synergies didn't work out.

Hindsight is 20/20, but some executives have vision while the supposed best and brightest lack it. In 1997, Amazon founder Jeff Bezos, who doesn't have an M.B.A., gave a presentation to a class at Harvard Business School about his company. They formed a group to discuss it, and this was what one told Bezos, according to Brad Stone, author of "The Everything Store":

"You seem like a really nice guy, so don't take this the wrong way, but you really need to sell to Barnes & Noble and get out now."

Who knows what would have been if Netflix or Amazon had become units of large, hidebound competitors.



Scenes from 'The Last Blockbuster' documentary, with interviews with actor Doug Benson and director Kevin Smith.

109/EVERETT COLLECTION (2)

We do know why dominant companies fail to embrace the future until it's too late. Executives don't want to cannibalize existing, profitable businesses they understand for ones they don't. By the time their businesses are losing customers, prices are more than full and the next iteration of the disruptive technology is about to make the original one look quaint.

Small investors aren't the only ones who suffer from FOMO.

—Spencer Jakab

FINANCE

Startup Kalshi Hits $2 Billion Valuation

By Alexander Osipovich

Kalshi, a startup prediction market that became a popular way to bet on the November election, said Wednesday that it had been valued at $2 billion in a new funding round, a vote of confidence in its business of facilitating wagers on future events.

New York-based Kalshi, which offers yes-or-no contracts allowing users to bet on topics ranging from hurricanes to the National Basketball Association finals to the Oscars, said it had raised $185 million from investors led by **Paradigm**, a venture-capital firm best known for its crypto investments. The round values Kalshi at $2 billion, cementing its status as a "unicorn," with a valuation in the billions.

Kalshi co-founder and Chief Executive Tarek Mansour said the funding would go, in part, to scaling up its tech team so it can integrate with more brokers. **Robinhood Markets** and **Webull** already offer their customers access to Kalshi's contracts, which are also available to be traded directly through Kalshi's own website. More than a dozen other broker integrations are in the works, Mansour said.

Silicon Valley venture-capital giant **Sequoia Capital**, crypto investor Multicoin Capital and Citadel Securities CEO Peng Zhao also took part in the funding round, with Zhao investing in his personal capacity.

News of the funding round was earlier reported by Bloomberg News.

Last year, Kalshi won a court battle with the Commodity Futures Trading Commission allowing it to list contracts on the outcome of elections, which the regulator had previously blocked. The court win came just in time for the November showdown between Donald Trump and Kamala Harris, and led to a surge of trading on Kalshi.

After the election, Kalshi's trading volumes subsided, and the platform has pushed hard into sports. About 79% of its daily trading volume in March and early April was sports-related, Bloomberg Intelligence data shows.

State gambling regulators in Nevada and New Jersey have sought to block Kalshi's sports bets. Kalshi has so far fended off their efforts, arguing that its federal license from the CFTC allows it to offer sports-related event contracts in all 50 states.

The additional funding could help Kalshi fend off a rival platform, Polymarket, which also attracted huge trading volumes during the November election. Polymarket doesn't have a CFTC license, and it blocks Americans from its markets to avoid running afoul of U.S. regulators, but it has been working toward gaining access to the U.S.

Proponents of prediction markets have argued for decades that they can be a useful tool for forecasting the probability of future events.

Last year, traders at Kalshi and Polymarket correctly bet on a Trump victory, even as many opinion polls showed a dead heat between Trump and Harris, in a big win for the concept of prediction markets.

But such platforms remain a relatively niche area, and past ventures such as Intrade, a prediction market that shut down in 2013, have failed to take off.

Crude-Oil Stockpiles Drop for Fifth Week

By Anthony Harrup

U.S. crude-oil inventories posted a fifth straight weekly decline, leaving stocks 11% below the five-year average for the time of year, according to data released Wednesday by the U.S. Energy Information Administration.

Commercial crude-oil stocks excluding the Strategic Petroleum Reserve fell 5.8 million barrels to 415.1 million barrels in the week ended June 20, the EIA said. Analysts surveyed by The Wall Street Journal had predicted crude stockpiles would fall 1.3 million barrels.

Oil stored in the SPR rose 237,000 barrels to 402.5 million barrels. Oil stocks at Cushing, Okla., the Nymex delivery hub, were down by 464,000 barrels at 22.2 million barrels.

Estimated U.S. crude-oil production was steady at 13.4 million barrels a day. Imports rose 439,000 barrels a day to 5.9 million barrels a day and exports fell 91,000 barrels a day to 4.3 million barrels a day.

Refinery capacity use increased 1.5 percentage points to 94.7%, compared with expectations of a half-percentage-point increase in the Journal survey. Crude oil input to refineries increased 125,000 barrels a day to just under 17 million barrels a day.

Gasoline stocks fell 2.1 million barrels to 227.9 million barrels against expectations of a 200,000 barrel increase, and were about 3% below the five-year average. Gasoline demand rose 389,000 barrels a day to 9.7 million barrels a day.